Small law firms chase, wait and fear AI

Problems, workflows, numbers, vocabulary and service gaps in small UK and US law firms (1 to 30 lawyers, including sole practitioners)

Research report, 11 October 2026

Problems and gaps only. This document adds no solutions and no recommendations.

Scope	UK (England and Wales) and US small law firms of 1 to 30 lawyers, including sole practitioners; conveyancing, probate, family, immigration, personal injury, employment, criminal, bankruptcy, debt and possession work.
Inputs	Ten note files compiled by the research team: time and money benchmarks, practitioners' vocabulary, practice-area workflows, AI and confidentiality rulings, police and crash reports, Clio configuration, the PI case-opening handoff, Filevine versus Clio, the twelve-gap ranking, and the employed-versus-freelance market.
Sources blocked	clio.com and its help centre; americanbar.org; lawsociety.org.uk; lawgazette.co.uk; sra.org.uk notice pages; G2, Capterra and (for some products) TrustRadius; Upwork and Fiverr gig pages; Reddit on every mirror; most US state crash-report portals and every UK police-force collision-report page. Facts from those hosts rest on search snippets, secondary reports or vendor claims and are tagged.
Currency and dates	All currency as published: GBP for UK figures, USD for US figures. Dates are given so freshness can be judged.

How to read the evidence tags

[snippet]	the fact was seen only in a search-engine summary because the page blocked the researcher
[vendor]	the vendor's own claim; no independent review confirmed it
[user, date]	a dated user review
[secondary]	the figure was relayed by a news site or blog rather than read from the primary report
[3p]	a third-party estimate or tracker, not the vendor's own figure
[n]	a numbered source; the URL is in the Sources appendix at the end

Prepared for Mustafa Shoukat. Built from the research report *Small law firm problems UK US* (about 32,000 words, 12 sections, 41 tables, 12 gap cards). 381 numbered sources.

Contents

Read this first 4

Lawyers bill three hours of eight; the rest is admin and chasing 5

Hours: what is billed, invoiced and collected 5

Money: why the lost time hurts 6

The intake leak 6

Their own words: the UK "chases", the US does "intake" 8

UK words 8

US words 8

What job advertisements pay people to do 9

How lawyers phrase their searches (Google autocomplete, 10 October 2026) 10

What firms buy on freelance boards, and at what price 11

Every practice area is a forms-and-deadlines loop run on someone else's clock 13

UK practice areas: steps, numbers, sources 13

The UK courts have shifted format risk onto firms 14

What clients complain about tracks the same loops 15

US practice areas: agencies instead of registries, sharper deadline risk 16

The fee model decides which pain bites 18

Website sweeps: how little is digital at the firm's edge 18

Why client data cannot go into ChatGPT: tribunals, warning notices, sanctions and shadow AI 19

UK: tribunal rulings, then warning notices 19

US: bar opinions, a privilege waiver, and routine sanctions 19

What firms are afraid of, in order: hallucination, then privilege and training, then vendor terms 20

Cyber incidents: the other reason small firms are told to keep data inside 22

US PI firms get the police report second, by hand, and vendors stop at the PDF 24

The sequence and why the report matters 24

Obtaining the report is a manual, state-specific act 24

The other intake verifications follow the same pattern 25

The automation boundary is legal, not technical 26

England and Wales: the low-value route removes the police report as a precondition 26

Clio can apply a checklist but cannot police it: the audit angle 27

What Clio's native automation can and cannot do 27

Everything conditional, date-driven or cross-matter needs the API or middleware 27

No vendor sells the exception report, and the evidence firms misconfigure is consistent 28

The consultant market is real but opaque on price 29

UK: the audit function is split three ways 30

The PI case-opening handoff: where cases "slip through the cracks" 31

The opening sequence the checklists converge on . . . 31
The failure points, in practitioners' own words . . . 31
The open sub-problem: the provider list itself . . . 32
What a daily 'missing-task' check on a PI practice would have to test . . . 33
Filevine versus Clio, Lead Docket versus Clio Grow . . . 34
Different buyers . . . 34
Real pricing is harder to pin down than either website suggests . . . 34
What each solves well, in users' words . . . 35
What users say Clio does not solve (stable for seven years) . . . 36
What users say Filevine does not solve (delivery, people, reports, AI quality) . . . 36
Clio Grow versus Lead Docket: a general intake add-on against a PI-grade intake system . . . 37
The UK mirror: Clio UK against LEAP, where the gap is contract and exit terms . . . 38
Six needs recur in the reviews of both products . . . 38
Twelve service gaps, ranked by problem signal and vendor weakness . . . 40
The twelve gap cards . . . 41
Crowded areas that are not gaps . . . 53
Employed path versus freelance path: the same skills, very different prices . . . 54
Employed demand: a dated snapshot . . . 54
Three title profiles that do not overlap . . . 55
Remote and visa reality . . . 56
The 2025-26 market moves explain the concentration . . . 56
The freelance and consulting path has three price tiers . . . 57
How small firms actually buy technology help . . . 58
Side by side on five criteria . . . 59
What the notes do not contain . . . 60
Sources . . . 61
What could not be verified . . . 69
Conclusion . . . 71

Read this first

The eight numbers that carry the report, then the twelve service gaps in rank order. Each gap has a full card in section 9.

3.0 of 8 h
billable hours per 8-hour day; only 2.4 h collected
US firms on the Clio platform, 2025; utilisation 38% Clio benchmarks [1] snippet

52% / 74%
name admin the number-one workflow problem (UK 2026 / US 2020)
LexisNexis Bellwether 2026, 568 respondents LexisNexis [8]; Thomson Reuters 2020 TR [5]

97 days
lock-up: 38 days unbilled plus 45 days unpaid (US median firm, 2023)
Clio Legal Trends 2023 via Legal Futures [17]

46%
of Legal Ombudsman complaint types are communication (24%) plus delay (22%)
14,259 complaints, 2025/26 (+37%) Legal Ombudsman [82]

123 days
UK purchase conveyance, instruction to completion (75 in 2007; ideal 6.78 weeks)
2025 figure, +64% since 2007 Legal Futures [69]

59%
of UK fee earners admit using unapproved AI tools; 68% of leaders see 'zero risk'
Censuswide for Access Legal, 200 respondents, Apr 2026 Legal Futures [172] vendor survey

524 → 668
AI-fabricated filings in US courts, 2025 → 2026 to July; 97 monetary sanctions in 2025
Charlotin tracker via MSBA [167] secondary

$49–$119
Clio per user per month (published); Filevine quote-only, est. $80–$120 small firm
PricingSaaS [225] 3p; Oktopeak [233]

The twelve gaps, ranked by problem signal and vendor weakness

#	Gap	Problem signal	Vendor coverage	Automatable	Country
1	Confidential document work (summarise, draft, improve) without a public AI tool	Very high	Medium-weak for small firms	Partly	UK and US
2	PI provider-list reconciliation and records completeness at the intake handoff	High	Weak	Partly	US (UK PI smaller)
3	Case-management configuration validation and exception reports (Clio, LEAP, Filevine)	High	Weak	Fully for detection	UK and US
4	UK court bundles to PD27A and tribunal rules	High	Medium	Largely	UK
5	AML risk-assessment reasoning and source-of-funds analysis on file	High	Weak on the reasoning	Partly	UK
6	Immigration evidence packets and RFE/RFI deadline tracking	High	Medium-weak	Partly	US and UK
7	Chasing clients and third parties for documents and money	Very high	Medium	Partly	UK and US
8	Land Registry requisitions and post-completion checks	Medium-high	Medium	Largely	UK
9	Criminal defence discovery video review	Medium	Unknown	Partly	US (UK unsourced)
10	Client-account and trust reconciliation errors and accounting sync	High	Strong on bookkeeping; weak on catching sync and reconciliation anomalies	Partly	UK and US
11	Legal aid billing (CCMS, LAA contingency reconciliation, fee re-coding)	High but niche	Medium	Partly	UK
12	Family financial disclosure assembly (Form E, financial affidavit)	Medium	Medium	Partly	UK and US

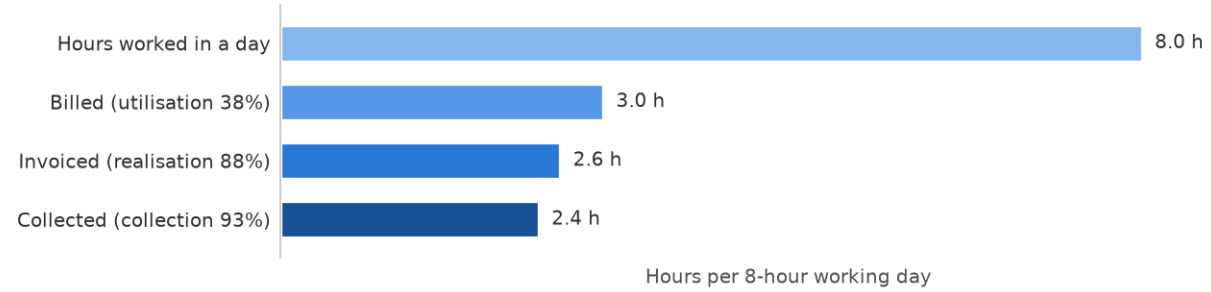
Crowded areas that are **not** gaps: intake call answering and lead follow-up; medical chronologies and demand letters; dictation and transcription (section 9).

SECTION 1

Lawyers bill three hours of eight; the rest is admin and chasing

The time problem is chronic, not new, and it is worse the smaller the firm: nearly two-thirds of a US lawyer's day is not billed, a UK SME fee earner records 773 chargeable hours against a 1,100-hour target, and 'administrative tasks' is the number-one complaint in both countries.

Of 8 hours worked, 3.0 are billed, 2.6 invoiced and 2.4 collected (US firms on Clio, 2025)

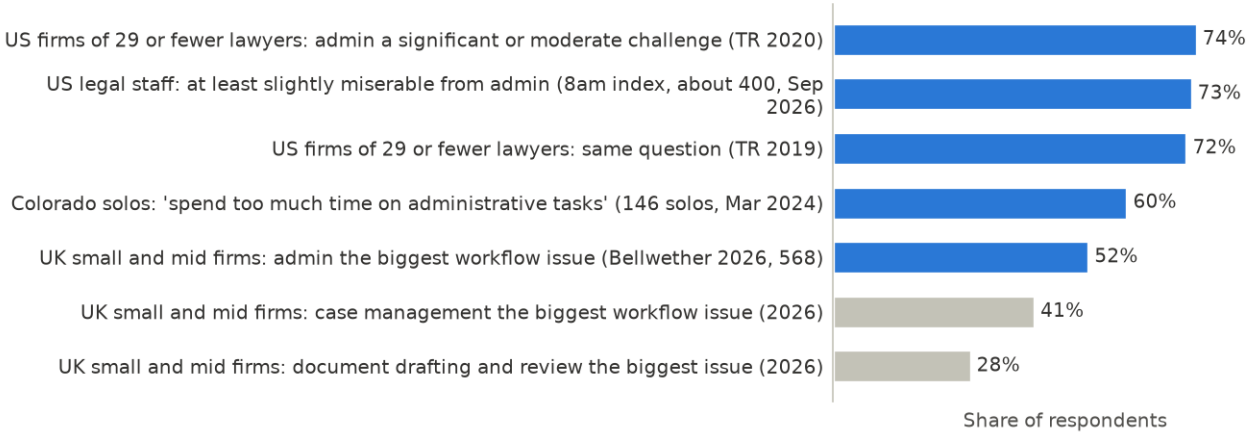


Source: Clio Legal Trends benchmarks 2025 [1] (seen in search snippets); utilisation 38%, realisation 88%, collection 93%. In 2017 the figure was 2.3 billed hours (29%) [3].

Hours: what is billed, invoiced and collected

- US utilisation rose from **29% (2.3 hours a day) in 2017** to **38% (3.0 hours) in 2025**; realisation of 88% and collection of 93% shrink the 3.0 hours to **2.4 hours of cash per day** (LawNext, 25 Mar 2019 [3]; Clio benchmarks [1] snippet).
- Solos are a full step behind: **25% utilisation (about 2 hours a day) against 36% for non-solos**, which is 211 fewer billed hours a year over 240 working days; 54% of solos work Saturdays (Clio, Legal Trends for Solo Law Firms, 2023 [4]).
- Thomson Reuters, firms with 29 or fewer lawyers: time spent practising law **60% (2020), 56% (2022), 61% (2023)**; admin a significant or moderate challenge for **72% to 74%**; only about **20%** had any plan to act on it (TR, Sep 2020 [5]; Legal IT Insider, Nov 2022 [6]; LawNext, Nov 2023 [7]).
- UK, LexisNexis Bellwether 2026 (568 legal professionals): **52% named administrative tasks the biggest workflow issue, 41% case management, 28% document drafting and review**; service 'still depends on stretched teams, manual processes and inefficient workflows behind the scenes' (LexisNexis pressroom, 18 May 2026 [8]).
- Sharpest single UK number: **43% of a conveyancer's time is spent 'chasing stakeholders or being chased'**, up from 39% a year earlier (Legal Futures, 29 Oct 2024 [9]).

Admin is the number-one complaint in both countries: 52% to 74% of small firms name it



Sources: Thomson Reuters 2020 [5]; Above the Law / 8am index Sep 2026 [12] (secondary); Law Week Colorado 2024 [11]; LexisNexis Bellwether 2026 [8]. Different surveys and question wording; bars are indicative, not strictly comparable.

Table 1.1 Time measures, population and date

Measure	Figure	Population and date	Source
Billable hours per 8-hour day (US)	2.3 h (29%) in 2017; 2.5 h in 2021; 2.9 h (37%) in 2024; 3.0 h (38%) in 2025	Clio platform users, mostly small firms	LawNext 2019 [3]; LeanLaw [10] secondary; Clio benchmarks [1] snippet
Hours collected per day (US)	3.0 billed, 2.6 invoiced, 2.4 collected	Clio 2025	Clio benchmarks [1] snippet
Solo vs non-solo utilisation	25% (about 2 h) vs 36% (2.9 h); 211 fewer hours a year	Clio survey, 2022	Clio solo report [4]
Time practising law, US small firms	60% (2019-20), 56% (2021-22), 61% (2023)	Thomson Reuters, 29 or fewer lawyers	TR 2020 [5]; Legal IT Insider 2022 [6]; LawNext 2023 [7]
Admin a significant or moderate challenge (US)	72% (2019), 74% (2020); 20% have a plan to reduce it	Thomson Reuters	TR 2020 [5]
Colorado solos, top challenge	59.86% "spend too much time on administrative tasks"; about 20% spend 75%+ of time on law; about 60% employ no staff	146 solos, Mar 2024	Law Week Colorado [11]
Biggest workflow issue (UK)	Admin 52%, case management 41%, drafting and review 28%; 9% rate overheads "excellent"	Bellwether 2026, 568 respondents	LexisNexis [8]
Conveyancer time chasing (UK)	43% (39% in 2023); 53% say completion time is the top frustration; 47% regulatory burden	100 conveyancers, Oct 2024	Legal Futures [9]
Chargeable hours per fee earner (UK)	Median 773 vs target 1,100-1,300; £146,000 fee income per fee earner	145 SME firms, FY2024	Legal Futures, Mar 2025 [2]
Admin misery (US)	73% at least slightly miserable from admin; 82% lose billable time weekly; almost 60% work extra hours; 80% "Sunday scaries"	about 400 legal staff, 8am index	Above the Law, Sep 2026 [12] secondary
Admin hours lost per week (US-heavy)	89.3% lose 5+ hours; 34.2% lose 10-15; 25.2% lose 15+	532 users of a consumer legal-AI product, Jul 2026	AI Lawyer [13] vendor, self-selected
Share of billable work that is "documenting"	26% of billable time; Clio says 74% of billable tasks could be automated	Clio 2024	2Civility [14] secondary

Money: why the lost time hurts

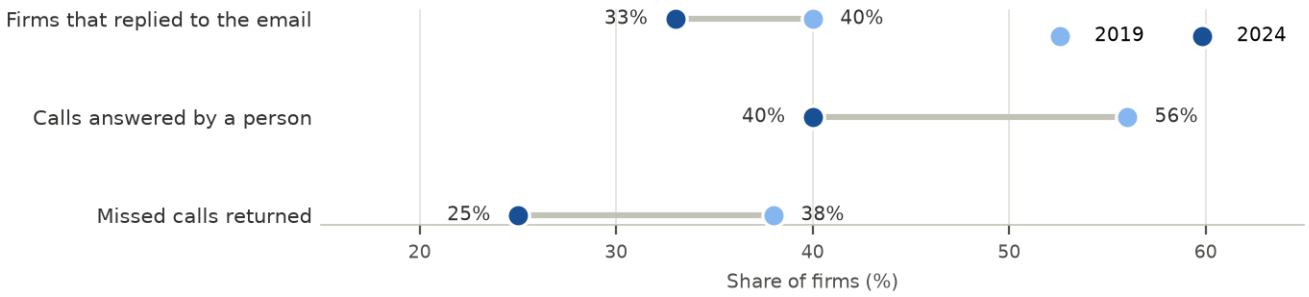
- Median UK SME firm: £146,000 of fee income per fee earner, **27% net profit (down from 31.4%)**, staff costs 39.4% of fees, PII 5.1% (Armstrong Watson, Feb 2026 [15]); underlying profit grew just **1.2%** once client-account interest was stripped out (Legal Futures, Mar 2025 [2]).
- PII: a sole practice pays a median **£7,383 (6% of turnover)**, a conveyancing firm **£50,000 (8%)**; only **28% of firms with up to 25 partners, and 9% of sole practitioners, hold cyber insurance** (Legal Futures, 21 Jul 2023 [16]).
- US: the median firm carried **97 days of lock-up** in 2023 (38 days unbilled plus 45 days unpaid); **41% of lawyers said clients pay late and 24% said many never pay**; almost one in three admitted the firm takes too long to send bills (Legal Futures, 20 Dec 2023 [17]); in 2022 the average firm collected only **$748 of every $1,000 of billable work** (2Civility, 14 Oct 2022 [18]).
- Staff are cheap to pay and expensive to lose: UK legal secretary £23,000 to £28,000, paralegal £22,000 to £27,000 (Ten Percent Legal, Nov 2025 [19], a recruiter's list); US paralegal median **$62,890** with about **40,800 openings a year**, almost all from turnover (BLS [20]); replacing one support-staff member costs **$10,000 to $40,000, sometimes $80,000** (Legal Futures, 2 Aug 2023 [21]).
- Practice-management software costs about **$81 per user per month** on average (Clio $49 to $159, MyCase $39 to $49) (CostBench [22] snippet): a three-user subscription is under $3,000 a year against a $30,000-plus paralegal replacement.

The intake leak

- Clio's 2024 mystery shop of 500 US firms: **only 33% replied to an email and 40% answered the phone**, **48% were effectively unreachable by phone**, just **12% of shoppers would recommend the firm**; all worse than 2019 (40%, 56%) (2Civility, 1 Nov 2024 [23]; 2Civility, 23 Oct 2019 [24]).
- UK secret-shopper exercise of 100 calls: **45%** of callers would not engage the firm because of poor service (Law Gazette [25] snippet).

- UK clients want same-day responses (**84%**) and weekly updates (**82%**); more than a third of repeat users did not return to the same firm (Legal Futures, 22 Jan 2025 [26]).

Lead response got worse between Clio's 2019 and 2024 mystery shops of US firms



Sources: 2Civility on Clio Legal Trends 2019 [24] (1,000 emailed, 500 called) and 2024 [23] (500 firms). 2024: 48% effectively unreachable by phone; 12% of shoppers would recommend the firm; 7% of firms use a website chatbot.

Table 1.2 Lead-response measures, Clio secret shopper

Lead-response measure (US, Clio secret shopper)	2019 (1,000 emailed, 500 called)	2024 (500 firms)
Firms that replied to the email	40%	33%
Calls answered by a person	56%	40%
Missed calls returned	38%	25%
Neither answered nor called back	more than half did not return voicemail within 72 h	48%
Shoppers who would recommend the firm	not reported	12% (73% would not)
Firms using a website chatbot	not reported	7%

Sources: 2Civility 2019 [24]; 2Civility 2024 [23]; Answering Legal summary [27] secondary.

SECTION 2

Their own words: the UK "chases", the US does "intake"

The two markets describe the same pain with different nouns. Autocomplete and job boards match on the noun, not the complaint, so a keyword list must follow the split: the UK 'chases' and talks about 'fee earners', 'bundles', 'SRA' and 'PII'; the US does 'intake', 'non-billable', 'calendaring', 'IOLTA' and 'e-filing'.

UK words

- The dominant verb is **'chasing'**: clients for 'ID or payments on account', lenders for 'mortgage offers', local authorities for 'Local Searches', management packs, the other side's 'enquiries' (Property Industry Eye, 29 Mar 2021 [28]).
- People are **'fee earners'** and **'support staff'**; costs are **'PII'**, **'run-off cover'**, **'SRA fees'**, **'AML'**, **'Legal Aid'**.
- Litigation pain is the **'bundle'**, its **'pagination'**, whether it is **'CPR compliant'**, and the rule that it be lodged **'no less than three working days before the hearing'** (Deka Chambers, 6 Oct 2023 [29]).

> 'All admin, file opening, compliance tasks and IT issues fall on you' ... 'AML, SRA compliance, conflict checks, audits, and complaints' ... 'client accounts, reconciliations, breaches, billing, credit control'
>
> A UK sole practitioner's own list of burdens (Jonathan Lea Network [30], a platform-firm marketing page)

US words

- The vocabulary is time and cash: **'non-billable administrative work'**, defined by one survey as 'intake, email follow-up, matter creation, deadlines, and billing preparation'; **'worked time never reaches the invoice'**; **'getting paid by clients'**; **'trust account' / 'IOLTA'**; **'e-filing'**; **'calendaring'** (AI Lawyer [13] vendor; Law Week Colorado [11]).
- Staff titles: **'paralegal'**, **'legal assistant'**, **'case manager'**, **'intake specialist'**; none appear in UK ads.

> Email, texts and social messages 'began to drive me a little batty'; the public's number-one complaint is 'lack of attorney-client communication'; 'the real issue is overwhelm'
>
> US solo (Toya Gavin, May 2018 [31])

> 'Communication' is 'the big culprit'; tasks that 'made me want to throw my laptop across the room'
>
> A Different Practice, Aug 2025 [32]

> The hated jobs: 'entering time, scheduling meetings, chasing unpaid invoices, and wrestling with administrative forms', 'revising incomprehensible billing entries' and 'writing dunning letters to non-paying clients'
>
> Above the Law columnist, September 2026 (Above the Law [12])

Table 2.1 High-signal markers by theme (keyword list)

Theme	UK words (high-signal markers)	US words (high-signal markers)
The lawyer and staff	solicitor, fee earner, support staff, legal secretary, legal cashier, COLP, COFA, paralegal, caseworker (OISC), legal executive (CILEX)	attorney, lawyer, paralegal, legal assistant, case manager, intake specialist, biller, receptionist
The file	matter, caseload ("70-80 residential conveyancing matters"), file opening and closing	case, matter, caseload "from intake through settlement", matter opening
Money	client account, office account, PII, run-off, credit control, lock-up, WIP, fixed fee, legal aid rates, pricing pressure	trust account, IOLTA, operating account, retainer, collections, write-off, realization, lockup, flat fee, contingency
Property	conveyancing, instruction, searches, exchange, completion, completion statement, SDLT, Land Registry, requisitions, contract pack, lender panel, management pack	closing, escrow, title company, title search, deed preparation, earnest money
Litigation	bundle, pagination, index, CPR, PD27A, skeleton, grounds, disclosure, "three working days before the hearing", costs order	trial binder, exhibit package, discovery, interrogatories, requests for production, depositions, e-filing, motions, pleadings

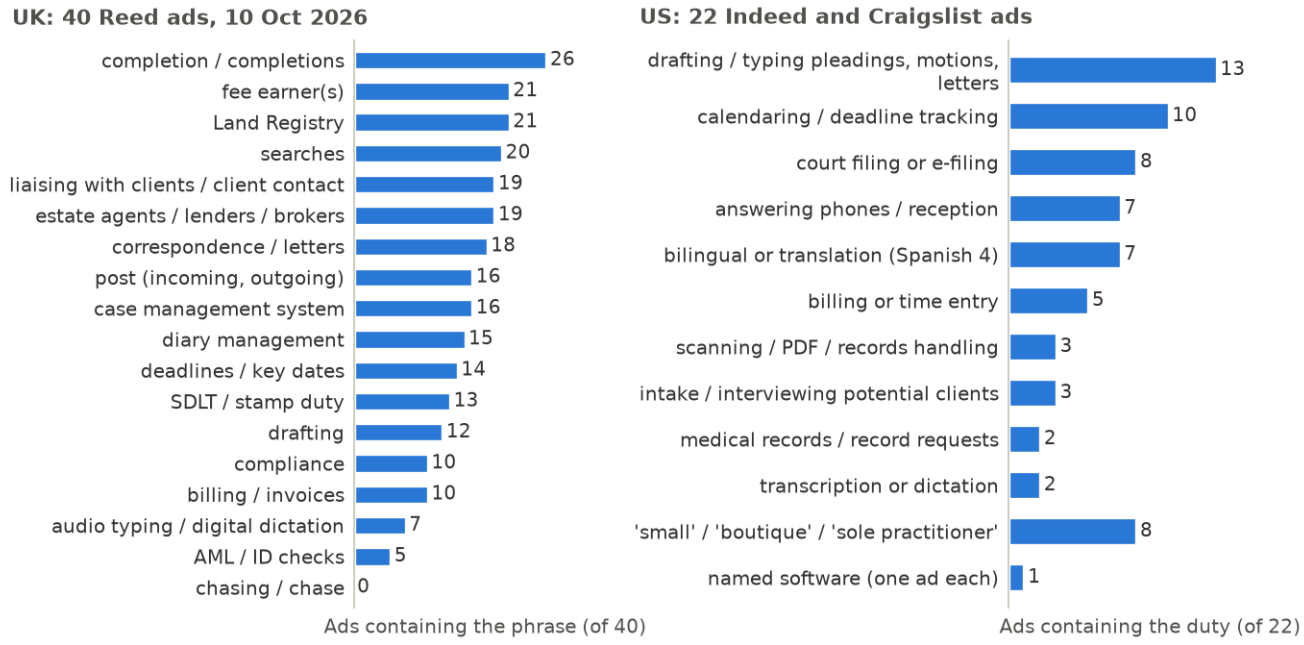
Theme	UK words (high-signal markers)	US words (high-signal markers)
Private client	private client, wills, LPA, grant of probate, IHT400, PA1P, estate accounts, statutory adverts	estate planning, trusts, probate, inventory (60 days), guardianship, trust funding
Immigration	Home Office, UKVI, OISC Level 1/2/3, Skilled Worker, Sponsor Licence, RFI, Upper Tribunal, e-bundle	USCIS, EOIR, I-130, I-485, N-400, G-28, RFE/NOID, consular processing, DS-160
Documents	precedent (meaning a model document), audio typing, digital dictation, Land Registry portal	template, transcription, dictation, PDF manipulation, scanning
Quality marks	Lexcel, CQS, CLC, SRA number, Cyber Essentials	OCA compliance, CLE, bar licence, notary public
The firm	high-street firm, private practice, sole practitioner, "small, friendly practice"	solo, boutique, "our small law office", "small but growing", "wearing many hats"
The pain verb	chasing, being chased, stretched teams, firefighting, "admin crap"	follow up, intake, non-billable, admin, "keep the file moving", "catch what slips"

Sources: Reed conveyancing paralegal ads [33]; Reed 57356370 [34]; Huggins Lewis Foskett [35]; Mallory Pryce [36]; ILFM [37]; Indeed US legal assistant [38]; Indeed US paralegal [39]; Craigslist Los Angeles legal [40]; Penningtons Manches Cooper [41]; SRA Accounts Rules [42]; Wikipedia: IOLTA [43].

What job advertisements pay people to do

- Job ads are the best proxy for what firms would pay a service to do. A scrape of **40 live UK Reed ads on 10 October 2026** (25 conveyancing paralegal, 15 legal secretary, salaries mostly £25,000 to £30,000) is dominated by process-stage words: **'completion' in 26 ads, 'fee earner' in 21, 'Land Registry' in 21, 'searches' in 20**, 'liaising with clients, estate agents, lenders' in 19; 'audio typing / digital dictation' still in 7; **'chasing' in zero ads**; no case-management brand named (Reed conveyancing paralegal jobs [33]; Reed 57348435 [44]). UK firms write ads around the stage of the matter, not the task type.
- The **22 US ads** read in full (14 Indeed samples plus 8 Craigslist Manhattan postings) are built around litigation mechanics and the front desk: **drafting or typing pleadings in 13, calendaring deadlines in 10, e-filing in 8, answering phones in 7, bilingual (mostly Spanish) in 7**, billing or time entry in 5, intake in 3 (Indeed US paralegal [39]; Craigslist Dweck Law posting [45]).
- The Los Angeles Craigslist board alone had 94 legal postings with 'personal injury' in 9 titles, 'workers comp' in 9 and 'PI CASE MANAGER' twice (Craigslist Los Angeles legal [40]).

UK ads are written around the stage of the matter ('completion', 'Land Registry'); US ads around litigation mechanics and the front desk



Sources: scrape of 40 live UK Reed ads, 10 Oct 2026 [33] (25 conveyancing paralegal, 15 legal secretary; 'chasing' in 0 ads, no case-management brand named); manual count over 22 US ads (14 Indeed samples, 8 Craigslist Manhattan) [39] [40]. Both counts are indicative, not statistical.

Table 2.2 Phrase counts in UK and US ads

Phrase in UK ads (of 40 Reed ads, 10 Oct 2026)	Ads	Phrase in US ads (of 22 ads read)	Ads
completion / completions	26	drafting, typing or editing pleadings, motions, correspondence	13
fee earner(s)	21	calendaring / deadline tracking	10
Land Registry	21	court filing or e-filing	8
searches	20	answering phones / reception	7
liaising with clients / client contact	19	bilingual or translation (Spanish 4, Korean 1, Mandarin 1)	7
estate agents / lenders / brokers	19	billing or time entry	5
correspondence / letters	18	scanning / PDF / records handling	3
post (incoming, outgoing)	16	intake / interviewing potential clients	3
case management system	16	medical records / record requests	2
diary management	15	transcription or dictation	2
deadlines / key dates	14	"small", "boutique", "sole practitioner" self-description	8
SDLT / stamp duty	13	named software (Clio, MyCase, Timeslips, MDEC, CaseFileXpress, iManage, Aderant)	1 each
drafting	12		
compliance	10		
billing / invoices	10		
opening / closing files	8		
scanning / photocopying / printing	7		
audio typing / digital dictation	7		
AML / ID checks	5		
time recording / chargeable	3		
court forms / bundles	3		
chasing / chase	0		
precedent / templates	0		
named case-management brand	0		

Sources: UK scrape of Reed [33] and Reed legal secretary [46] listings; US manual count over Indeed legal assistant [38], Indeed paralegal [39] and Craigslist postings such as Senior Legal Assistant, PI [47] and Court Calendar Clerk [48]. Both counts are indicative, not statistical.

How lawyers phrase their searches (Google autocomplete, 10 October 2026)

- Lawyers search in **noun phrases and job titles, not in complaint sentences**. UK and US settings returned near-identical lists.
- The seeds 'how to stop chasing clients' and 'law firm too much admin' returned **nothing**; 'chasing clients for' returned only 'chasing clients for payment'.
- The AI question is asked in the lawyer's own role word and in product-tier words: the worry is specifically whether a **paid tier changes confidentiality** (Google suggest, 'is chatgpt confidential' [49]).
- Search volumes are unknown; only the suggestion order was captured.

Table 2.3 Autocomplete suggestions, verbatim (use as keywords)

Seed	Autocomplete suggestions (verbatim)
can lawyers use chatgpt	can lawyers use chatgpt; do lawyers use chatgpt; do lawyers use chatgpt reddit; should lawyers use chatgpt; can solicitors use chatgpt; do solicitors use chatgpt
is chatgpt confidential	...and secure; ...reddit; ...at all; ...for therapy; is chatgpt plus confidential; is chatgpt enterprise confidential; is chatgpt business confidential; is paid chatgpt confidential
secure chatgpt for	secure chatgpt for business; security for chatgpt; chatgpt safe for work; chatgpt safe for business
ai for solicitors	ai for solicitors uk; best ai for solicitors; ai tools for solicitors; ai courses for solicitors; ai policy for solicitors; ai software for solicitors; ai training for solicitors; ai guidance for solicitors ("ai for law firms" returned nothing)
law firm automation	law firm automation software; law firm automation reddit; law office automation; law firm ai automation; law firm workflow automation; law firm document automation; law firm intake automation
legal document automation	...software; ...jobs; ...tools; ...specialist; ...ai; legal document management software

Seed	Autocomplete suggestions (verbatim)
court bundle (UK only)	court bundle example; court bundle template uk; court bundle software; court bundle practice direction; court bundle index template; court bundles in family proceedings; court bundle maker; court bundle cover page; court bundle preparation
time recording solicitors	time recording law firms; time recording lawyers; solicitors time recording rules; solicitors time recording units
law firm billing	...jobs; ...software; ...jobs remote; ...specialist; ...chart; ...codes; ...increments; ...rates
law firm intake	law firm intake specialist; ...specialist jobs; ...specialist remote jobs; law firm intake form; law firm intake specialist job description; law firm intake form template
hire a paralegal	hire a paralegal near me; ...for divorce; ...virtual assistant; ...small claims court; ...online; hire a freelance paralegal; hire a remote paralegal
legal virtual assistant	...jobs; ...hiring; ...jobs remote; ...training; ...job description; ...services; ...salary; legal virtual assistant philippines
outsource legal	outsource legal department; outsource legal work; outsource legal assistant; outsource legal billing; outsource legal cashier; outsource legal drafting
paralegal shortage	paralegal shortage; what is the demand for paralegals; are paralegals in high demand; why do paralegals make so little
solo attorney / sole practitioner solicitor	solo attorney malpractice insurance cost; solo attorney reddit; solo attorney health insurance; sole practitioner solicitor indemnity insurance; sole practitioner solicitor uk

Source: Google suggest endpoint calls such as ai for solicitors [50], court bundle [51], law firm automation [52], outsource legal [53].

What firms buy on freelance boards, and at what price

- Upwork law-firm-side posts (nearly all US) are for intake calls, 'keep the file moving' administration, immigration form preparation and PI case management. Their words: 'Following up with clients for missing documents, signatures, and information', 'Making repeated follow-up calls and sending messages when clients do not respond', 'so I can focus on legal work and business development', 'so our paralegal can focus on substantive casework' (Upwork legal-assistance jobs [54]; Upwork immigration-law jobs [55]).
- One PI case-manager post wants someone who will 'Order police reports', 'Open insurance claims', 'Communicate with insurance adjusters', 'Prepare demand packages' and 'Coordinate lien reductions', with 'Clio Manage', 'Clio Grow' and 'AI tools (ChatGPT, Claude, Gemini)' as preferred experience (Upwork [54]).
- UK firms are almost absent as buyers: PeoplePerHour's 'Legal Services' board on 10 October 2026 held 20 projects, every one a consumer or small business seeking a solicitor, none a firm seeking support (PeoplePerHour legal services [56]).
- Fiverr organises supply into landing pages titled '24 Best Paralegal Services To Buy Online', '24 Best Clio Automation Services', '24 Best Clio Grow Services' and '24 Best Legal Automation Services', which indicates measurable buyer search for brand-name set-up help; Fiverr blocked every fetch, so review counts and texts could not be read (Fiverr Clio automation [57]; Fiverr paralegal [58]).

Table 2.4 Work bought on freelance boards and prices seen

Work bought on freelance boards	Price seen	Where and when	Source
Remote legal admin assistant (US firm partner, 10 h/week)	$10-$25/hour, paid 2-hour test task	Upwork, 8 Oct 2026	Upwork [54]
Daily accountability partner for a law-firm partner	$5-$14/hour	Upwork, 7 Oct 2026	Upwork [54]
AI automation developer, estate-planning firm (Clio Grow + Manage, Zapier, Claude/OpenAI APIs; first priority "dashboards that pull Clio data")	$15-$35/hour, under 30 h/week, 1-3 months, contract to hire	Upwork, Oct 2026	Upwork [59] snippet
Criminal-defence paralegal (witness interviews)	$50/hour (6-8 bids)	Freelancer.com, Oct 2026	Freelancer [60]
Attorney to review and send pre-written demand letters	$75 per letter	Upwork, 8 Oct 2026	Upwork [61]
Paid consult on how medical chronologies are built and priced	$150 for 30 minutes, $100 written	Upwork, 8 Oct 2026	Upwork [61]
SEO for an immigration firm ("deportation lawyer", Houston)	$2,000 for first page	Upwork, 4 Oct 2026	Upwork [55]
Upwork project tiers for legal VAs	research $1,000-$2,000; drafting $2,000-$3,500; intake coordination $3,500-$5,000; trial support $5,000-$8,000	Upwork hire page	Upwork [62] vendor page

Work bought on freelance boards	Price seen	Where and when	Source
Chatbot integration / AI intake voice agents for law firms	$1,200-$4,500 per project; maintenance $500-$2,500	Upwork hire pages	Upwork [63] snippet
Fiverr "virtual paralegal / legal assistant for solo attorneys and pro se"	from $10-$100	Fiverr	Fiverr [58] snippet
Fiverr Clio set-up, automation, training gigs	$10, $15, $50, $75	Fiverr	Fiverr gig [64]; Fiverr gig [65] snippet
Fiverr "AI legal assistant" build with "custom RAG knowledge base"	$850	Fiverr	Fiverr gig [66]
Fiverr custom RAG chatbots for documents	from about $60	Fiverr	Fiverr chatbots [67] snippet
UK PeoplePerHour: solicitor for flat sale; non-compete; ET interview	£2,500 fixed; £50/hour; £250 fixed	PPH (consumer buyers)	PPH [68]

SECTION 3

Every practice area is a forms-and-deadlines loop run on someone else's clock

In every practice area and both countries the firm's controllable work is front-loaded (intake, identity, authorisations, the first deadline) and back-loaded (filing, registration, disbursement); the middle is weeks or months of waiting on a court, registry, agency, bank, insurer or medical provider, while the file must be kept alive, the client updated and the deadline watched.

Step marks in the two workflow tables: **M** manual, **R** repetitive, **D** document-heavy, **T** deadline-driven. The marks are the researcher's reading of the sources, not a survey result.

UK practice areas: steps, numbers, sources

Table 3.1 UK workflows

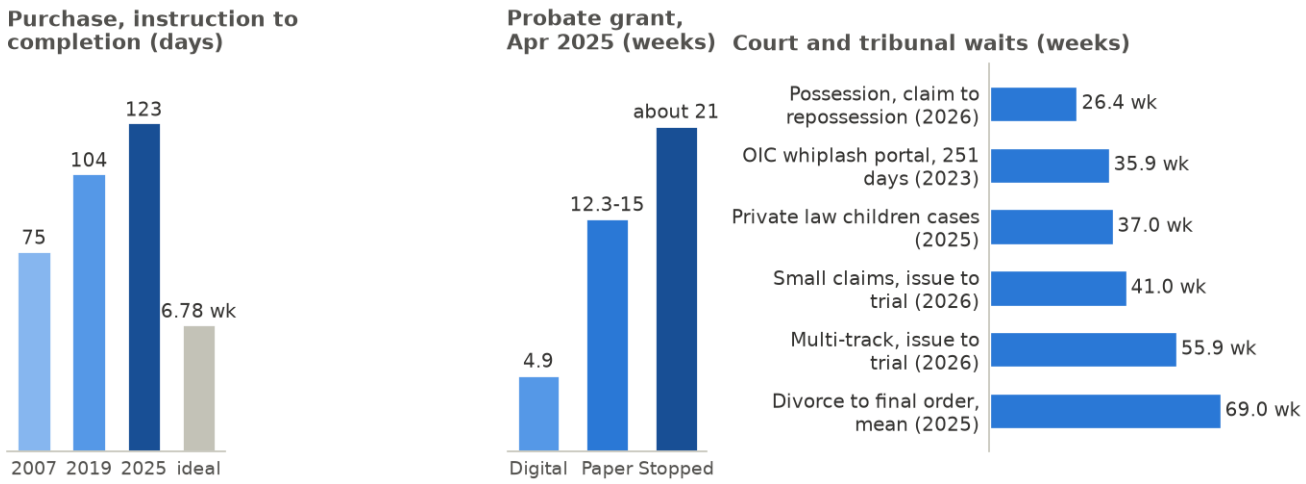
UK practice area	Steps in order (marks)	Numbers from the notes	Source
Residential conveyancing	Instruction and online quote; ID, AML and source-of-funds evidence (M, D); submit searches and wait (local authority 10 working days to 3-5 weeks); mortgage offer wait (2-6 weeks); raise and chase enquiries, TA6/TA10 forms (M, R, D); exchange; completion statement and funds (M, D); SDLT return within 14 days (T); AP1 to Land Registry with correct names and scans (D, T); answer requisitions	123 days instruction to completion (2025, +64% since 2007); consumer ideal 6.78 weeks; 43% of time chasing; caseloads of 70-80 matters per fee earner snippet; 32.2% of register updates take over 3 months; complex applications mostly up to 12 months; roughly one million requisitions a year, over half avoidable, each adding 2-6 weeks snippet; 57% of firms now under a 5% avoidable-requisition rate, some still under 30%; conveyancing is 36% of accepted Legal Ombudsman complaints	Legal Futures, 3 Feb 2026 [69]; Carbon Law Partners [70]; GOV.UK SDLT [71]; HMLR processing times [72]; HMLR requisitions, Dec 2025 [73]; Mortgage Solutions, Jan 2023 [74] snippet; findajob.dwp.gov.uk [75] snippet
AML on every conveyance	Client and matter risk assessment with written reasoning (M, D); CDD and electronic verification; source-of-funds collected and analysed (M, D); file review	SRA 2024-25: almost a third of firms examined non-compliant, 54% partially; 16% of files had no risk assessment, 39% an ineffective one; source-of-funds checks "often collected but not analysed"; 35+ fines totalling £565,000+ by late 2025 vendor article	Legal Futures, 7 Jan 2026 [76]; Today's Conveyancer, 11 May 2026 [77]
Wills, probate, estate administration	Instructions and questionnaire; IHT400 with wet-ink signature, wait for HMRC code (D, T: allow 20 working days); PA1P/PA1A online or paper; chase banks, share registrars, pensions for date-of-death balances (M, R); statutory adverts; estate accounts; distribution after 2 months from adverts and 6 months from grant	Digital grant 4.9 weeks, paper 12.3-15 weeks, stopped cases about 21 weeks; "some digital grants in less than 24 hours"; 9,000 stops in 2022 from incorrect IHT400s snippet; a stopped case takes "more than double" the admin time; a small firm's estate takes 6-9 months; grant-only fixed fees £500-£950 plus VAT, administration £2,500-£4,500; poor service found in 79% of assessed wills-and-probate complaints	ICAEW, Jun 2025 [78]; ICAEW, Sep 2025 [79]; Burton & Co probate pricing [80]; Myerson [81] snippet; Legal Ombudsman 2025/26 [82]
Family (private law, financial remedy)	Form E financial disclosure from client documents (M, D); for every hearing: agree bundle index 7 working days out, lodge e-bundle 5 working days out, fresh position statement with page caps, file by 11am the day before (D, T; costs sanctions); legal aid certificate work through CCMS	PD27A rewritten from 2 March 2026, about twice the old length; "a new bundle is needed for each subsequent hearing"; position-statement caps 6/8/12/15 pages; private law children cases average 37 weeks; divorce application to final order mean 69 weeks; median family legal aid provider at break-even on fees frozen since 1996 snippet	Resolution guidance note [83]; Financial Remedies Journal [84]; MoJ Family Court Statistics Oct-Dec 2025 [85]; Law Society sustainability research [86] snippet
Immigration	Home Office application and evidence; answer requests for further information (M, D, T); tribunal e-bundle as a single OCR'd PDF under 50 MB with bookmarks and continuous pagination (D, T; non-compliant bundles "likely to be rejected"); deadlines set by the Home Office and Tribunal, not the firm	Requests for further information rose from 15% to 49% of one charity's applications (2020 to 2024), each adding about a month; processing 29 days to ten weeks; an anonymous solicitor: "it's incredibly hard to plan your week" snippet; none of 24 swept high-street sites in the target cities listed immigration	Free Movement, 19 Feb 2025 [87]; EIN, UT IAC e-bundles [88]; Law Society [89] snippet
Personal injury and clinical negligence	Phone-first "No Win No Fee" intake; find the other insurer (askMID £10 one-off search); police reference from client; Official Injury Claim (OIC) portal re-keying for low-value claims (R); medical evidence; fixed recoverable costs bands	OIC: 349,000 unresolved claims, 251 days average to settle (2023); 90% of claimants still represented; FRC covers most £25,000-£100,000 claims; fixed costs for clinical negligence up to £25,000 expected to push small firms out; PI is 14% of accepted LeO complaints; PI and clin-neg firms cite cybersecurity more than any other area (35%)	Legal Ombudsman horizon scan, Oct 2023 [90]; askMID [91]; OIC start a claim [92]; Legal Futures, 14 Aug 2026 [93]

UK practice area	Steps in order (marks)	Numbers from the notes	Source
Employment	ACAS early conciliation, now 12 weeks (T); ET1; diarise limitation; wait	515,000 open claims (52,000 single); receipts 26,000 vs disposals 10,000 in a quarter; longer hearings listed into 2028; 66% of ACAS notifications never become an ET1; open single claims up 33% in a year	Higgs LLP [94]; ACAS statistics [95]; BCLP, Mar 2026 [96]
Criminal and legal aid billing	Police station attendance and fixed-fee claim (R, T); magistrates' and Crown work; claims through LAA systems (CCMS, Crime Apply); re-code billing for new rates	Police station fee harmonised to £320 from 22 Dec 2025; LAA cyber-attack (May 2025) forced dummy MAAT number 900900, delegated authority ending 30 Sep 2025, "Submit a Bulk Claim" live 4 Feb 2026; duty solicitors down 25% (1,317 fewer) 2017-2024; CCMS bills "more likely to be rejected" and "significant delays to payment" (2015 warning)	Access Group, D25 rates [97]; GOV.UK LAA incident [98]; MoJ criminal consultation [99]; Family Law on CCMS, 2015 [100]
Landlord and tenant possession	Section 8 notice (Section 21 gone from 1 May 2026); PCOL online only for rent arrears, otherwise paper N5 and N119 posted or emailed (D); "A complete court bundle is needed"; warrant and bailiffs	Median 26.4 weeks claim to repossession (Jan-Mar 2026); 32.5 weeks in Q1 2025; 96% of landlords had little confidence courts can cope	GOV.UK possession [101]; OTS Solicitors [102]; NRLA [103]
Debt recovery	Posted Letter of Claim with statement of account, information sheet, reply form and financial statement (D); wait 30 days, possibly another 30; issue online or paper; judgment request or defence	Court fees from £35 (up to £300) to 5% (£10,000-£200,000); SRA requires published prices for business debt recovery up to £100,000	Pre-Action Protocol for Debt Claims [104]; GOV.UK court fees [105]; SRA Transparency Rules [106]
Overhead on every file	Written client-care and complaints information at engagement; conflict check; bill before any client-account transfer; bank statements and a three-way reconciliation at least every five weeks signed by the COFA (R, T); 8-week complaints clock; accountant's report within six months; six-year record retention; annual competence declaration; PII renewal	Common reconciliation failures: aged items carried for months, receipts on the wrong ledger, duplicate entries, "reconciling to zero and moving on"; firms with fewer than 10 partners spent 27 days a year on compliance (2011, dated)	SRA Code of Conduct [107]; SRA Accounts Rules [42]; Legal Futures on ILFM, May 2026 [108]; Legal Futures, 2011 [109]

The UK courts have shifted format risk onto firms

- Administrative Court user-group minutes: CE-File sets the fee automatically, 'applications were being rejected because an incorrect fee had been used', and 'once the application is rejected there is no way of resurrecting it' (Judiciary.uk minutes, 10 Feb 2025 [110]).
- A City solicitor who built a free bundling tool: 'It should be simple to prepare a bundle manually, but it's not'; it is 'a high-pressured task, shaped by conventions and certain rules' where 'human error creeps into the process'; his tool saves 'up to an hour per bundle' (Legal Futures, 8 Apr 2026 [111]).
- The cost of getting it wrong: a bundle 'randomly thrown together' with replies '2,000 or 4,000 pages apart' drew a **£20,000 costs order**; a claimant who missed the bundle deadline blamed 'IT problems, lack of support staff, and miscommunications' and was refused relief; a judge called it 'dangerous to leave matters to the last minute' (Deka Chambers, 6 Oct 2023 [29]).

UK waits the firm cannot control: a purchase takes 123 days, paper probate 12 to 15 weeks, a multi-track trial 56 weeks



Sources: Legal Futures Feb 2026 [69]; ICAEW Jun 2025 [78]; MoJ family and civil statistics 2025-26 [85] [115]; OTS Solicitors [102]; Legal Ombudsman horizon scan 2023 [90]. Consumer ideal for a purchase is 6.78 weeks. Employment tribunal hearings are listed into 2028.

Table 3.2 UK queues and clocks

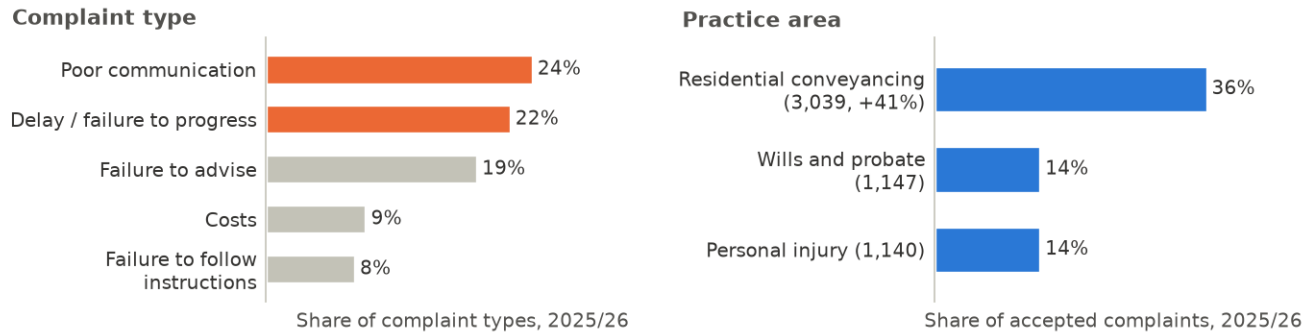
UK queue or clock	Figure	Date	Source
Probate grant, digital	4.9 weeks (peak 14 weeks); some under 24 hours	Apr 2025	ICAEW [78]
Probate grant, paper / stopped	12.3-15 weeks / about 21 weeks	Apr 2025	ICAEW [78]; Boys & Maughan [112] snippet
HMRC IHT400 code	allow 20 working days before applying	2020 guidance	The Gazette [113]
Purchase conveyance, instruction to completion	123 days (75 in 2007, 104 in 2019); consumer ideal 6.78 weeks	2025	Legal Futures [69]
HM Land Registry register updates	41.6% within 1 day; 32.2% over 3 months	Jul 2026	HMLR [72]
HM Land Registry complex changes	61.3% up to 12 months; 12.5% longer; first registrations half in about 8 months	Jul 2026	HMLR [72]
Requisition delay per application	2 weeks simple, up to 6 weeks complex	Jan 2023	Mortgage Solutions [74] snippet
Employment tribunal open caseload	68,192 single cases (+49% in a year); 515,000 including multiples; hearings into 2028	Jan 2026	BCLP [96]; Higgs [94]
ACAS early conciliation	12 weeks (was 6) from 1 Dec 2025; five-week wait to allocate a conciliator	2025-26	Farrer & Co [114] snippet; Higgs [94]
Private law children cases	37 weeks average to disposal	2025	MoJ [85]
Divorce, application to final order	mean 69 weeks (median 38 weeks in Q4)	2025	MoJ [85]
Small claims / multi-track, issue to trial	41.0 weeks / 55.9 weeks	Apr-Jun 2026	MoJ [115]
Possession, claim to repossession	median 26.4 weeks (32.5 in Q1 2025)	Jan-Mar 2026	OTS [102]
OIC whiplash portal	251 days average to settle; 349,000 unresolved	2023	Legal Ombudsman horizon scan [90]
Home Office change-of-conditions	29 days to 10 weeks; each RFI adds about a month	Nov 2024	Free Movement [87]

What clients complain about tracks the same loops

- Legal Ombudsman 2025/26: **14,259 complaints, up 37%**; **poor communication (24%) and delay or failure to progress (22%)** together 46%; **residential conveyancing 36% of accepted complaints (3,039, up 41%)**, wills and probate 14%, personal injury 14%; poor service found in **72%** of assessed cases (79% in wills and probate); the firm's own first-tier complaint handling unreasonable in 46% of investigated outcomes; a quarter of consumers never got a final response (Legal Ombudsman 2025/26 [82]).

- US equivalent, the bar complaint: Virginia's leading violation sources 2020-2022 were 'Competency, Rule 1.1; Diligence, Rule 1.3; Managing Trust Accounts, Rule 1.15', with roughly **25% of complaints citing communication** (Sands Anderson [116]); Maryland reports that 'failure to communicate and lack of diligence' produce the largest number of grievances (Maryland AGC [117] snippet).

Communication (24%) and delay (22%) are 46% of Legal Ombudsman complaint types; conveyancing is 36% of accepted complaints (2025/26)



Source: Legal Ombudsman annual complaints data 2025/26 [82]: 14,259 complaints received (+37%), 8,412 accepted (+16%); poor service found in 72% of assessed cases (79% in wills and probate).

Table 3.3 Legal Ombudsman, 2024/25 against 2025/26

Legal Ombudsman measure	2024/25	2025/26
New complaints received	10,447	14,259 (+37%)
Accepted	7,203	8,412 (+16%)
Poor communication (share of types)	24%	24%
Delay / failure to progress	23%	22%
Failure to advise	19%	19%
Costs	8%	9%
Failure to follow instructions	not given	8%
Residential conveyancing (share of accepted)	30% (2,153)	36% (3,039, +41%)
Wills and probate	16% (1,128)	14% (1,147)
Personal injury	14% (1,016)	14% (1,140)
Poor service found in assessed cases	70% (conveyancing 78%, W&P 76%)	72% (W&P 79%, criminal 57%)
First-tier complaint handling unreasonable	49% (conveyancing 58%)	46% (conveyancing 53%, W&P 53%)
Total remedies	£3,708,674	£3,700,986
Emotional-impact compensation	not given	in 86% of investigated cases, average £429
Fee refund or reduction	not given	in 29%, average £3,520

Sources: Legal Ombudsman 2024/25 [118]; Legal Ombudsman 2025/26 [82].

US practice areas: agencies instead of registries, sharper deadline risk

- **Missed deadlines are 'the single largest cause of malpractice claims against lawyers'** in plaintiffs' PI work; claims arise where 'a complaint was placed in the file and never filed' (Lawyers Mutual NC, Sep 2024 [119]).
- ABA claims profile 2020-2023 (relayed by ALPS): estate and probate **13.58%** of claims, real estate 13.19%, **plaintiff PI 12.73%**, family 10.02%; 'administrative errors (including calendaring) are rising and now account for nearly 25% of all claims' (ALPS, Jul 2026 [120] secondary).

US malpractice claims by practice area, 2020-2023: estate and probate 13.6%, real estate 13.2%, plaintiff PI 12.7%; administrative errors near 25% of all claims and rising



Source: ABA claims profile 2020-2023 as relayed by ALPS, Jul 2026 [120] (secondary). Missed deadlines are 'the single largest cause of malpractice claims against lawyers' in plaintiffs' PI work [119].

Table 3.4 US workflows

US practice area	Steps in order (marks)	Numbers from the notes	Source
Personal injury (contingency)	Intake call and sign retainer, HIPAA and records authorisations (D); calendar statute of limitations immediately (T); letters of representation to all insurers within 24-48 hours (R, T); request police report (M; 5-10 business days, up to 6 weeks in Ohio); policy-limits request; spoliation letters; request records and bills from every provider and follow up (M, R, D); treatment tracking; client check-in every 14 days (R); Medicare/Medicaid and lien identification; demand package; lien resolution; disbursement	About four record requests per matter (1,600 a month at 400 new matters) vendor; "Follow up. Then follow up again"; requests "still outstanding six weeks later" vendor; typical retrieval 10-15 days, complex 15-30+ days vendor, unverified; Medicare conditional-payment response 60-90 days; lien resolution adds 4-7 months; fees "inaccessible" until liens clear; PI has the most missed-deadline claims	CASEpeer checklist, Sep 2026 [121] vendor; CloudLex [122] vendor; Tavrn [123] vendor; LegalFunding.com, Jul 2025 [124]; YoCierge on Supio [125] vendor; Lawyers Mutual NC [119]
Family (hourly)	Paid consultation; financial affidavit from two years of pay stubs, bank statements and tax returns (M, D), updated repeatedly; parenting plan to state template; discovery run by a paralegal (D); hearings	"3.5+ hours manually" per affidavit vendor; sanctions for gaps "now mandatory" in NC snippet; one posting: discovery for "a minimum of 45 files" snippet; $300 for a 30-minute consultation	Casemark [126] vendor; Freed Marcroft [127]; Hodgson Law Office [128]
Estate planning and probate	Long questionnaire clients cannot complete from memory (M, D); template drafting; probate inventory within 60 days (Tennessee) or 3 months (Nebraska), notarised, mailed to all interested parties with certificate of service (D, T); partial inventories and amendments	"Probate cases generate endless back-and-forth emails and phone calls" vendor; will drafting $940-$1,500 in Omaha snippet; creditors have 3-6 months to claim	Content Snare [129] vendor; Douglass & Runger [130]; Atticus TN form [131]
Immigration	Questionnaire and evidence packet with exhibit index (D); online filing still needs a wet-ink client signature and G-28 upload; RFE arrives by mail or inbox, deadline 84-87 days, no extension (T); point-by-point cover letter and tabbed exhibits; translations	RFE triage "several hours", complex drafting "6 to 10 hours or more" vendor; time lost to "Late detection of RFEs sitting in mailboxes", "Drafting each response from a blank page", "Deadlines tracked only in individual calendars or spreadsheets" vendor; missing the deadline "commonly results in a denial"	Toorey [132] vendor; Messersmith Law [133]; USCIS online filing [134]
Criminal defence (flat fee)	24/7 phone; free consultation; discovery review including body-worn camera video (M, D); court dates; plea paperwork	One public defender reviewed 16 hours of video in a single case; footage "tripled our workload per case"; "it's malpractice for them to not view every scrap of video" snippet (2019-2021 public-defender data)	WDBJ7, Nov 2019 [135]; The Journal [136] snippet
Bankruptcy (federal, flat fee)	Collect income, debt and asset documents (M, D); means test; petition plus five schedule sets; mandatory CM/ECF e-filing; credit counselling certificates; 341 meeting at 21-40 days (Ch 7) or 21-50 (Ch 13); Ch 13 plan within 14 days (T)	Fees $245 + $75 + $15 (Ch 7); $235 + $75 (Ch 13); payments begin within 30 days of filing; a client review called "gathering documents to upload" the hardest part	US Courts, Ch 7 [137]; US Courts, Ch 13 [138]; Greenway Law Group [139]
Workers' compensation (Ohio)	First Report of Injury online or by mail; medical records and witness statements; BWC decides within 28 days; appeal within 14 days (T)	Seven-day waiting period; BWC notice within one year	Charles E. Boyk [140]
Social Security disability	Intake; long idle wait; records push about 3 months before hearing (M, D); evidence 5 business days before hearing (T)	ALJ hearing wait "about 12-15 months"; post-hearing records add "a month or two" snippet	Greeman Toomey [141]; Midwest Disability [142] snippet
Residential closings (South Carolina)	Title search, deed preparation, lender coordination, disbursement (D)	One Greenville firm: 40,000 closings since 1998 with no digital intake described; another runs a Qualia portal and electronic earnest money	Cogdill Law Firm [143]; Sallé Law [144]

US practice area	Steps in order (marks)	Numbers from the notes	Source
Overhead on every file	Conflict check; engagement or non-engagement letter; one person enters deadlines, a second verifies, weekly review (R); mandatory e-filing (Nebraska all courts from 2022; Kentucky attorneys from 2022 snippet); IOLTA monthly trial balance and three-way reconciliation, records kept six years (Alabama); billing and collection; file retention 5-7 years	Rule 1.4 communication is the top complaint category in every state source; 26% of billable time is documenting	Lawyers Mutual NC, Dec 2022 [145]; Ezel Alabama trust template [146]; Sands Anderson [116]

The fee model decides which pain bites

- A contingency PI firm is the client's lender for case costs and its own fee: every month of records or lien delay is a financing cost.
- An hourly family or business firm loses revenue to unrecorded time (38% utilisation) and slow billing: 37% of solos 'take too long to bill', 36% say clients do not pay on time (Answering Legal [27] secondary).
- A flat-fee criminal, bankruptcy or estate-planning firm bills and is paid fastest (flat-fee firms are 'five times more likely to send bills almost immediately' and 'close cases nearly three times faster' (2Civility [14])) but absorbs every unplanned hour, such as body-cam review, as lost margin.
- Clients prefer flat fees for the whole case (**71%**); most solos offering them use them for the entire matter (**80%**) (MinuteDock summary of Clio 2024 [147] snippet).

Website sweeps: how little is digital at the firm's edge

- **24 reachable UK small-firm sites** (Hull, Stoke, Sunderland, Plymouth, Lincoln, Blackpool, Carlisle, Wolverhampton, Doncaster, Middlesbrough, Bradford, Wrexham, Swansea, Derry, Dundee): phone listed by all 24; **zero mention online onboarding, electronic ID verification, e-signature or document upload**; the only client portal belongs to a CLC-regulated conveyancer; five firms still publish fax numbers; one live home page contains 'Lorem ipsum'; one warns 'we cannot guarantee that your e-mail will be received by us'; another states 'This Firm does not accept service of documents by Email or Fax'; a further 16 domains could not be read at all (expired, parked, wrong certificate, redirected to LinkedIn) (Allington Hughes [148]; Taylor Bracewell [149]; McKenzie Bell [150]; Kenneth Jones redirect [151]). Online quote tools exist only for conveyancing; everything else is 'call for a quote'.
- **18 US firm sites** (Tulsa, Birmingham, Greenville, Spokane, Toledo, Dayton, Knoxville, Chattanooga, Lubbock, Lexington, Albuquerque, Little Rock): every site leads with a phone number; 11 have a four-or-five-field form; only one offers online scheduling (Calendly); only one a client portal (Qualia, a closing practice); four publish fax numbers; none describes e-signature, document upload or payment plans; one firm's domain now serves gambling spam (Greenway Law Group [139]; Sallé Law [144]; Hartley Law Office listing [152]).
- Spanish-language service appears at every immigration firm read and almost nowhere else. The client's manual journey at every swept firm: find the phone number, wait for a call-back, be matched to a fee earner, then deliver documents by whatever means that person chooses.

SECTION 4

Why client data cannot go into ChatGPT: tribunals, warning notices, sanctions and shadow AI

Every UK and US regulator that has spoken says the same thing: confidentiality, competence and supervision apply unchanged, putting client information into a public or free AI tool is disclosure to a third party, and the lawyer stays personally responsible for the output. In 2025-26 the duty moved from guidance to enforcement, and the enforcement landed on the 1-20 lawyer segment.

UK: tribunal rulings, then warning notices

- **November 2025, Upper Tribunal**: a Manchester immigration solicitor had 'put client emails he had drafted about Home Office decisions into ChatGPT to improve them' and 'uploaded Home Office decision letters to summarise them for clients'; putting such information into open AI tools is **'to breach client confidentiality and waive legal privilege'**; lawyers who did this 'would have to self-report and should consult the ICO'; closed tools such as Microsoft Copilot are available 'without these risks'. A second Birmingham firm had grounds drafted by 'a part-time trainee lawyer' who was in fact a very junior caseworker; the judge said the matter was 'principally about supervision' because 'anyone with Google has access to AI' (Legal Futures, 24 Feb 2026 [153]).
- **October 2026, third ruling**: at an East London firm 'a junior member of staff, namely a paralegal' used ChatGPT to produce grounds of appeal that the solicitors 'did not check'; supervision 'did not begin to mitigate the risk'; two self-reports to the SRA (Legal Futures, 9 Oct 2026 [154]).
- A reported 2026 Upper Tribunal decision describes uploading confidential material to an open tool as placing it 'on the internet in the public domain' because such tools 'may retain and use inputs for model training' (Slaughter and May Lens, 8 Jun 2026 [155], a large-firm commentary).
- **SRA warning notice, 17-18 August 2026**, after 'rising cases of hallucinated case law and confidentiality breaches': solicitors 'remain accountable for their work and outputs, regardless of how that work has been prepared'; entering confidential information into open tools such as ChatGPT would amount to a waiver of privilege; client information only with 'appropriate contractual, technical and organisational safeguards' (Legal Cheek, 18 Aug 2026 [156] secondary; the notice text itself was blocked). The SRA had received **42 reports of potential AI misuse between July 2025 and July 2026** (Lets Data Science [157] secondary).
- Bar Council guidance (reviewed 25 Nov 2025), para 21: 'anything that a user types into the system may be used to train the software and might find itself repeated verbatim in future results'; para 28: sharing privileged or confidential information with a generative LLM 'is likely to be a breach of Core Duty 6' (Bar Council PDF [158]).
- Bar Standards Board guidance in force from 18 May 2026: free tools are generally unsuitable for client work because their terms typically let providers 'claim rights over input data, store prompts indefinitely, and use them for model training' (Legal Cheek, May 2026 [159] secondary).
- Law Society, 'Generative AI: the essentials' (Aug 2024): for a free online tool with no operational relationship with the vendor 'you should not put any confidential data into the tool' (LawCareers.Net, Michelmores [160] secondary).
- **Ayinde v Haringey and Al-Haroun v Qatar National Bank (Divisional Court, 6 June 2025)**: freely available tools 'are not capable of conducting reliable legal research' and 'may cite sources that do not exist'; in one case five cited authorities did not exist, in the other 18 of 45; both matters referred to the regulators; powers listed: admonishment, costs orders, strike-out, police referral, contempt (Judgment, National Archives [161]).

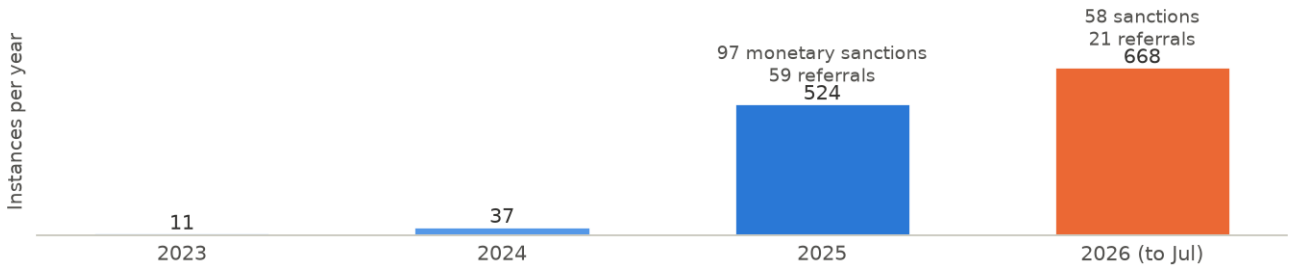
US: bar opinions, a privilege waiver, and routine sanctions

- **ABA Formal Opinion 512 (29 July 2024)**: self-learning tools raise disclosure risk 'even if the tool is used exclusively by lawyers at the same firm'; 'a client's informed consent is required prior to inputting information relating to the representation into such a GAI tool'; 'merely adding general, boiler-plate provisions to engagement letters' is not enough (Zuva summary [162] secondary; the ABA PDF was blocked).
- **Kentucky E-457 (March 2024)**: do not 'input any client information that lacks reasonable and adequate security protections unless, of course, client consent is first obtained'; 'review the "terms of use" of any AI product' because some use 'uploaded documents such as pleadings or contracts to train itself, or to share that information with third parties' (KBA E-457 [163]). **California (Nov 2023)**: attorneys 'must not input any confidential client information' into AI tools lacking adequate protections (Epiq [164] secondary).
- **United States v Heppner (S.D.N.Y., 10 Feb 2026)**: Judge Rakoff held that a client's use of a consumer AI tool waived attorney-client privilege because the platform was a third party whose terms warned that prompts

'may be shared further' (Washington Legal Foundation [165]); two other federal courts treated AI as a tool rather than a person, so the US position is split (ACEDS [166]).

- Hallucination sanctions are routine: a tracker of AI-fabricated content in US filings counted **11 instances in 2023, 37 in 2024, 524 in 2025 and 668 in 2026 to July**, with **97 monetary sanctions and 59 disciplinary referrals in 2025** (37 cases at $1,000-$5,000, four over $50,000); 'judicial patience for unverified citations has evaporated' (MSBA, 27 Jul 2026 [167] secondary). The rate rose 'from about two cases per week before spring 2025 to two or three per day'; a Colorado attorney got a 90-day suspension after admitting he 'had not checked the work on a motion that ChatGPT helped draft' (Cronkite News, 28 Oct 2025 [168]).
- Even paid legal research tools hallucinate: Stanford (May 2024) found Lexis+ AI and Westlaw AI-Assisted Research 'each relatively hallucinate between 17% and 33% of queries' (Bar Council PDF, para 11 [158]).

AI-fabricated content in US court filings: 11 instances in 2023, 524 in 2025 and 668 in the first seven months of 2026



Source: Charlotin tracker as reported by MSBA, 27 Jul 2026 [167] (secondary). 2025: 97 monetary sanctions, 59 disciplinary referrals; 37 cases at $1,000-$5,000, four over $50,000. 2026 to July: 58 sanctions, 21 referrals; offenders 405 pro se / 256 lawyers.

Table 4.1 AI-fabricated content in US court filings (Charlotin tracker)

AI-fabricated content in US court filings (Charlotin tracker)	2023	2024	2025	2026 (to Jul)
Instances	11	37	524	668
Monetary sanctions	not given	not given	97	58
Disciplinary referrals	not given	not given	59	21
Offenders: pro se / lawyers	not given	not given	308 / 208	405 / 256
Sanction size distribution (2025)			37 cases $1,000-$5,000; 4 over $50,000	

Source: MSBA, 27 Jul 2026 [167] secondary.

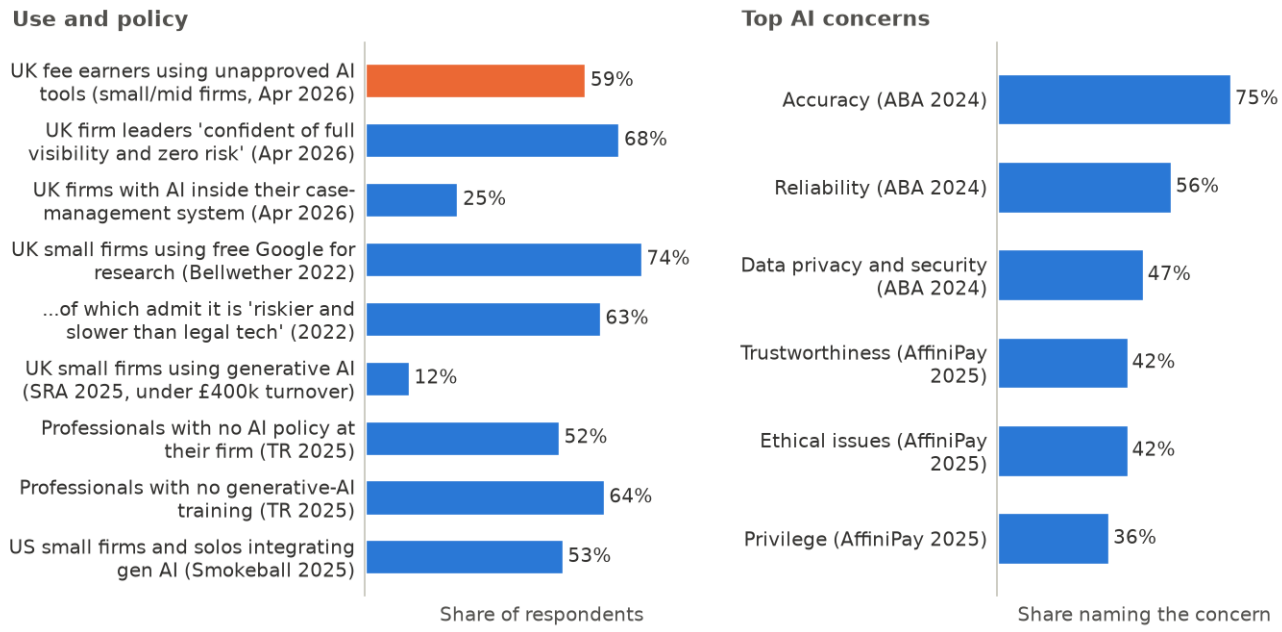
What firms are afraid of, in order: hallucination, then privilege and training, then vendor terms

- Surveys rank accuracy first: **75%** of ABA-surveyed lawyers named accuracy the top concern and **47%** data privacy and security; AffiniPay's 2025 survey of more than 2,800 mostly small-firm respondents put trustworthiness and ethical issues at 42% each and privilege at 36%, with 60% unsure when their firm would adopt (LawNext, Apr 2025 [169]).
- SRA 2025 study of sole practitioners and small firms under £400,000 turnover: **only 12% use generative AI**, 25% are considering it; barriers are cost (25%), data breach or compliance risk (15%) and quality (11%) (SRA research findings [170]). The SRA's 2023 AI report had already named the risk scenario of 'a staff member using an online AI tool such as ChatGPT on a client's case' and said automation 'could be particularly beneficial for small firms where senior practitioners do not have support from an administrative team' (SRA, Nov 2023 [171]).
- **The shadow-AI gap is the clearest single number**: Censuswide, 200 UK legal professionals, April 2026: **59% of fee earners in small and mid-sized firms admitted using unapproved tools such as free ChatGPT and Google AI search, while 68% of firm leaders were 'confident they have full visibility and zero risk'**; half would welcome AI built into their case-management system but only 25% of firms have it; 'restricting or banning AI may push staff toward shadow tools' (Legal Futures blog, Access Legal [172] vendor-run survey).
- The behavioural precursor, 2022: **74% of UK small firms used free Google for research and 63% admitted this was 'riskier and slower than legal tech'** (Solicitors Journal, 16 May 2022 [173]).
- Thomson Reuters 2025 cross-profession survey: **52% had no AI policy and 64% no generative-AI training** (LawNext [169]); among in-house teams 83% use tools not provided by the company and 81% tools

not approved (Bloomberg Law [174]).

- The people pasting client material into free tools in the UK cases were paralegals, trainees and sole principals at immigration firms; the principal's defence that 'there was no mechanism by which staff at his firm could use AI' was rejected (Legal Futures, 24 Feb 2026 [153]).
- The closed-tool alternative has its own documented problem: Microsoft 365 Copilot 'can share confidential information with unauthorized firm personnel if data permissions aren't appropriately established', so document permissions and sensitivity labels must be fixed first (Intapp case study [175]; ABA Law Technology Today, 2026 [176]).

59% of UK fee earners use unapproved AI tools while 68% of their leaders see 'zero risk'; accuracy is the top stated concern



Sources: Access Legal survey via Legal Futures [172] (vendor-run, 200 respondents, Apr 2026); SRA 2025 [170]; Solicitors Journal 2022 [173]; LawNext Apr 2025 [169] (TR 2025, ABA 2024, AffiniPay 2025); LawNext Mar 2025 [178] (Smokeball, vendor).

Table 4.2 AI policy and shadow-use measures

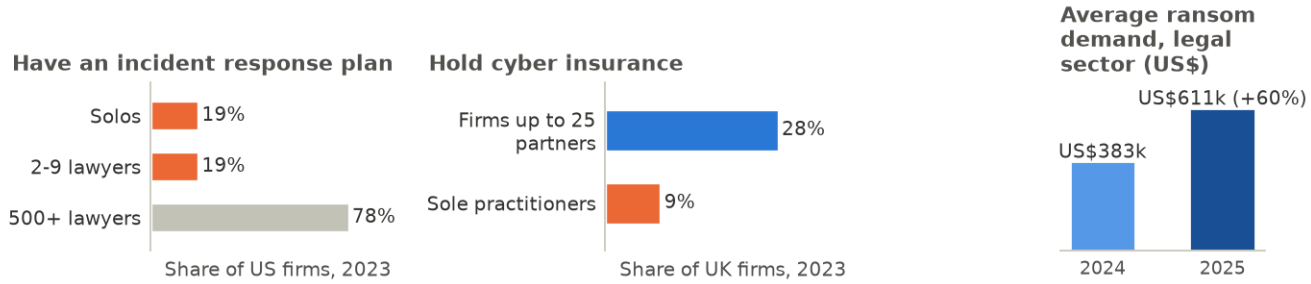
AI policy and shadow-use measure	Figure	Population	Source
Fee earners using unapproved AI tools (UK small/mid firms)	59%	100 practitioners, Apr 2026	Access Legal via Legal Futures [172] vendor survey
Leaders confident of "full visibility and zero risk"	68%	100 firm leaders, Apr 2026	same
Firms with AI inside their case-management system	25%	same survey	same
Hours lost per fee earner per week to "ill-functioning technology"	4.16 billable hours	same survey	same vendor estimate
UK small firms using generative AI / considering it	12% / 25%	138 firms up to 4 partners, under £400k, 2025	SRA [170]
UK solicitors saying firm "adopted AI in some way"	96% (56% widespread; 29% say it saved costs)	500 solicitors, 82% at firms of 20 or fewer, Nov 2024	Legal Futures [177] vendor survey
UK small firms using free Google for research / admitting it is riskier	74% / 63%	Bellwether 2022	Solicitors Journal [173]
No AI policy / no gen-AI training	52% / 64%	1,702 professionals, 2025	LawNext [169]
Top AI concerns (ABA members)	accuracy 75%, reliability 56%, privacy and security 47%	ABA 2024 survey	LawNext [169]
US small firms and solos integrating gen AI	53% (27% in 2023)	310 firms, Smokeball 2025	LawNext, Mar 2025 [178] vendor survey
SRA reports of potential AI misuse	42 in Jul 2025-Jul 2026	SRA	Lets Data Science [157] secondary

AI policy and shadow-use measure	Figure	Population	Source
Hallucination rate in paid legal research tools	17-33% of queries	Stanford, May 2024	Bar Council PDF [158]

Cyber incidents: the other reason small firms are told to keep data inside

- NCSC legal-sector report: 'many legal practices, especially smaller firms, chambers and individual practitioners, rely on an external IT services provider, making it challenging for them to assess for themselves whether the controls they have in place are appropriate'; 'a small law firm with few resources could be devastated' by ransomware (NCSC, Jun 2023 [179]).
- SRA thematic review of 40 firms: **30 had been targeted, over £4 million of client money stolen from 23 firms, 18 firms paying about £400,000 of their own money, 43% of attacks on small firms, email modification fraud about half of all attacks**; one conveyancing firm's ransomware attack (an employee clicked a weekend email) closed it for 14 days and cost £60,000 to recover plus £150,000 in lost revenue (Legal Futures, 31 Oct 2019 [180]).
- ICO action against three small criminal-law firms: Tuckers (ransomware Aug 2020; no MFA, five-month patch gap, unencrypted data); Levales (reprimand Oct 2024; 8,234 people affected, no MFA on the compromised account); DPP Law (£60,000 fine Apr 2025; brute-forced admin account on a legacy case-management system, 791 people including privileged material, reported 43 days late after the NCA found the data on the dark web) (ICO, Levales [181]; teiss, 22 Apr 2025 [182]).
- A November 2023 attack on CTS, an IT provider to law firms, left an estimated 80 to 200 conveyancing firms unable to complete transactions (Mortgage Solutions, 5 Dec 2023 [183]). The average ransom demand on legal-sector organisations rose **60% to US$611,000 in 2025** with attack volume up 54% (Insurance Business / QBE, Jun 2026 [184]).
- US: 27% to 29% of ABA-surveyed firms report a breach, but only **19% of solos and 19% of 2-9 lawyer firms have an incident response plan**, against 78% at firms of 500+ (ABA 2023 Cybersecurity TechReport [185]).
- Everyday channel problems: email (a solicitor was fined by the SDT after transferring more than £290,000 to a hacker on emailed bank details (Law Society [186])) and WhatsApp, which the SRA's 2024 asylum review found had become the 'preferred communications tool' at firms with no written policy and case-management systems that do not capture messages (Legal Futures, 31 Jul 2024 [187]); a costs judge has ruled WhatsApp messages form part of the solicitor's file if charged for (Legal Futures on MacInnes v DWF [188]).
- No UK or US regulator mandates on-premises or in-country hosting; the pressure comes from UK GDPR transfer rules, client outside-counsel guidelines that ask 'where data is stored' (Conventus Law [189]), and a few US judges' standing orders requiring a certificate that AI use 'didn't disclose proprietary information to unauthorized parties' (Bloomberg Law [190]). The practical exposure for a small firm: it cannot answer 'where is it processed' for a free consumer tool.

Small firms are least prepared: 19% of US solos have an incident plan, 9% of UK sole practitioners hold cyber insurance, ransom demands rose 60%



Sources: ABA 2023 Cybersecurity TechReport [185]; Law Society PII research via Legal Futures 2023 [16]; Insurance Business / QBE Jun 2026 [184]. SRA review 2019: 30 of 40 firms visited had been targeted, over £4m of client money stolen from 23 firms [180].

Table 4.3 Cyber incidents and costs

Cyber incident or cost	Figure	Source
SRA review: firms targeted	30 of 40 visited; about 150 attacks a year reported	Legal Futures, 2019 [180]
Client money stolen / firms' own losses	over £4m from 23 firms / about £400,000 paid by 18 firms	same
Share of attacks on small firms / email modification fraud	43% / about half	same

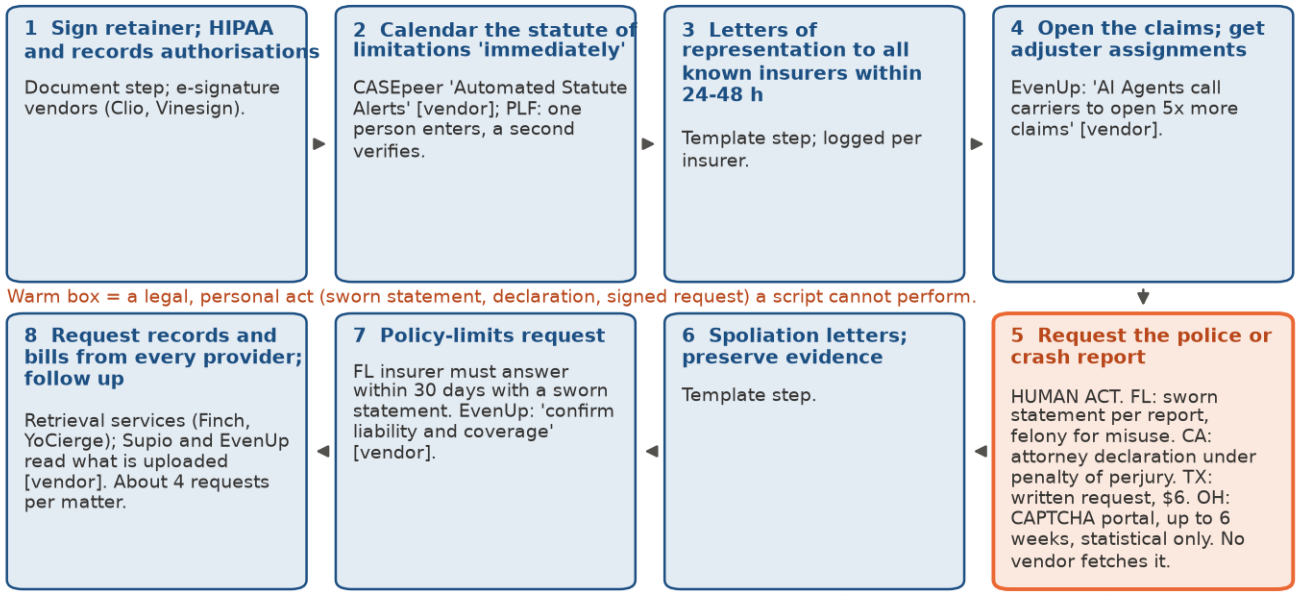
Cyber incident or cost	Figure	Source
Ransomware case (conveyancing firm)	14 days closed; £60,000 recovery; £150,000 lost revenue; $500 ransom not paid	same
Email fraud case (small firm)	£400,000 diverted; £5,000 excess; £900 Ombudsman award	same
DPP Law ICO fine	£60,000 (Apr 2025); 791 people; reported 43 days late	teiss [182]
Levales reprimand	8,234 individuals, 863 high risk; no MFA (Oct 2024)	ICO [181]
CTS supply-chain outage	80-200 firms; one lender had 600 cases affected (Nov 2023)	Mortgage Solutions [183]
Average ransom demand, legal sector	US$383,000 (2024) to US$611,000 (2025), +60%	Insurance Business / QBE [184]
US firms reporting a breach	27% (2022), 29% (2024) snippet	ABA 2022 [191]; Sikich [192]
Incident response plan: solos / 2-9 / 500+	19% / 19% / 78% (2023)	ABA 2023 [185]
UK cyber insurance: all firms up to 25 partners / sole practitioners	28% / 9% (2023)	Legal Futures [16]
Friday-afternoon fraud share of SRA cybercrime reports	75% (2016)	Law Society Communities [193]
Cyber Essentials Plus assessment	about £1,500 plus preparation vendor	Forensic Control [194]

SECTION 5

US PI firms get the police report second, by hand, and vendors stop at the PDF

In every checklist read, the first 72 hours after a car-accident client signs run the same way, and the police report comes second in time but 'first' in importance. Obtaining it is a manual, state-specific act, and no vendor page read claims to fetch it.

The first 72 hours of a US PI case: the police report is step 5 in time, 'get it first' in importance, and the one step no vendor automates



Sources: CASEpeer checklist, 2 Sep 2026 [121] (vendor); Oregon PLF PI checklist [206]; Tex. Transp. Code 550.065 [198]; Fla. Stat. 316.066 [199]; Cal. Veh. Code 20012 [200]; Ohio Crash Retrieval [201]; EvenUp Intake [207] (vendor); Supio Mar 2026 [209] (vendor). Time runs left to right on the top row, then down and right to left.

The sequence and why the report matters

- CASEpeer's checklist: sign the retainer and the HIPAA and records authorisations, calendar the statute of limitations 'immediately', send letters of representation 'to all known insurers within 24 to 48 hours', open the claims and get adjuster assignments, and only then 'Request the police or incident report', send spoliation letters and pull policy limits (CASEpeer checklist, 2 Sep 2026 [121] vendor).
- Practitioners say 'get it first' in importance because it 'has the defendant, the carrier, and the officer's narrative' (Finch [195] vendor); without it 'the details may "boil down to he said, she said"' (Morgan & Morgan, Mar 2025 [196]).
- The firm reads from it: the adverse driver and carrier, the officer's narrative and opinion of fault, citations and coded contributing factors, the scene diagram, witness and passenger details, injury descriptions. Adjusters 'generally accept police accident reports as credible, unbiased evidence of fault'; roadway and weather conditions 'may appear as code numbers' that need a call to the department to decode; in fatal or pending-toxicology cases 'the report is amended as information becomes available', so a final copy is needed (Injury Claim Coach [197]).
- Factual errors (a wrong address or spelling) can be corrected with supporting evidence, but 'changing the officer's opinion of fault is "much more difficult"' (Injury Claim Coach [197]; Morgan & Morgan [196]).

Obtaining the report is a manual, state-specific act

- **Texas** sells the collision report for **$6 plus $2 for certification**, releases the full version only 'on written request' to an enumerated list of persons 'directly concerned' (attorneys are not named and fall under 'authorized representative' by implication), and publishes a redacted copy anyone can buy (Tex. Transp. Code 550.065 [198]).
- **Florida** makes reports **confidential for 60 days** except to 'the parties involved in the crash, their legal representatives', insurers and agencies; requires a written sworn statement that the report 'will not be used for any commercial solicitation of accident victims', which 'must be completed and sworn to by the requesting

party for each individual crash report'; knowing misuse is 'a felony of the third degree'; the officer's long-form report is due within 10 days of completing the investigation (Fla. Stat. 316.066 [199]).

- **California** releases confidential reports to anyone with 'a proper interest', including 'any attorney who declares under penalty of perjury that he or she represents' an involved person, and caps copy fees at actual cost (Cal. Veh. Code 20012 [200]).
- **Ohio's** statewide portal warns that 'Crash reports may take up to 6 weeks to be available', that they 'are to be used for statistical use only and are not sufficient to be used for any court proceeding', that 'the investigating agency is the official record keeper', and it sits behind a case-sensitive CAPTCHA (Ohio Crash Retrieval [201]).
- Firm-side explainers put the general cost at '$5 to $25' and availability at '5 to 10 business days after the accident, but it could take longer if the investigation is ongoing', with BuyCrash and LexisNexis as aggregators that 'may charge additional fees' (Morgan & Morgan [196]).
- Every aggregator (BuyCrash/LexisNexis, CrashDocs/Carfax, ReportBeam) and every other state portal attempted (Texas CRIS, Florida FLHSMV, CHP, Georgia, Kentucky, Tennessee, Oklahoma, Alabama, Nebraska, Idaho, NYPD) refused the researcher, so their fees, account terms and anti-bot clauses are unsourced.

Table 5.1 Crash-report access by state or channel

State or channel	Fee	Who may obtain the full report	Human act required	Availability	Source
Texas	$6; +$2 certified; $6 for a "no report on file" certificate	Enumerated "directly concerned" persons incl. "authorized representative", owners, insurers; redacted copy to anyone	Written request and payment	not stated in statute	Tex. Transp. Code 550.065 [198]
Florida	not in statute text fetched	Parties, "their legal representatives", insurers, agencies, media (redacted); everyone else after 60 days	Sworn written statement per report; felony for misuse	Officer files within 10 days of completing investigation	Fla. Stat. 316.066 [199]
California	not above actual cost of the copy	Anyone with "a proper interest" incl. drivers, injured persons, owners, "any attorney who declares under penalty of perjury"	Attorney declaration under penalty of perjury	not stated	Cal. Veh. Code 20012 [200]
Ohio statewide portal	not stated	Anyone, by crash number, document number or date/county/agency/name	Case-sensitive CAPTCHA	up to 6 weeks; statistical only; go to the investigating agency for the evidentiary copy with diagram	Ohio Crash Retrieval [201]
Illinois	not stated on page	not stated on page	Driver self-report within 10 days if no officer attended (thresholds $1,500 / $500 uninsured)	not stated	ISP Crash Reports [202]
General (firm blogs)	$5-$25; aggregators add fees	"Some states limit access to involved drivers, their representatives, and their insurers"	Identification; officer's service number, location, date and time	5-10 business days; "a week or two"	Morgan & Morgan [196]; Injury Claim Coach [197]

The other intake verifications follow the same pattern

- Policy limits are statutory in Florida: an insurer must answer a claimant's written request within 30 days with a sworn statement giving the insurer, each insured, the limits including umbrella and excess, any coverage defence and 'a copy of the policy' (Fla. Stat. 627.4137 [203]).
- Medicare's recovery contractor expects 'the Medicare beneficiary or his/her attorney' to 'inform Medicare as soon as they become aware other insurance is available' and recovers conditional payments from any settlement (CMS BCRC [204]); Medicare resolution 'takes about 5-6 months from start to finish' or about 45 days if opened early (Garretson Resolution Group [205]).
- Oregon's professional liability fund asks whether the lawyer has 'obtained the pertinent HIPAA-compliant medical authorizations', 'an employment and tax records authorization', determined Medicare or Medicaid eligibility and 'put the agencies on notice', and obtained records 'including treatment prior to the litigated incident' (OSB PLF PI checklist [206]).
- The one verification vendors have clearly automated is the carrier call: EvenUp says 'Once you've signed the client, AI Agents call carriers to open 5x more claims and get adjuster assignments', agents 'confirm liability and coverage, and deliver written confirmation to your team', saving '16+ Minutes Per Case On Coverage Checks' (EvenUp Intake [207] vendor); its Lerner & Rowe release claims '2x more claims opened in the same amount of time' and 'policy-limit tenders that I would not normally be getting' (EvenUp, 3 Jun 2026 [208] vendor).

- Supio's March 2026 release adds a Case Review Agent that 'automatically extracts incident facts from case files' and 'shows which information is present and which still needs to be collected from the client', plus Instant Liens that 'reads every document in the case file and identifies liens' as Government, ERISA/private or provider (Supio, 16 Mar 2026 [209] vendor).

The automation boundary is legal, not technical

- None of the vendor pages read (EvenUp, Supio, Eve, Finch, Wisedocs, DigitalOwl, Parrot, Case Status, Filevine, Lead Docket, Litify, SmartAdvocate, CloudLex, CASEpeer, Lawmatics, Smokeball, and the Zapier listings for Clio and Filevine) claims to fetch a crash report from a state portal or names a crash-report parser. They automate upstream (intake calls, lead scoring, carrier calls) and downstream (fact extraction from whatever is uploaded, lien classification, demand drafting).
- Zapier can 'Upload Document to Matter' in Clio but cannot fetch one; Filevine's Zapier app exposes a single 'New Event' trigger and no document-upload action (Zapier Clio [210]; Zapier Filevine [211]).
- The reasons are on the statute book: Florida's per-report sworn statement under felony penalty and California's attorney declaration under penalty of perjury are signed, personal acts, and any script that performed them would shift criminal exposure onto the firm; Texas requires a written request from an enumerated person; Ohio's portal is CAPTCHA-gated and non-evidentiary anyway.
- CloudLex describes its own records service as 'no portals, no uploads', which is a managed human service, not a software integration (CloudLex [212] vendor).
- The reliable boundary today: a human (paralegal, client or adjuster) obtains the PDF; software ingests it (Supio's forwarding inbox, SmartAdvocate's barcode scan, CloudLex's mail indexing) and extracts the facts; a human checks the version and the fault opinion.

Fully manual, with no vendor claim at all: decoding state-specific contributing-factor codes, chasing amended reports in fatal or toxicology cases, and asking the agency to correct a factual error.

England and Wales: the low-value route removes the police report as a precondition

- The Official Injury Claim portal needs 'the full name and UK vehicle registration number of the driver you feel is responsible', witness details, the claimant's National Insurance number and police details only 'if the police attended the scene', with the Police Reference Number 'if available'; the compensator has up to 30 business days on liability and 20 to make a first offer (OIC start a claim [92]).
- The other driver's insurer is found through askMID at **£10 for a one-off search or £774 a year** on subscription, migrating to 'Check Their Vehicle' from 7 December with new subscriptions paused until Q1 2027 (askMID [91]); uninsured or untraced drivers go to the Motor Insurers' Bureau, which says about 335,000 uninsured vehicles are on UK roads on any day (MIB [213]).
- STATS19 is the police statistical return, not the disclosable collision report (GOV.UK STATS19 [214]). Every police-force collision-report fee page attempted returned an error, so the typical fee, who may request and the turnaround are unverified.

SECTION 6

Clio can apply a checklist but cannot police it: the audit angle

Clio Manage's native automation is template-based, not event-driven: it can apply a task list and show a stage, but nothing in the documentation enforces required fields, named task owners or overdue exception reports. Across every US competitor page fetched, the words 'overdue alert', 'required field' and 'exception report' are absent.

What Clio's native automation can and cannot do

- Documented building blocks: matter templates (Essentials tier and above), task-template lists applied to a matter, and matter stages (Advanced and above) shown as Kanban boards (Lawyerist Clio review [215]).
- 'Automated Workflows': on matter creation or a stage move it can 'Assign a task list' or 'Generate a document', and on a Clio Grow to Manage conversion 'Apply a matter template'; that is the full list of actions; available only on the Advanced and Expand (or Complete) tiers (Clio help 35132279298843 [216] snippet; Clio Automated Workflows guide, May 2025 [217]).
- A reviewer in August 2025: 'No conditional logic in task assignments' and a 'basic notification system with limited real-time updates' (TrustRadius Clio [218] user, 7 Aug 2025).
- Clio's October 2025 'intelligent legal work platform' release promises 'Manage AI' that 'turns court documents into calendar events' and 'Grow AI' that 'automatically follows up on outstanding intake items' but names no workflow tools and gives no availability or price (PR Newswire, 16 Oct 2025 [219] vendor); Lawyerist notes that 'deeper automation for calendaring and task management is planned, not yet available' (Lawyerist [215]).
- Clio Operate, the configurable-workflow product from the ShareDo acquisition, is 'built for firms with more than 200 users' (PR Newswire, 9 Mar 2026 [220]), so it does not reach the 1-30 lawyer firm.

Everything conditional, date-driven or cross-matter needs the API or middleware

- Zapier's Clio app: 12 triggers (New Matter, Matter Status Updated, New Task, Task Status Updated, New Document, New Contact and so on), 17 actions (including 'Assign Task Template List' and 'Create Task'), 8 searches (including Find Matter by Custom Field); **no trigger on a custom-field value, no 'Updated Matter' trigger, no Clio Grow trigger** (Zapier Clio [210]). Zaps are 'only compatible with Clio Manage' and 'run for every user on the account' (Clio help 16186400854171 [221] snippet); a user found Clio's own 'Required Custom Field rules' blocked a Zap updating matters (Zapier community [222]).
- Clio Manage API v4: 'a default rate limit of 50 requests per minute during peak usage hours' per access token; 'Clio does not currently offer custom rate limit increases' (Clio developer docs [223]); the docs sidebar lists no webhooks page and a guessed path returned 404 (Clio developer docs [224]). Fifty requests a minute is enough for a nightly sweep across a small firm's open matters, but any exception report is a polling job, not an event.
- Data-model limits: 'Clio does not allow a "User" custom field' and 'does not allow you to create custom fields that are "lists" or "collections"' (TrustRadius Clio [218] user, 20 Jul 2022); document templates can only be built from matter fields, not contact fields, 'which made medical records requests hard to generate for multiple providers' (Lawyerist [215] user, 5 Jan 2020).

Table 6.1 Workflow capability by system (part 1: triggers, logic, rules, owners)

System	Event triggers	Conditional logic	Required-field rule	Task owner by role
Clio Manage (native)	Matter created; stage change; Grow conversion	Not documented; user: "No conditional logic" (Aug 2025)	"Required Custom Field rules" exist (blocked a Zap)	Task lists assign tasks; role-vs-named not confirmed (help blocked)
Clio via Zapier / API	12 Zapier triggers (object create, status change); no custom-field trigger; API 50 req/min, no webhooks found	Only in Zapier/Make logic	Via API field checks	Via API
MyCase	"custom triggers — dates, filings, or completed tasks" (Pro tier)	Not stated	Not stated; custom fields "cannot easily be filled in after a case is created" (Jul 2020)	"Assign every step to the right attorney, paralegal, or staff member"
PracticePanther	Task completion chains the next task	Not stated	Unique contact IDs optional, so integrations "break" (Oct 2019)	"assign who's responsible for each task"
CASEpeer (PI)	"Automated Statute Alerts"; treatment tracking	Not stated	Not stated	Not stated

System	Event triggers	Conditional logic	Required-field rule	Task owner by role
Smokeball	Practice-area workflows	Not stated	Not stated	Anyone can see everyone's tasks; "no way to restrict permissions"
Filevine	Phase-based taskflows; auto-tasks per phase	Deeper, but Workato automations metered ("$100 per 500 actions" 3p)	Not documented	Yes, via phases and roles
LEAP (UK)	Not on features page	Not stated	Not stated	Not stated
Osprey (UK)	Workflows trigger email or SMS	Not stated	Not stated	"Key dates ... can be easily reassigned"
Access CaseMatters Evo (ex-Proclaim, UK)	Pre-built PI workflows; MOJ portal	Not stated	Not stated	Not stated

Table 6.1 Workflow capability by system (part 2: alerts, exception reports, price, source)

System	Overdue alerts	Overdue or missing-task exception report	Price seen	Source
Clio Manage (native)	Not documented	Not documented; users export to Excel	$49 to $159/user/month (2026, tiers now mostly quote-only)	Clio help [216] snippet; TrustRadius [218]; PricingSaaS [225]
Clio via Zapier / API	Via middleware	Build it yourself by polling	Zapier plan plus build time	Zapier [210]; Clio docs [223]
MyCase	Not stated	Not stated	$50/$60 Basic, $100/$120 Pro, $130/$150 Advanced	MyCase [226] vendor; Lawyerist MyCase [227]
PracticePanther	"daily reminders"; SOL view	Not stated	$49 / $69 / $89	PracticePanther [228] vendor; Lawyerist PP [229]
CASEpeer (PI)	Statute alerts; "automated follow-ups" for records	"Over 50 Additional Reports" on Pro; no missing-provider report	$90 / $130 / $160	CASEpeer pricing [230] vendor
Smokeball	Not stated	Business reporting	Quote only	Lawyerist Smokeball [231]
Filevine	Yes	Report Builder examples: "incomplete tasks due in the next 7 days", "projects with an SOL coming in 90 days"; Fusion needs vendor enablement	Quote only; est. $80-$120/user/month plus add-ons	Filevine support [232] snippet; Oktopeak [233]
LEAP (UK)	Not stated	Reporting only	Per user behind a form; set-up fee may apply	LEAP UK features [234] vendor
Osprey (UK)	Colour-coded key dates	"Key date reports"; 50+ core reports; Power BI	36-month term, 5% annual rise, minimum 3 licences	Osprey [235] vendor
Access CaseMatters Evo (ex-Proclaim, UK)	"automated task reminders"	Dashboards; "2,000 files checked overnight" vendor ROI card	"£60-£175 per user per month" market rule of thumb	Access Legal [236] vendor

No vendor sells the exception report, and the evidence firms misconfigure is consistent

- Clio publishes only a correlation: 'growing firms are 18 percent more likely to adopt key workflows' and are '2x more likely to use automation' (PR Newswire, 16 Oct 2025 [237] vendor), never a base rate for task-template or custom-field use.
- The insurer ALPS: 'routine errors, especially calendaring and the filing and service of documents, remain a primary cause of claims despite widespread adoption of legal technology'; 'technology is not a substitute for process'; 'software can't fix inconsistent routines, ineffective internal processes, or poor documentation habits' (ALPS, 21 Jul 2026 [120]).
- Oregon's PLF sets the operational rule an audit would test: 'No file should ever be set aside without a reminder date on it or be tickled for more than 60 days', review all files at least every 30 days, 'Double-checking of all entries', and 'DO NOT assume anything. Verify it.' (OSB PLF tickler systems [238]; OSB PLF docketing checklist [239]).
- Users from the inside: 'the reporting is not remotely close to be as great as they say' user, 19 Sep 2026; 'Clio creates duplicate invoices' and 'some trust activity is sent to QBO as a triple entry' user, 21 Aug 2026; 'It's basically sink or swim, based on your own level of accounting knowledge' user, 11 Jul 2026; 'Grow and manage do not work together at all' and 'We got a 34% increase in per month per user increase two months ago' user, 17 Aug 2026 (Trustpilot [240]); 'a firm will need to spend time getting set-up' and 'not all of your needed functionality will be included in Clio's price' (Lawyerist [215]).

- The Grow-to-Manage conversion is a documented data-loss point: if sync was not previously enabled 'only the contact set as the default client in Clio Grow will be converted', related contacts are dropped, and 'matter status, assigned-to, estimated case value, emails, and tasks' do not convert (Clio Grow conversion help [241] snippet).

The consultant market is real but opaque on price

- Clio's Certified Consultant programme page and directory were blocked, so the count and any Clio-published rates are unverified; visible self-listed entries include Big Mode Consulting (DC, '50+ firms' moved to Clio), XPRTS (Austin, 'fractional operations leadership'), LawTech Partners (Florida, 'Clio Gold Partner') and Apply Compliance Today (Surrey, UK); Clio states it 'doesn't review or guarantee any advisor's listing' (Big Mode [242]; Apply Compliance Today [243]).
- Third-party estimates: Clio live training '$150 to $300 per hour', data migration '$500 to $5,000' (aimadefor, Jul 2026 [244] [unverified against Clio]); a one-time $399 Grow set-up fee is 'optional for accounts with four or fewer users' (Costbench [245]).
- The closest published 'health check' is Jayva Global, a LEAP consultancy (Boston, Manchester, Cumbria, Dublin, Auckland): 'Are you wasting your software investment? Don't let your LEAP system drift!'; covers 'Underused features and tools', 'Data quality, reporting and operational visibility', 'Consistency across teams and departments' and 'Legal accounting processes and compliance controls'; 'quick wins and a clear roadmap'; no price or duration (Jayva [246]).
- LEAP's UK certified-partner directory lists only **12 partners (7 consultancies, 3 bookkeepers, 2 IT firms)**; certification 'can be finished within 2 weeks', after which 'LEAP refers new clients to you' (LEAP partner directory [247]; LEAP Partner Network [248]).
- Filevine runs a formal Certified Implementation Partner tier with a published partner rate card: Sprint packages for 1-20 users at **$1,750 to $7,500**, Launch packages at **$12,500 to $32,500** over 4-6 months, and 'Reporting setup', Workato and LOIS automation modules at **$2,500 each** (Oktopeak, Oct 2026 [233] quoting Vineskills [249]).
- Upwork shows the same demand at freelance prices: a Clio dashboard and automation developer post at $15-$35 an hour, 'Filevine Developer – Workflow Optimization & Dashboard Development', a firm seeking 'a primary administrator for FileVine', a '27 Best Freelance Clio Specialists' hire page (Upwork automation job [59]; Upwork Filevine developer job [250]); employment benchmarks put a 'Filevine Administrator' at $45 an hour and Filevine-tagged jobs at an average $26.34 an hour (Built In [251]; ZipRecruiter [252]).
- Fiverr lists Clio set-up gigs at $10 to $75 with scopes such as 'custom legal intake forms and workflows, calendar, tasks, and document automation' and 'matter creation workflows, automatic task assignments'; some sellers 'describe themselves as law students or early-level sellers' (Fiverr Clio automation [57] snippet).

Table 6.2 Consultant and freelance price points

Consultant or freelance price point	Figure	Source
Clio third-party live training	$150-$300 per hour	aimadefor [244] 3p, unverified
Clio data migration (third party)	$500-$5,000	aimadefor [244] 3p
Clio Grow account set-up fee	$399 one-time (optional for 4 or fewer users)	Costbench [245]
Filevine partner Sprint (1-20 users, about 2 weeks)	$1,750-$7,500 (list $2,500-$7,500)	Oktopeak / Vineskills [233]
Filevine partner Launch (4-6 months, migration)	$12,500-$32,500	same
Filevine reporting set-up / Workato / LOIS module	$2,500 each	same
Filevine implementation complaints	"$60,000 upfront for services and add-ons that were never used"	SoftwareFinder [253] user, Jun 2025
Filevine administrator (employment)	$45/hour; Filevine-tagged jobs average $26.34/hour	Built In [251]; ZipRecruiter [252]
Upwork Clio automation and dashboard developer	$15-$35/hour	Upwork [59] snippet
Fiverr Clio set-up and automation gigs	$10, $15, $50, $75	Fiverr [57] snippet
Jayva LEAP health check (UK/US)	not priced; "isn't a major project"	Jayva [246]
Actionstep	per user plus implementation fees; certified partners by tier	Actionstep pricing [254]
Osprey (UK)	implementation and "unlimited" training bundled; 36-month term	Osprey [235] vendor
Access Legal (UK)	go-live "about one month"; "outsourced file audits" offered	Access Legal [236] vendor

UK: the audit function is split three ways

- Vendors (Access, Osprey, LEAP) bundle implementation, training and file audits; certified consultants sell implementation, training and workflow build; strategic consultancies such as Baskerville Drummond (independent reviews and system selection, consultants who 'have held board-level positions in law firms') and 3Kites ('65+ system selection engagements', 'No vendor bias') sell board-level reviews on bespoke quotes (Baskerville Drummond [255]; 3Kites [256]).
- A configuration-validation audit for a 1-30 lawyer firm sits between the certified-consultant and strategic tiers and was not clearly occupied by anyone fetched.

SECTION 7

The PI case-opening handoff: where cases "slip through the cracks"

The practitioner checklists converge on one opening sequence and one set of failure points, and the control point they name is the transfer from intake to the case manager. Every checklist assumes the firm already knows every provider; none has a step that reconciles the provider list against what the records mention.

The opening sequence the checklists converge on

- CASEpeer (updated September 2026): gather client information and screen against acceptance criteria; sign the retainer; execute HIPAA and records-release authorisations; open the claim and enter client, incident and insurance details; letter of representation to all known insurers 'within 24 to 48 hours'; identify the statute of limitations and calendar it immediately; request the police report; preserve evidence; spoliation letters; identify witnesses; pull policy limits; track treatment and flag gaps; 'request records and bills from every provider and log them as they arrive'; check Medicare and Medicaid; check in with the client about every 14 days; identify every lienholder and request itemised lien statements early because 'they often take weeks to arrive'; run a 30/60/90-day audit of SOL calendared, records current and lien statements outstanding. The checklist 'does not include a separate medical provider list step' and 'does not assign owners to these steps' (CASEpeer [121] vendor).
- Oregon's PLF adds the employment and tax authorisation, Medicare and Medicaid notice, uninsured-motorist notice in 'phantom vehicle' cases, records 'including treatment prior to the litigated incident', 'a reminder well in advance of the timeline', and 'have someone assigned to screen incoming mail for calendaring needs BEFORE the mail is distributed' (OSB PLF PI checklist [206]; OSB PLF docketing [239]).
- Lawyers Mutual: an intake checklist should capture 'important dates and deadlines', 'someone should be responsible for making sure it happens', and 'client intake is too important to leave to chance' (Lawyers Mutual NC, 29 Sep 2026 [257]).

The failure points, in practitioners' own words

> A PI case 'most often fails because a lien wasn't tracked, a treatment gap went unexplained, or a statute of limitations deadline slipped through the cracks during a handoff'; unexplained treatment gaps are 'one of the fastest ways to lose value'
>
> CASEpeer [121] vendor

> Providers 'may overlook requests if not reminded'; 'transcription mistakes, missing pages, or misfiled documents' compromise evidence
>
> CASEpeer medical records, Sep 2026 [258] vendor

> 'Every provider has slightly different authorization requirements'; 'a missing field or expired date gets your record request rejected and might even reset the clock entirely'; 'fax-dependent workflows add days'; common gaps on receipt are missing billing records, missing imaging pages and reports cut off mid-document
>
> CloudLex [122] vendor

> 'A rejected authorization resets the clock'; late requests are 'the most common source of preventable delays'
>
> ChartRequest [259] vendor, snippet

> 'Chasing medical records' is 'the most failure-prone phase of pre-lit'; 'if a client is calling you for a status update, you've already failed'; 'send the demand too early and you cap the case at yesterday's bills'
>
> Finch guides [260] vendor

> Files fall 'through the cracks because nothing has happened to create any activity on the file'
>
> OSB PLF tickler [238]

> 'Medical records, bills, and other documents are essential to the case but hard to track down'; the report exists because tracking requests 'matter by matter' fails
>
> Smokeball, Jan 2023 [261] vendor

The open sub-problem: the provider list itself

- Every checklist assumes the firm already knows every provider; none has a step that says 'reconcile the provider list against the providers, referrals and facilities named inside the records and bills that have arrived'.
- Vendors cluster around the adjacent problem, 'missing records' (a known provider's records have not come) or a chronological 'treatment gap'; **none of the eight vendor pages read claims to detect a provider referenced in received records that was never requested**.
- EvenUp: 'Recover $1,500 in missing documents on average before case value drops', a 'missing docs check', care timelines, treatment-gap flags, 'about 20% of missed appointments going unnoticed without the product', Communication Agents that automate 'record follow-ups'; missing providers 'not mentioned' (EvenUp [262]; EvenUp Medical Management [263] vendor).
- Supio: chronologies find 'missing documents' and 'missing bills', 'proactively spot case signals, like gaps or opportunities', 'human subject matter experts verify every chronology'; the Case Review Agent 'shows which information is present and which still needs to be collected from the client'; missing providers 'not addressed' (Supio chronologies [264]; Supio March 2026 [209] vendor).
- Finch, a service rather than software: requests records 'in parallel with treatment', reports '14-day average time to records and 80% received within 30 days', '94% first-pass completeness' and a '94-day median time to demand'; 'says nothing about detecting new referrals or additional providers inside received records' (Finch [195] vendor).
- Eve: '1200+ firms', nightly audits for 'buried injuries, treatment gaps', agents 'chasing records' (Eve Legal [265] vendor). Wisedocs (insurer and defence customers): flags 'missing records', 'provider recurrence' and 'High-Risk Providers' (Wisedocs [266] vendor). DigitalOwl: '97% or higher' accuracy, 'up to 72% reduction in review time' for insurers (DigitalOwl [267] vendor).
- No vendor publishes a price; all are 'case-based' or 'per case'. No independent review of any of them could be read (G2, Capterra and TrustRadius blocked), so every figure is vendor-authored or a vendor-selected testimonial.

Table 7.1 PI vendors: claims, crash report, provider detection, pricing, reviews

Vendor	What it claims (vendor pages)	Police / crash report	Detects provider named in records but never requested	Pricing	Independent reviews read
EvenUp	"2,000+ PI firms"; carrier-calling intake agents ("5x more claims"); "$1,500 in missing documents" recovered on average; treatment gaps; "missing docs check"; "cut 9+ hours of manual work per case"; Lerner & Rowe: "42 hours saved per case manager in demand preparation"	Not mentioned	Not mentioned	"Case-Based Pricing", no figures	None (blocked); customer quotes only
Supio	Instant Liens classifies liens from the file; Case Review Agent extracts incident facts and flags what is still missing from the client; chronologies find "missing documents" and "missing bills"; "437 hours across six cases"	Not mentioned	"not addressed"	None published	None (blocked)
Finch (service)	24/7 bilingual intake; "14 days to records"; "94% first-pass completeness"; "94-day median time to demand"; "43% average lien reduction"; "no per-record fee"	"Get it first" advice only	"says nothing" about it	Per-case, no figures	None shown
Eve	"1200+ firms"; intake agent "signs the client before the call ends"; nightly "Auditor" for treatment gaps; agents "chasing records"; "15-30% higher settlements"	Not mentioned	Not mentioned	None published	G2 4.9 claimed by vendor
Wisedocs	Insurer/IME/defence medical review; flags missing records, provider recurrence, treatment gaps; "Under $500" per case from "$8,000+" (one defence firm)	Not mentioned	Not claimed (provider recurrence is different)	None published	None
DigitalOwl (Datavant)	"97% or higher" precision; "up to 72%" review-time cut; "Self-Serve for Legal" under 30,000 pages a month	Not mentioned	Not mentioned	None published	None

Vendor	What it claims (vendor pages)	Police / crash report	Detects provider named in records but never requested	Pricing	Independent reviews read
CASEpeer	Medical Treatment Tab with provider history and liens; "automated follow-ups"; "Automated Statute Alerts"; 50+ reports on Pro	Checklist step only	"not mentioned"	$90 / $130 / $160 per user/month	Vendor cites Capterra 4.8, G2 4.7, 400+ reviews
Filevine	LOIS agents "proves what wasn't found" (general); MedChron summaries; "40M+ matters"	Not mentioned	Not claimed	Quote only	Users: MedChron "entries from the early 1900s" (Aug 2026)
CloudLex	Managed records retrieval "no portals, no uploads"; daily mail indexing; Lexee intake with human sign-off	Not mentioned	Not mentioned	None published	None
Case Status	Client app; "up to 80% of routine client communication is handled automatically"; "600+ firms"	Not mentioned	Not mentioned	None published	"4.9 from 50k+ ratings" claimed by vendor

Sources: EvenUp [262]; EvenUp Medical Management [263]; EvenUp Lerner & Rowe [208]; Supio [268]; Supio chronologies [264]; Finch [195]; Eve [265]; Wisedocs [266]; DigitalOwl [267]; CASEpeer pricing [230]; Filevine [269]; TrustRadius Filevine [270]; CloudLex [212]; Case Status [271]. All rows are vendor claims unless marked.

What a daily 'missing-task' check on a PI practice would have to test

Read together, the checklists give this list; none of the systems in section 6 produces it natively.

- retainer signed; HIPAA and employment authorisations on file;
- letter of representation sent to every known insurer within 48 hours;
- statute of limitations and any tort-claim-notice date entered with an advance reminder;
- police report requested and version checked; policy limits requested; spoliation letters sent;
- Medicare, Medicaid and uninsured-motorist notices sent;
- every provider on the list with a request date, a follow-up date inside the firm's interval and a received date;
- lien statements requested; last client contact within 14 days;
- no matter without a next reminder date within 60 days.

The insurer data frames all of this as a growing 'administrative error' risk, not an IT project; the control point both CASEpeer ('during a handoff') and the PLF ('double-checking of all entries') name is the transfer from intake to the case manager.

SECTION 8

Filevine versus Clio, Lead Docket versus Clio Grow

The two products sell to different buyers; the overlap zone is the 5-30 lawyer PI firm. Clio publishes a starting price and hides the rest; Filevine publishes nothing and sells implementation through partners. User complaints about Clio have been stable for seven years and shifted in 2026 toward commercial behaviour; Filevine's are mostly delivery and people problems.

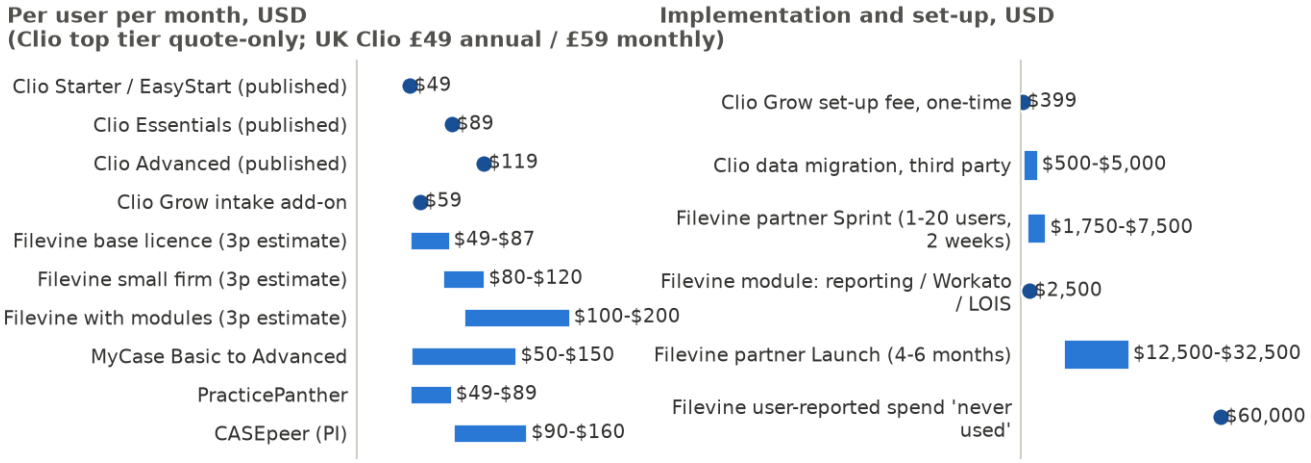
Different buyers

- Filevine has 'historically' sold to 'mid-sized plaintiff firms' with a focus on 'high-volume plaintiff practices', had about 3,400 customers in mid-2024 and 'nearly 6,000' by September 2025, ARR estimated at $250 million (Sacra, May 2026 [272] 3p estimate). Lawyerist: 'personal-injury firms and other process-oriented practices will likely find the best results with Filevine'; it 'needs more setup effort than many competitors' and is 'probably more than solo practices need' (Lawyerist Filevine [273]); a 2026 review says it is not for 'solo and 2-3 attorney firms starting out' or 'firms with limited time for onboarding', and implementation 'is a multi-week project (4-12 weeks) requiring partners' (Dupple, May 2026 [274] 3p).
- Clio Manage 'is a good fit for most solo to medium-sized firms' (Lawyerist Clio [215]), crossed **$500 million ARR in May 2026**, serves 'hundreds of thousands of legal professionals in 130+ countries' (Sacra [272]), and added a Personal Injury add-on in October 2023 'specifically designed for a PI lawyer's distinct workflows' (LawNext, 9 Oct 2023 [275]).
- Switching stories concentrate in the overlap: a 10-staff Connecticut PI firm moved from 'Dropbox and Clio' because 'I remember having a lot of frustration with Clio and thinking "This really isn't for injury firms"' (Filevine case study [276] vendor); a Capterra reviewer who moved from Clio called the Filevine rollout 'absolute chaos', 'went live before the system was finished' and 'wished they'd stayed with Clio' (Capterra Filevine p2 [277] user, snippet, undated).

Real pricing is harder to pin down than either website suggests

- A price tracker logged Clio EasyStart at $49, Essentials $89 and Advanced $119 per user per month (annual) in June 2026, with the top tier, Clio Grow, Manage AI and the PI add-on all 'Contact'; it recorded a Q2 2025 rise (EasyStart $39 to $49, up 25.6%), the removal of a 25% first-year discount in Q3 2025, prices hidden behind contact buttons from 23 March 2026, and a rename to Starter / Core / Signature / Elite on 5 August 2026 (PricingSaaS Clio [225] 3p tracker).
- Clio Grow is '$59/user/month', 'not available with Clio's EasyStart plan' and included only on the top tier (Lawyerist Clio Grow [278]); 'Clio does not publish a way to buy Clio Grow without Clio Manage' (Layer3Labs, 22 Sep 2026 [279]). Payments about 2.9% plus $0.30 per card transaction; e-signatures capped at 3 a month on EasyStart and 15 on Essentials (Costbench Clio [280] 3p); two-way texting for Grow leads needs a third-party app at $35 or $139 a month (Clio app directory, Falkon [281]; Text Request [282]).
- The commercial edge in users' words: 'charging me $2,842/yr for two seats' (TrustRadius [218] user, 9 Aug 2024); 'They renewed 4 licenses that I had inactive and would not refund after being a customer for over 10 years' (Trustpilot [240] user, 30 Jun 2026); the 34% per-user rise (section 6). In the UK Clio sells at **£49 per user per month annual or £59 monthly with 'no contract'** (Clio UK vs LEAP [283] vendor).
- Filevine 'does not post prices on the website' and sells AI analysis, demand drafting, document management, lead management and e-signatures as separate add-ons (Lawyerist Filevine [273]); third-party estimates: '$49 to $87 per user per month' base, '$80-$120' small firms, '$100-$200' with modules, onboarding '$1,000-$10,000+', Lead Docket text lines '$20 per month per text line number', automations '$100 per 500 actions per user per month beyond 500', data kept only 30 days after termination (Oktopeak, 2 Oct 2026 [233]; Dupple [274] 3p).
- Oktopeak's worked example for a 15-user firm over three years: **$32,710 to $64,480 before LOIS AI, Lead Docket and renewal increases** (Oktopeak [233]). Two reviewers in 2025 reported '$60,000' spent on Filevine services, one saying 'Nothing was deployed to production' (SoftwareFinder [253] user, Jun and Jul 2025); a 2023 reviewer who 'tried to buy out my three year contract' was 'threatened with arbitration in Ohio by their legal department' (Lawyerist Filevine [273] user, 28 Sep 2023). One hard public number: Marin County, California pays **$67,944 a year** for a three-year Filevine subscription with no auto-renewal (CivicIQ [284]).

Clio publishes $49 to $119 per user per month and hides the top tier; Filevine is quote-only (estimates $80 to $200) and sells implementation through partners at $1,750 to $32,500



Sources: PricingSaaS Clio tracker Jun-Aug 2026 [225] (3p); Lawyerist Clio Grow [278]; Oktopeak Oct 2026 quoting Vineskills [233]; Dupple [274] (3p); aimadefor [244] (3p, unverified); Costbench [245]; CASEpeer pricing [230]; MyCase and PracticePanther via Lawyerist [227] [229]; SoftwareFinder user review Jun 2025 [253].

Table 8.1 Cost items, Clio against Filevine

Cost item	Clio	Filevine	Source
Base licence, per user per month	$49 (Starter/EasyStart); $89; $119; top tier quote-only (Jun-Aug 2026); UK £49 annual / £59 monthly	Not published; estimates $49-$87 base, $80-$120 small firm, $100-$200 with modules	PricingSaaS [225]; Clio UK [283]; Oktopeak [233]; Dupple [274]
Intake / CRM	Clio Grow $59/user/month add-on; not on lowest tier; included on top tier only; $399 set-up	Lead Docket "Starting Price: USD 300.00" per feature (listing) or custom quote; $20 per text line; 1,000 SMS and 300 voice minutes per number	Lawyerist Grow [278]; Software Advice Lead Docket [285]; Lead Docket support [286] snippet
AI	Manage AI (ex-Duo) add-on, quote; a blog lists Duo bundles at $119/$149/$179 [unverified]; users report forced enrolment	LOIS packages priced per project; three AI chats per user per month by default; MedChron only in LOIS Expert	PricingSaaS [225]; aimadefor [244]; Sacra [272]
Automation	Native workflows on Advanced tier and above; Zapier extra	Workato-based credits, "$100 per 500 actions per user per month beyond 500" 3p	Clio help [216]; Oktopeak [233]
Payments	about 2.9% + $0.30 per card transaction; 1% ACH 3p	Vinesign retainer payment; Filevine Payments (no rate seen)	Costbench [280]
E-signature	3/month on EasyStart, 15/month on Essentials; HelloSign in Grow	Vinesign stand-alone; Solo plan 30 documents/month (price not captured)	Costbench [280]; Vinesign [287]
Implementation	migration $500-$5,000, training $150-$300/hour 3p; "sink or swim"	partner Sprint $1,750-$7,500; Launch $12,500-$32,500; users report $60,000	aimadefor [244]; Oktopeak [233]; SoftwareFinder [253]
Contract	monthly or annual; UK "no contract"; renewals of inactive seats reported	annual standard; three-year contracts reported; data kept 30 days after exit	Trustpilot [240]; Lawyerist Filevine [273]
Worked example	5-10 users on Core/Signature with Grow, AI and payments: roughly $150-$200/user/month plus 3% of card volume (researcher's inference)	15 users, 3 years: $32,710-$64,480 before AI and intake add-ons	Oktopeak [233]
Public-sector contract	not seen	Marin County $67,944/year, 3 years, no auto-renew	CivicIQ [284]

What each solves well, in users' words

- Clio's praise clusters on money and speed to value: 'billing, time tracking, and centralized matter workflows are commonly highlighted wins' and 'ease of use and fast onboarding' (rfp.wiki Clio [288] 3p aggregator); 'Their support is second to none' (Lawyerist [215] user, Mar 2018); 'I love how I can streamline the intake process in Clio Grow and then hand off the client seamlessly' (Capterra Clio [289] user, 2024, snippet); 'Pricing seems quite fair and reasonable to me' (Trustpilot [240] user, 23 Aug 2026).
- Filevine's praise clusters on case control: 'Filevine feels more like a living/breathing system, that helps move cases forward', 'nothing is as customizable as Filevine', 'DOCUMENT GENERATION!' (Lawyerist Filevine [273] users, Mar 2020); 'the fact that I can do all aspects of case management from one platform' (Capterra Filevine [290] user, snippet); in August 2026 the 'report builder and report generation, including real-time updates', letter generation, 'medical summaries and chronologies' and task tracking (TrustRadius Filevine [270] users, Aug 2026).

What users say Clio does not solve (stable for seven years)

Table 8.2 Dated Clio complaints

Date	Reviewer	What Clio does not solve (quote)	Source
5 Jan 2020	Attorney (Lawyerist)	Templates only pull matter fields, not contact fields, "which made medical records requests hard to generate for multiple providers"	Lawyerist [215]
25 May 2022	Senior bookkeeper, 1-10 family firm	"Reports are lousy. Customization limited. Have to export to Excel to sort."; "Inflexible bill formatting"	TrustRadius [218]
20 Jul 2022	Senior partner, 11-50 firm	"Clio does not allow a 'User' custom field."; "does not allow you to create custom fields that are 'lists' or 'collections'."; trust accounting "does not allow for sub accounts"; Grow intake "does not have an API"	TrustRadius [218]
17 Aug 2022	Lawyerist user	WealthCounsel intake-form integration "never worked"	Lawyerist [215]
1 Jun 2023	Partner, 51-200 firm	"Document content searching"; "Narrowing document name searching" listed as cons	TrustRadius [218]
6 Nov 2023	TrustRadius user	"extremely poor integration with accounting software (Quickbooks)"	TrustRadius [218]
9 Aug 2024	1-10 firm	iPhone contact and calendar sync broken; support "advised stopping iPhone use for contacts"; "$2,842/yr for two seats"	TrustRadius [218]
26 Nov 2024	TrustRadius user	"Lead organization in Clio Grow should not be separate from Clio Manage."	TrustRadius [218]
7 Aug 2025	1-10 firm (litigation, PI, family)	"No conditional logic in task assignments."; "Basic notification system with limited real-time updates."	TrustRadius [218]
11 Jul 2026	Trustpilot user	"Its basically sink or swim, based on your own level of accounting knowledge"	Trustpilot [240]
31 Jul 2026	Trustpilot user	The AI "spewed details of 'my' Chancery court case, two imaginary offspring"	Trustpilot [240]
6 Aug 2026	Trustpilot user	"I virtually cannot click on a matter, document, or note, without getting intrusive advertisements"	Trustpilot [240]
15 Aug 2026	Trustpilot user	"The sync function with QBO is horrible. Support is not much better."; "over a thousand sync errors, duplicate invoices during migration"	Trustpilot [240]
17 Aug 2026	Trustpilot user	"Grow and manage do not work together at all"; "We got a 34% increase in per month per user increase two months ago"	Trustpilot [240]
28 Aug and 4 Sep 2026	Trustpilot users	"Forced me to use an AI system and then required me to jump through hoops to remove it."; "it automatically enrolled our firm, and apparently all users, in its AI platform"	Trustpilot [240]
9 Sep 2026	Trustpilot user	Cancellation "forces you to call and you wait on hold forever"; "the migration help was lacking"	Trustpilot [240]
19 Sep 2026	Trustpilot user	"the reporting is not remotely close to be as great as they say"; "I talk to CLIO support more than my own mother"	Trustpilot [240]

Overall scores: Capterra 4.7 from about 1,740 reviews, G2 about 4.6-4.7, TrustRadius 8.1/10 from 117, Trustpilot 3.6 from 297 (rfp.wiki [288]; Trustpilot [240]); the Trustpilot page skews negative by self-selection.

What users say Filevine does not solve (delivery, people, reports, AI quality)

Table 8.3 Dated Filevine complaints

Date	Reviewer	What Filevine does not solve (quote)	Source
Nov 2018	Lawyerist user	"the worst practice software I have EVER encountered ... takes eons to set up and even THEN it didn't work"	Lawyerist Filevine [273]
Sep 2022	Lawyerist user	"paid Filevine ALOT of money just to be handed a product that in my opinion was not functional"	Lawyerist Filevine [273]
28 Sep 2023	Ryan L.	"I tried to buy out my three year contract, but they refused"; "threatened with arbitration in Ohio"	Lawyerist Filevine [273]
Jul 2024	SoftwareFinder user	"Works best with fast internet and small files"	SoftwareFinder [253]
Nov 2024	SoftwareFinder user	"Rarely reaches Filevine staff directly. Support refers feature questions to third-party vendors"	SoftwareFinder [253]
Jan 2025	SoftwareFinder user	"Unanswered emails and repeated account manager changes"; "charged for modules canceled years earlier"	SoftwareFinder [253]

Date	Reviewer	What Filevine does not solve (quote)	Source
May 2025	1-10 firm	"useless for immigration cases"; "They never responded to our problems"	SoftwareFinder [253]
Jun 2025	11-50 firm	"charged us $60,000 upfront for services and add-ons that were never used. Nothing was deployed to production"	SoftwareFinder [253]
Jul 2025	11-50 firm	Calendar "forces use of Outlook"; "lacks a basic Save As function"; "Spent over $60,000"	SoftwareFinder [253]
Aug-Sep 2025	SoftwareFinder users	"upsold implementation"; "you cannot even try a demo first"; built "for lawyers, not investigators"	SoftwareFinder [253]
14 Aug 2026	TrustRadius user	"AI cannot read nursing home records (PointClickCare, Matrix)"; OCR "through Adobe first"; UI changes throw "everyone into a tailspin"	TrustRadius p2 [291]
17 Aug 2026	11-50 firm (6/10)	"There are way too many choices when it comes to report building and there is no easy way to decipher what does what"; "Lack of training from Filevine"; "Constant turnover of account managers"; "Filevine doesn't need to log you out every day"	TrustRadius p2 [291]
18 Aug 2026	PI firm; finance director	"The reports generated could be more user friendly and maybe allow date ranges"; "Reporting doesn't always structure the way we need to"; "Medchron is too slow ... takes up to 72 hrs"; "we have to do most of it ourselves based on tutorials found online"; "It should have a mobile app"	TrustRadius [270]; p2 [291]
26 Aug 2026	TrustRadius user	High cost "especially with fax, Lead Docket, and AI add-ons"; wants "a mobile phone app"	TrustRadius p2 [291]
28 Aug 2026	TrustRadius user	"the med chron has messed up the dates before and had entries from the early 1900s"; "the AI tool has cited to defense letters from adjustor to support a finding"	TrustRadius [270]
30 Sep 2026	TrustRadius user	LOIS "tends to over-markup documents even when only asking for high level / major issues"; "playbooks don't adapt well if the document template is different"	TrustRadius [270]

- Overall scores: Capterra 4.4 from about 286, G2 4.6-4.7 from about 300, TrustRadius 8.4/10 from 76, Lawyerist 4.3 editorial with cons 'Complex', 'Basic Task Management', 'No Client Portal' (rfp.wiki Filevine [292]; Lawyerist Filevine [273]).
- Non-PI users say the templates assume plaintiff litigation ('useless for immigration cases'; built 'for lawyers, not investigators'), that billing and QuickBooks depth lag (Capterra Filevine [290] snippet), and that there was no native client portal (the partner directory lists CaseStatus) (Filevine partners [293]); Filevine added timekeeping, invoicing and payments in 2023 for 'non-contingency practices such as criminal defense, family law, bankruptcy, estate, immigration and corporate law' (Filevine news [294] vendor).
- PI users on Clio historically lacked provider tracking, lien tables and settlement maths, now in the paid PI add-on with provider cards in a 'Medical records subtab' and an 'Other liens table' on the 'Settlement subtab', 'not available for all Clio subscription plans' (Clio help 18350703919899 [295] vendor, snippet), and still lack repeating fields and contact-based templates; Lawyerist's Grow verdict is 'Not for PI Intake' (Lawyerist Grow [278]).

Clio Grow versus Lead Docket: a general intake add-on against a PI-grade intake system

- Grow: custom intake forms with 'conditional logic to adapt questions based on prior answers', a Kanban pipeline, HelloSign e-signature on engagement letters 'autofilled with intake data', conflict checks across Grow and Manage, a scheduler and source attribution (Clio online intake forms [296] vendor; Layer3Labs [279]).
- But its text message 'is a no-reply notification, and your client cannot respond to it' (Clio help 14164457325595 [297] vendor, snippet); 'follow-up sequences are linear (not branching)' and 'reporting on pipeline stage conversion is basic' (Layer3Labs intake roundup, Jul 2026 [298] 3p, snippet); the form builder could not link Dropdown, Contact Select, Email, Integer, Money or Website custom fields to questions as of 2022 (Clio Cloud Conference 2022 PDF [299]); users: 'the reports are not accurate', 'when booking consultations for repeat callers, Grow duplicates the contact. There isn't an easy way to merge' (G2 Clio Grow [300] user, snippet); 'you cannot delete contacts in bulk in Clio Grow' (Clio Grow data import [301] snippet).
- Lead Docket captures leads 'through web forms, web chat, text, or call service', works with answering services and call-tracking numbers, tracks referral partners, reports 'Revenue by marketing source, conversion rates, lead volume over time, referral fees', runs two-way SMS on firm numbers (1,000 texts and 300 voice minutes a month each), assigns Vinesign signature tasks by lead status with a retainer payment attached, and maps lead status to Filevine phases, though phase mapping 'has to be enabled by Lead Docket support first' (Lead Docket features [302]; Phase Mapping [303]; Vinesign article [304] vendor, snippets).

- Its public complaints are sparse: 'some clients can get past mandatory fields without issue, leaving the firm chasing vital information' (Software Advice AU [305] user, snippet) and the add-on cost; it rates 4.9 on Capterra from 62 reviews but has '0 Reviews' of text on TrustRadius (Capterra CA compare [306]; TrustRadius Lead Docket [307]).

Table 8.4 Clio Grow against Lead Docket, feature by feature

Feature	Clio Grow	Lead Docket (Filevine)
Buyer	general solo-to-mid practice already on Clio Manage	PI and mass-tort firms on Filevine
Price	$59/user/month add-on; not on lowest tier; included on top tier; $399 set-up; not sold without Manage	"Starting Price: USD 300.00" per feature (listing) or custom quote; $20 per text line 3p; no standalone terms confirmed
Capture	website, email or text forms with conditional questions; after-hours AI answering vendor	web forms, web chat, text, call service, call-tracking numbers; custom intake scripts
Texting	one-way no-reply notifications; two-way only via Manage or a $35-$139/month app	two-way SMS on firm numbers; 1,000 SMS and 300 minutes per number per month
Follow-up automation	linear sequences; "not straightforward" (user)	automated messaging plus recurring staff tasks; conditional logic not mentioned
E-signature	HelloSign, retainer autofilled	Vinesign task assigned by status; retainer payment attached
Conflict check	across Grow and Manage	listed in release notes; mechanics not readable
Scheduling	Clio Scheduler with text reminders	none found on features page
Reporting	source and channel attribution; users: "reports are not accurate"	revenue by source, conversion, lead volume, referral fees, exportable
Hand-off	conversion to Manage drops related contacts and several fields if sync was off; template workflow can fire on conversion	status-to-phase mapping into Filevine projects; enabled by support
Data hygiene	duplicates repeat callers; no merge; no bulk delete	mandatory fields bypassable (user)
API	Grow intake "does not have an API" (Jul 2022)	not assessed

The UK mirror: Clio UK against LEAP, where the gap is contract and exit terms

- LEAP serves 'over 26,000 legal professionals from more than 2,700 UK law firms' (Law Society LEAP offer [308]), rates 4.2 on Capterra UK against Clio's 4.7 (Capterra UK compare [309]).
- 2026 UK reviews: 'Leap makes it purposefully difficult for you to move data around' (29 Sep 2026), '1 person covering support for the whole of the UK' (20 Jul 2026), 'Annual prices increases, very expensive and very little help' (3 Jun 2026), 'once you signed up your trapped' (4 Mar 2026) (Trustpilot LEAP UK [310] users); a sole practitioner 'tied in for 3 yrs' could not get client files back (Software Advice FR LEAP [311] user, snippet).

Six needs recur in the reviews of both products

Both vendors sell that layer back as add-ons, partners or AI, which is why consultants, Zapier and spreadsheets persist on both sides.

Table 8.5 Gaps common to Clio and Filevine

Gap common to Clio and Filevine	Clio evidence	Filevine evidence
Management reporting without Excel	"Have to export to Excel to sort." (May 2022); Grow "reports are not accurate"; custom reports gated to Advanced tier	"no easy way to decipher what does what" (Aug 2026); partner sells "Reporting setup" at $2,500; Fusion needs vendor enablement
Conditional or date-driven automation without a consultant	"No conditional logic in task assignments." (Aug 2025); no custom-field triggers in Zapier	Workato credits metered; $2,500 automation modules; phase removal deletes auto-tasks permanently
Two-way texting inside the system	Grow texts are no-reply; $35-$139/month apps	Lead Docket numbers are a separate metered line
Clean contact data	Grow duplicates repeat callers, no merge, no bulk delete; Zapier users build matching rules	merge is irreversible; migration needs unique IDs in spreadsheets
Predictable total cost	34% rise (Aug 2026); inactive licences renewed (Jun 2026); AI auto-enrolment (Aug-Sep 2026)	$60,000 services never deployed (Jun 2025); charged for cancelled modules (Jan 2025); three-year buy-out refused (Sep 2023)
Reliable support and stable account manager	"I talk to CLIO support more than my own mother" (Sep 2026); hold queues	"Constant turnover of account managers" (Aug 2026); "Support refers feature questions to third-party vendors" (Nov 2024)
AI output that can be trusted	AI "spewed details of 'my' Chancery court case, two imaginary offspring" (Jul 2026)	MedChron "entries from the early 1900s"; "cited to defense letters from adjustor" (Aug 2026)
Medical records handled in-system	PI add-on plan-gated; liens in a settlement table; templates cannot address multiple providers	Arctrieval and Codes Health partners; users OCR "through Adobe first"

Sources: TrustRadius Clio [218]; Trustpilot Clio [240]; G2 Clio Grow [300]; TrustRadius Filevine [270] and p2 [291]; SoftwareFinder Filevine [253]; Lawyerist Filevine [273]; Oktopeak [233]; Filevine support, phases [312]; Filevine partners [293]; Zapier community [313].

SECTION 9

Twelve service gaps, ranked by problem signal and vendor weakness

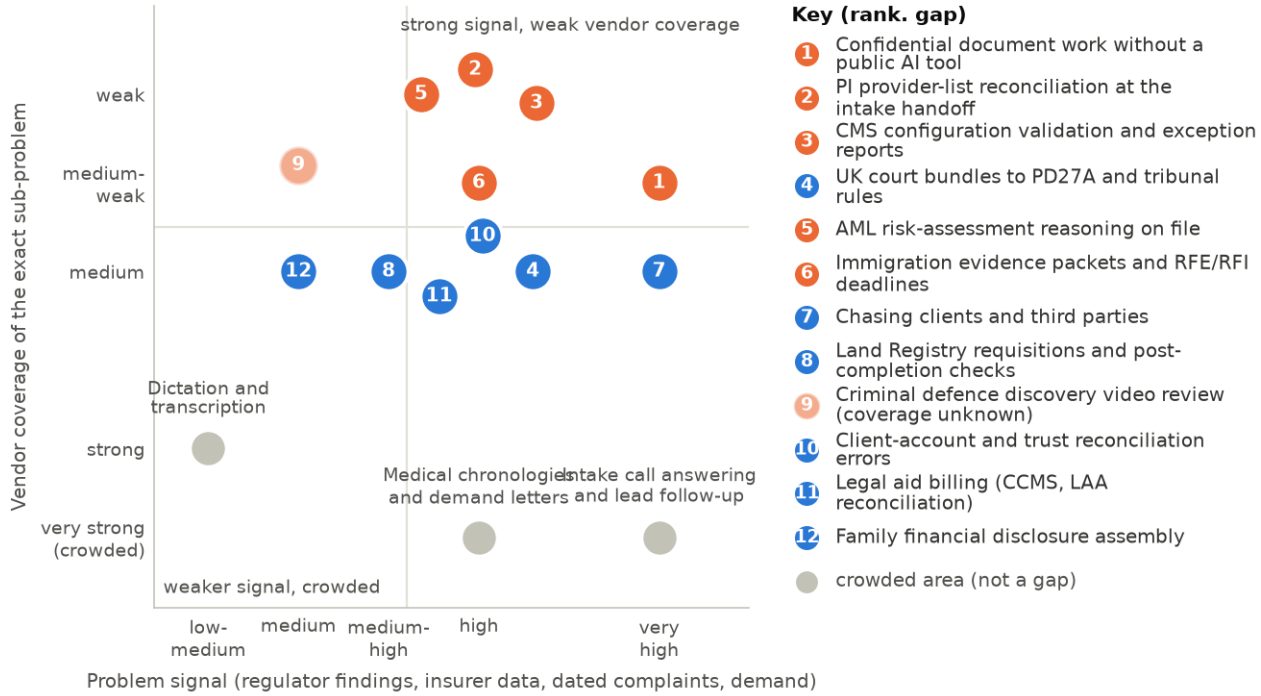
Each gap is scored on two things: how strong and how recent the problem signal is (regulator findings, insurer claims data, dated user complaints, job-ad and freelance demand), and how weak the vendor coverage is (whether a named product claims to solve the exact sub-problem and whether any independent review confirms it). A third column marks fit with a self-hosted or private-data angle, strongest where the work touches client files that regulators say must not leave the firm.

Table 9.1 The ranking, with the three crowded problems at the end

#	Gap	Problem signal	Vendor coverage of the exact sub-problem	Self-hosted / private-data fit	Country	Automatable
1	Confidential document work (summarise, draft, improve) without a public AI tool	Very high: tribunal rulings 2025-26, SRA warning notice, 42 reports, 59% shadow use	Medium-weak for small firms: Copilot needs permission work; CMS AI has forced-enrolment and hallucination complaints	Strongest	UK and US	Partly: human check required by law
2	PI provider-list reconciliation and records completeness at the intake handoff	High: "slipped through the cracks during a handoff"; PI 12.73% of claims; 4 requests per matter	Weak: eight vendors claim "missing records" or "gaps"; none claims providers named in records but never requested	Strong (PHI)	US (UK PI smaller)	Partly: extraction yes, requests and verification human
3	Case-management configuration validation and exception reports (Clio, LEAP, Filevine)	High: dated reviews 2020-2026; insurer: "technology is not a substitute for process"	Weak: no vendor documents required-field rules or overdue exception reports; consultants unpriced	Medium-strong (API pull into firm store)	UK and US	Fully for detection; human for configuration decisions
4	UK court bundles to PD27A and tribunal rules	High: costs orders, rejections, new 2026 rules, "court bundle software" searches	Medium: one free tool reported; no commercial product named in the notes	Strong (litigation files)	UK	Largely: pagination, OCR, bookmarks; selection human
5	AML risk-assessment reasoning and source-of-funds analysis on file	High: one-third non-compliant, 39% ineffective assessments, £565k+ fines	Weak on the reasoning: e-verification vendors stop at the ID result	Strong (financial data)	UK	Partly: drafting rationale; MLRO judgment human
6	Immigration evidence packets and RFE/RFI deadline tracking	High: RFI 15% to 49%; RFE 6-10 hours; the ChatGPT rulings were immigration firms	Medium-weak: one RFE vendor; Filevine "useless for immigration"	Strong (asylum data)	US and UK	Partly: deadlines and assembly; argument human
7	Chasing clients and third parties for documents and money	Very high: 43% of conveyancer time; Upwork posts; 84% want same-day replies	Medium: intake follow-up and client-app vendors cover reminders, all vendor-claimed	Medium	UK and US	Partly: reminders and missing-item lists; phone chasing human
8	Land Registry requisitions and post-completion checks	Medium-high: about 1m requisitions a year, over half avoidable [snippet]; 2-6 weeks each	Medium: forms automation and HMLR training; no pre-submission checker named	Medium	UK	Largely: cross-checks; signatures human
9	Criminal defence discovery video review	Medium: "tripled our workload"; data 2019-21 and public-sector only	Unknown: no small-firm vendor in the notes	Strong (evidence)	US (UK unsourced)	Partly: transcription and indexing; review duty human
10	Client-account and trust reconciliation errors and accounting sync	High: ILFM failure list; "over a thousand sync errors"; Rule 1.15 top-3 discipline	Strong on bookkeeping; weak on catching sync and reconciliation anomalies	Medium	UK and US	Partly: anomaly detection; sign-off human
11	Legal aid billing (CCMS, LAA contingency reconciliation, fee re-coding)	High but niche: fees frozen since 1996; 2025 outage; dummy identifiers	Medium: CMS vendors re-code; LAA systems external	Medium	UK	Partly: validation and reconciliation

#	Gap	Problem signal	Vendor coverage of the exact sub-problem	Self-hosted / private-data fit	Country	Automatable
12	Family financial disclosure assembly (Form E, financial affidavit)	Medium: "3.5+ hours" per affidavit [vendor], repeated; sanctions	Medium: one workflow vendor	Strong (financial statements)	UK and US	Partly: extraction and index; sworn accuracy human
crowded	Intake call answering and lead follow-up	Very high: 40% calls answered	Very strong: answering services, Supio, Eve, Lead Docket, CloudLex, EvenUp, Clio after-hours AI	Low	both	mostly automated already
crowded	Medical chronologies and demand letters	High	Very strong: EvenUp, Supio, Eve, Parrot/MedChron, Wisedocs, DigitalOwl, Finch	Medium	US	largely automated, quality complaints
crowded	Dictation and transcription	Low-medium: 7 of 40 UK ads	Strong: Dragon, Word, many	Medium (cloud-processing complaint)	both	automated

Gap map: the twelve gaps placed by problem signal against vendor weakness, using the report's own ranking words



Positions follow the wording of the ranking table in section 9 (very high / high / medium-high / medium signal; weak / medium-weak / medium / strong coverage), not measured scores. Warm = coverage weak or medium-weak; blue = medium; faded = coverage unknown; grey = the three crowded areas the report says are not gaps.

The twelve gap cards

Every card has the same eight fields in the same order. The three badges summarise the ranking table: problem signal (strong = very high or high), vendor coverage (weak = weak, medium-weak or unknown; partial = medium), and the report's own word on automation (fully, largely, partly).

1 Confidential document work without a public AI tool — UK and US

Problem signal: strong | **Vendor coverage:** weak | **Automatable:** partly

Problem	Staff need to summarise, draft and improve documents that contain client data (decision letters, client emails, grounds of appeal, medical and financial records), and the tools to hand are free public models that regulators and tribunals now treat as disclosure to a third party and a waiver of privilege. Firms either ban AI (and staff use it anyway) or have no policy.
Who has it	UK immigration, asylum, family and crime firms of 1-20 fee earners (the three 2025-26 tribunal cases were Manchester, Birmingham and East London immigration firms); US solos and 2-9 lawyer firms where 19% have an incident-response plan; any paralegal-heavy drafting practice. Both countries.
Evidence	Upper Tribunal: putting client emails and Home Office letters into ChatGPT is "to breach client confidentiality and waive legal privilege"; firms must "self-report and should consult the ICO" (Legal Futures, 24 Feb 2026 [153]). SRA warning notice 17-18 Aug 2026; 42 misuse reports Jul 2025-Jul 2026 (Legal Cheek [156] secondary; Lets Data Science [157] secondary). 59% of UK fee earners use unapproved tools; 68% of leaders think there is zero risk; 25% have AI in their CMS (Legal Futures / Access Legal [172] vendor survey). 12% of UK small firms use generative AI; barriers cost 25%, breach risk 15% (SRA [170]). US: 524 fabricated-citation instances in 2025, 97 monetary sanctions (MSBA [167] secondary); Heppner privilege waiver (WLF [165]); 52% no AI policy (LawNext [169]).
Their words	"put client emails ... into ChatGPT to improve them"; "uploaded Home Office decision letters to summarise them for clients"; "open" versus "closed" systems; "waive legal privilege"; "self-report"; "no mechanism by which staff at his firm could use AI"; "anyone with Google has access to AI"; "AI disconnected from the firm's work" (25% top pain vendor); "Do NOT include any client information"; "verify all AI-generated research". Search phrases: "can solicitors use chatgpt", "is chatgpt confidential and secure", "is paid chatgpt confidential", "is chatgpt enterprise confidential", "secure chatgpt for business", "chatgpt safe for work", "ai policy for solicitors", "ai guidance for solicitors", "ai software for solicitors", "chatgpt for lawyers free", "law firm ai automation".
How they handle it today	Juniors use free ChatGPT or "Google's AI mode" on client files; principals assume no one does; 74% of UK small firms research on free Google and 63% admit it is riskier; large firms issue warnings (21%); some firms switch on Microsoft 365 Copilot and discover permission "oversharing"; others ban AI, which "may push staff toward shadow tools".
Vendors already covering it	Microsoft 365 Copilot: closed tool, named by the tribunal as available "without these risks" tribunal, but "can share confidential information with unauthorized firm personnel if data permissions aren't appropriately established" (Intapp [175], large-firm case study). Clio Manage AI / Duo: document summaries "with citations" and drafts inside Clio vendor; users report being auto-enrolled and the AI inventing "two imaginary offspring" (Trustpilot [240] user, Jul-Sep 2026). Filevine LOIS: "over-markup", wrong dates (TrustRadius [270] user, Aug-Sep 2026). Smokeball Archie, LEAP Matter AI: vendor labels only. Lexis+ AI and Westlaw AI: 17-33% hallucination (Stanford). Fiverr: "$850" GPT-based "AI legal assistant" with "a custom RAG knowledge base" and generic RAG chatbots "from about $60" snippet.
Automatable?	Partly, with a mandatory human step. Summaries, first drafts and extraction can run on a closed or self-hosted model with sources cited, but Ayinde and the SRA notice require the qualified lawyer to check every authority and output against an authoritative source, and supervision of staff cannot be delegated to a tool.
What the reader would need to learn	UK GDPR and the SRA, BSB and Law Society AI guidance; ABA Formal Opinion 512 and the state opinions (California, Florida, Kentucky, New Jersey); how enterprise AI terms treat retention, training and processing location; retrieval with page-level citation to the firm's own documents; measuring hallucination on legal tasks; Copilot permission and sensitivity-label hygiene; the vocabulary of "open" versus "closed" tools so the offer matches the tribunal's language.

2 PI provider-list reconciliation and records completeness at the intake handoff

US (UK PI smaller)

Problem signal: strong | **Vendor coverage:** weak | **Automatable:** partly

Problem	At case opening the provider list is built from the client's memory and the first bills; records that arrive later name other providers, referrals, imaging centres and pharmacies that are never requested. The gap surfaces at demand time as a missing bill or at settlement as a surprise lien. No checklist has a "reconcile the provider list against what the records mention" step and no system assigns an owner to it.
Who has it	US plaintiff personal-injury firms of 1-30 lawyers on contingency, especially those bundling PI with workers' compensation and Social Security disability; to a smaller degree UK PI and clinical negligence firms (GP and hospital records, MedCo reports).
Evidence	A PI case "most often fails because a lien wasn't tracked, a treatment gap went unexplained, or a statute of limitations deadline slipped through the cracks during a handoff" (CASEpeer, Sep 2026 [121] vendor). About four record requests per matter, 1,600 a month at 400 new matters (YoCierge on Supio [125] vendor). "Every provider has slightly different authorization requirements"; "a missing field or expired date gets your record request rejected and might even reset the clock"; "Follow up. Then follow up again" (CloudLex [122] vendor). EvenUp claims "$1,500 in missing documents" recovered per case on average and "about 37% of issues needing follow-up" (EvenUp [263] vendor). Plaintiff PI is 12.73% of malpractice claims and administrative errors "nearly 25%" and rising (ALPS [120] secondary). Lien resolution adds 4-7 months and fees stay "inaccessible" (LegalFunding.com [124]). Oregon PLF: records "including treatment prior to the litigated incident" (OSB PLF [206]).
Their words	"missing records", "treatment gap", "records retrieval", "medical records follow-ups", "letters of representation", "HIPAA authorizations", "lien", "LOP" (letter of protection), "balance verification", "Keeps cases moving without being asked", "Documents everything", "Request and organize medical records and billing records". Job titles: "PI CASE MANAGER", "Records coordinator/Client coordinator", "Legal Records Retrieval & Client Services Specialist", "Senior Intake and Case Manager for Personal Injury Law Firm". Search phrases: "law firm intake automation", "legal document automation specialist", "law firm workflow automation"; Upwork: "Personal injury case management, client intake, medical records follow-ups, and letters of representation".
How they handle it today	A paralegal or case manager keeps the list in the CMS (CASEpeer treatment tab, Clio's PI add-on provider cards, Filevine sections) or in Excel, chases by fax, phone and portal, checks in with the client every 14 days, uses a retrieval service (Finch, YoCierge, Arctrieval, Codes Health) for known providers, and runs a 30/60/90-day audit if the firm has one; Smokeball built a "Global Document Request Report" because tracking "matter by matter" fails (Smokeball [261] vendor).
Vendors already covering it	EvenUp: care timelines, treatment gaps, "missing docs check", record follow-up agents; missing-provider detection not mentioned; no price; no independent reviews read vendor. Supio: "missing documents" and "missing bills" in chronologies, Case Review Agent flags what is still needed from the client; missing providers "not addressed"; no price vendor. Finch: service with "14 days to records", "94% first-pass completeness"; "says nothing" about providers found inside records vendor. Eve: nightly audit for "treatment gaps"; agents "chasing records" vendor. Wisedocs and DigitalOwl: insurer and defence side; "provider recurrence" is a different thing vendor. CASEpeer: treatment tab and automated follow-ups; "not mentioned" vendor. Clio PI add-on: provider cards with request status, plan-gated vendor, snippet. Filevine MedChron: users report wrong dates user.
Automatable?	Partly, with human steps. Extracting provider, facility and referral names from received records and bills and comparing them to the request log is a document-extraction job that can run on the firm's own files. The request itself needs a signed HIPAA authorisation per provider, provider-specific forms and often a fax; confirming that a named provider actually treated the client, and deciding whether a referral matters, needs a human call.
What the reader would need to learn	HIPAA authorisations and business-associate obligations; the PI pre-litigation sequence (CASEpeer and Oregon PLF checklists); how medical records are structured (face sheets, referral lines, billing codes); OCR and entity extraction on poor scans; the CMS data models for providers and liens (Clio PI add-on subtabs, Filevine sections, CASEpeer treatment tab); lien types (Medicare conditional payments, ERISA plans, hospital liens) and their timelines.

3 Case-management configuration validation and exception reports

UK and US

Problem signal: strong | **Vendor coverage:** weak | **Automatable:** fully

Problem	Clio (and LEAP, MyCase, PracticePanther) can apply a task list to a new matter and show a Kanban stage, but cannot enforce that required fields are filled, that every task has a named owner and due date, that overdue tasks are surfaced by owner, or that a matter with no next date is flagged. Firms set the system up "sink or swim", run on "institutional memory", and export to Excel to find out what is missing.
Who has it	1-30 lawyer firms on Clio (US, UK, Canada), LEAP (UK, 2,700 firms), MyCase and PracticePanther; PI and litigation firms most exposed because deadlines are the top malpractice cause; firms that bought Clio Grow and found it "does not work together" with Manage.
Evidence	"No conditional logic in task assignments." (TrustRadius [218] user, 7 Aug 2025); "Reports are lousy ... Have to export to Excel to sort." user, 25 May 2022; "the reporting is not remotely close to be as great as they say" (Trustpilot [240] user, 19 Sep 2026); "Its basically sink or swim" user, 11 Jul 2026. ALPS: "Routine errors, especially calendaring ... remain a primary cause of claims despite widespread adoption of legal technology"; "Software can't fix inconsistent routines" (ALPS [120]). PLF: no file tickled "for more than 60 days"; review every 30 days (OSB PLF [238]). Clio publishes only a correlation ("18 percent more likely to adopt key workflows") and no feature-usage base rate (PR Newswire [237] vendor). API: 50 requests a minute at peak, no webhooks page (Clio docs [223]); Zapier has no custom-field triggers (Zapier [210]). Grow-to-Manage conversion drops related contacts, matter status, assigned-to and tasks (Clio help [241] snippet). Upwork: Clio dashboard developer at $15-$35 an hour; "Filevine Developer – Workflow Optimization & Dashboard Development" (Upwork [59]). Filevine partner sells "Reporting setup" at $2,500 (Oktopeak [233]).
Their words	"Reports are lousy"; "export to Excel to sort"; "No conditional logic in task assignments"; "sink or swim"; "Grow and manage do not work together at all"; "duplicate invoices"; "triple entry"; "Don't let your LEAP system drift!"; "Underused features and tools"; "Data quality, reporting and operational visibility"; "dashboards that pull Clio data for leadership"; "primary administrator for FileVine"; "Technology is not a substitute for process"; "institutional systems" not "institutional memory". Search phrases: "law firm workflow automation", "law firm automation software", "law firm automation reddit", "clio automation" and "clio manage" (Fiverr category pages), "legal document automation specialist".
How they handle it today	Excel exports and pivot tables; Zapier or Make flows; Fiverr set-up gigs at $10-$75 often by "law students or early-level sellers" snippet; third-party Clio training at $150-$300 an hour 3p; Filevine partner modules at $2,500; weekly deadline-review meetings with two-person docket verification (insurer advice); post-it notes and "Excel worksheets" for client notes (TrustRadius [218] user, May 2022).
Vendors already covering it	Clio Certified Consultants (directory blocked; self-listed; "Clio doesn't review or guarantee any advisor's listing"); Big Mode, XPRTS, LawTech Partners, Apply Compliance Today (UK) vendor directory; Jayva Global's LEAP "health check" (the only public scope: under-used features, data quality, reporting, cross-team consistency, accounting controls; unpriced) (Jayva [246]); Law Right, Thinkwild (LEAP implementation); Uptime Legal ("workflow setup"); Affinity Consulting ("Comprehensive Practice Analysis"); Katchr (UK legal BI with "proactive alerts" vendor); Vineskills, Yessio (Filevine reports and fusions); Legalboards, Workload (task boards via Clio API). None publishes a price or a review; none documents a required-field or overdue-exception check.
Automatable?	Fully for the detection part: a nightly pull of matters, tasks, task templates, custom fields and calendar entries through the API into a store the firm controls, with rules such as "no open task", "no next date within 60 days", "letter of representation not logged within 48 hours", "SOL field empty", "task overdue by owner". Polling, not events, because no webhooks were found. The fix (which fields are required, who owns which task, the firm's follow-up intervals) is a human configuration decision, and malpractice insurers say the weekly human review must stay.
What the reader would need to learn	Clio Manage API v4 (OAuth, pagination, ETags, 50 requests a minute, no custom rate increases) and its data model (matters, tasks, task-template lists, custom fields, calendar entries, communications); Clio Grow limits (no API, no custom-field form links, linear sequences); Zapier and Make patterns and their blind spots; the Filevine API (token exchange, unpublished rate limits, "a success response doesn't guarantee a write landed" (Carly blog [314])); LEAP's certified-partner route (2 weeks to certify); the malpractice-insurer checklists (PLF 60-day and 30-day rules, Lawyers Mutual two-person verification); data-hygiene rules for duplicate contacts and QuickBooks sync; basic SQL and dashboarding.

4 UK court bundles to PD27A and tribunal rules

UK

Problem signal: strong	**Vendor coverage:** partial	**Automatable:** largely

Problem	E-bundles must be a single PDF with continuous computer pagination, OCR, bookmarks for every significant document, a hyperlinked index, correct file naming and size limits (50 MB on CE-File and the Upper Tribunal, 20 MB by email), with page caps on position statements, a fresh bundle for every hearing, the index agreed 7 working days out and the bundle lodged 5 working days out. Errors mean rejection, removal from the list or a costs order.
Who has it	UK litigation, family (financial remedy and children), immigration and employment practices of 1-20 fee earners without a dedicated litigation paralegal; litigants in person "come into this process not knowing what a bundle is".
Evidence	£20,000 costs order for a bundle "randomly thrown together"; relief refused where "IT problems, lack of support staff, and miscommunications" caused a missed deadline; judge: "dangerous to leave matters to the last minute" (Deka Chambers, Oct 2023 [29]). PD27A rewritten from 2 March 2026, "about twice the length", deadlines moved from 4 to 7 and 2 to 5 working days, "a new bundle is needed for each subsequent hearing", caps of 6/8/12/15 pages, costs sanctions (Resolution [83]; Financial Remedies Journal [84]). Upper Tribunal: non-compliant bundles "likely to be rejected" (EIN [88]). "It should be simple to prepare a bundle manually, but it's not"; free tool "saves up to an hour per bundle" (Legal Futures, Apr 2026 [111]). CE-File rejections "cannot be undone" (Judiciary.uk minutes [110]). Employment tribunal hearings listed into 2028 (more hearings, more bundles).
Their words	"not CPR compliant", "pagination", "booby-trapped bundle", "randomly thrown together", "lever-arch files containing hundreds of pages", "no less than three working days before the hearing", "Pagination must be continuous and consistent", "Bookmarked hearing bundles" (first duty in a freelance litigation paralegal ad), "CE filing", "Bundle_LA_Applicant" (MyHMCTS naming). Search phrases (UK only): "court bundle software", "court bundle template uk", "court bundle index template", "court bundle practice direction", "court bundles in family proceedings", "court bundle maker", "court bundle preparation".
How they handle it today	A secretary or paralegal assembles in Word and Acrobat, often the night before; some firms use the free tool; chambers publish warnings; LexisNexis publishes guidance on e-bundles; firms with no support staff miss deadlines.
Vendors already covering it	The free bundling tool built by a City solicitor (reported April 2026; claims "up to an hour per bundle" saved and "days of work" for litigants in person) reported claim; LexisNexis e-bundle guidance (guidance, not software) (LexisNexis [315]). The notes name no commercial bundling product, so commercial coverage is unverified here and should be checked before any claim is made.
Automatable?	Largely. Pagination stamping, OCR, bookmarks, index generation, file naming, size and orientation checks, and the PD27A working-day deadline arithmetic are mechanical. Choosing what goes in (correspondence and messages are excluded unless directed), agreeing the index with the other side, and drafting the position statement are the solicitor's.
What the reader would need to learn	PD27A (family), the CPR practice directions on bundles, the Upper Tribunal IAC CE-File guidance (single PDF, 50 MB, 200-300 DPI, portrait, computer pagination, no A1/A2 schemes), MyHMCTS naming conventions, employment tribunal bundle practice; PDF toolchains for OCR, bookmarking and page stamping; working-day calendars; how UK firms store matter documents (LEAP, Proclaim, Osprey, Clio UK, SharePoint).

5 AML risk-assessment reasoning and source-of-funds analysis on file

UK

Problem signal: strong | **Vendor coverage:** weak | **Automatable:** partly

Problem	Firms collect identity, source-of-funds evidence and risk-assessment forms but do not write the reasoning; template forms that only tick high, medium or low fail inspection; some treat a positive electronic verification as completing due diligence; explanations do not match the funds received. The evidence exists on file; the written analysis does not.
Who has it	UK conveyancing and private-client firms of 1-20 fee earners (conveyancing is the SRA's named highest-risk area); sole practitioners who are their own MLRO and COLP.
Evidence	SRA AML report 2024-25: 935 proactive engagements; "almost a third of firms examined were assessed as non-compliant" and 54% partially; 16% of files had no or incomplete risk assessment and 39% "did not effectively evaluate money laundering risk"; source-of-funds checks "often collected but not analysed"; 19 SARs submitted by the SRA itself, "many involving conveyancing" (Legal Futures, 7 Jan 2026 [76]). 35+ fines totalling £565,000+ by late 2025; 70% of early-2025 fines involved inadequate firm-wide risk assessments (Today's Conveyancer [77] vendor-written). 47% of conveyancers cite "regulatory and administrative burden" (Legal Futures [9]). Conveyancing is 36% of accepted Ombudsman complaints. AML or ID checks appear in 5 of 40 Reed ads; a private-client ad lists "client care and AML checks at intake" (Mallory Pryce [36]).
Their words	"client and matter risk assessment", "firm-wide risk assessment", "source of funds", "source of wealth", "CDD", "enhanced due diligence", "the rationale for the risk level and level of due diligence should be clear on file" snippet, "collected but not analysed", "AML / anti-money laundering / ID checks", "client ID checking", "complying with the CLC and Law Society's Conveyancing Quality Scheme", "delays in ID and proof-of-funds checks", "regulatory and administrative burden", "compliance demands". Search phrases: none captured directly; adjacent are "sole practitioner solicitor uk", "conveyancing assistant job description".
How they handle it today	PDF or paper forms with tick boxes; an electronic verification result filed as proof; the fee earner or MLRO reviews when time allows; file reviews for Lexcel or CQS; vendor compliance articles; fines when inspected.
Vendors already covering it	Electronic identity and verification providers (referred to only generically in the notes; a positive result is what some firms wrongly treat as completing CDD); SearchFlow (search provider that writes AML enforcement articles) vendor; Access Legal "outsourced file audits" vendor; Apply Compliance Today (UK Clio consultant with compliance in its name) vendor directory. No vendor page in the notes claims to draft the written rationale or to check that the source-of-funds story matches the money received.
Automatable?	Partly, with a human sign-off. Drafting a structured rationale from the gathered evidence (ID results, bank statements, matter facts, the firm's risk policy) and flagging mismatches between stated source and actual receipts is a document job that can run inside the firm. The risk judgment, the decision on enhanced due diligence and the sign-off are the MLRO's, and the SRA holds the firm responsible for reasoning on file.
What the reader would need to learn	Money Laundering Regulations 2017 and the SRA's AML guidance and warning notices; the Legal Sector Affinity Group guidance structure (firm-wide, client and matter risk assessments); what source-of-funds and source-of-wealth evidence looks like in conveyancing (gifted deposits, sale proceeds, mortgage offers, overseas funds); the conveyancing stages and CQS requirements; UK GDPR handling of financial data; what SRA inspectors check (timeliness, seniority of reviewer, rationale).

6 Immigration evidence packets and RFE/RFI deadline tracking

US and UK

Problem signal: strong | **Vendor coverage:** weak | **Automatable:** partly

Problem	Requests for evidence (US) and further information (UK) arrive by post or inbox at any time with fixed windows, must be answered as tabbed exhibit packets with a cover letter tracking each request, foreign documents translated, inconsistencies with prior filings checked, and filed with proof of delivery; late detection, blank-page drafting and deadlines "tracked only in individual calendars or spreadsheets" cause denials.
Who has it	US immigration firms of 1-10 lawyers (nearly all Spanish-speaking; Craigslist Manhattan had 9 immigration titles among 47 legal postings); UK immigration and asylum firms using OISC caseworkers and paralegals, the same segment that produced the ChatGPT rulings.
Evidence	Requests for further information rose from 15% to 49% of applications (2020 to 2024), each adding "around another month"; processing from 29 days to ten weeks (Free Movement, Feb 2025 [87]). RFE window "typically 84 or 87 days", "cannot be extended"; complex drafting "6 to 10 hours or more" (Toorey [132] vendor). Missing the deadline "commonly results in a denial" (Messersmith Law [133]). Online USCIS filing still needs a "valid wet-ink signature" and a G-28 upload; some forms paper-only (USCIS [134]). "Unless you're only doing straightforward visa applications, it's incredibly hard to plan your week" (Law Society [89] snippet). Upwork: immigration legal assistants at 30-40 hours a week to make sure "existing client matters continue moving administratively", following up for "medical exams, tax documents, civil documents, police records, school records" (Upwork [55]); a specialist USCIS paralegal post for "I-130, I-140, I-485, I-129 ... including exhibit indices" and "Track RFE/NOID deadlines". Three UK tribunal rulings on ChatGPT-drafted grounds at immigration firms.
Their words	"RFE", "NOID", "I-130, I-140, I-485, I-129", "DS-160, DS-260 and NVC", "exhibit indices", "Track RFE/NOID deadlines", "Coordinate client document collection", "consular processing", "preparing exhibit packages for Immigration Court", "translation of documents", "Home Office applications", "UKVI", "Skilled Worker, Global Business Mobility, Sponsor Licence", "monitoring application deadlines, visa expiry dates", "OISC Level 1, 2, or 3", "grounds of appeal", "skeleton argument", "Late detection of RFEs sitting in mailboxes or inboxes", "Drafting each response from a blank page", "Disorganized response packages". Search phrases: not captured for immigration; the firm-side Upwork SEO post wanted "deportation lawyer" and "immigration lawyer".
How they handle it today	Spreadsheets and individual calendars; caseworkers and paralegals; offshore assistants in Latin America and India at $5-$25 an hour; CampLegal or general CMS; free ChatGPT by juniors in the UK cases; wet-ink signature loops by post.
Vendors already covering it	Toorey (RFE response management; claims a day-1 to filing workflow; no metrics on its page) vendor; CampLegal (named only as the CMS in one job post); Filevine ("useless for immigration cases" user, May 2025); Clio (general); Supio Inbox (forwarding documents into a case, PI-oriented) vendor. The notes name no immigration-specific product with independent reviews.
Automatable?	Partly. Detecting and logging an RFE or RFI from scanned post or email, computing the deadline and internal milestones, generating the issue-specific document checklist for the client, assembling the tabbed exhibit index and bookmarks, and drafting translations for certification are mechanical. The legal argument, the client's evidence, the inconsistency check against prior filings and the signature are human, and the tribunal rulings make the qualified lawyer's check non-negotiable.
What the reader would need to learn	USCIS form families, RFE and NOID structure and filing mechanics; UK Home Office routes, Upper Tribunal CE-File rules and OISC levels; the heightened sensitivity of asylum data under UK GDPR and the SRA's WhatsApp findings; multilingual document handling and certified translation rules; the Hamid and Ayinde duties on checking authorities.

7 Chasing clients and third parties for documents and money

UK and US

Problem signal: strong | **Vendor coverage:** partial | **Automatable:** partly

Problem	Files stall because clients have not sent identity documents, payments on account, signatures, bank statements or tax papers, or because lenders, local authorities, banks, registrars and medical providers have not replied; staff spend hours on repeated calls, emails and messages, and clients then chase the firm for updates because nobody told them nothing had changed.
Who has it	UK conveyancing (43% of time), probate (banks, registrars, HMRC), family (Form E documents); US immigration (document follow-up), estate planning (trust funding after signing), bankruptcy ("gathering documents to upload" is the hardest part), PI (records). Every firm under 30 lawyers in both countries.
Evidence	43% of conveyancer time "chasing stakeholders or being chased"; 31% cite "poor communication among stakeholders" (Legal Futures, Oct 2024 [9]). Conveyancer: local authorities "very slow to return Local Searches", lenders "very slow to issue mortgage offers", clients slow by "not sending ID or payments on account quickly" (Property Industry Eye [28]). Probate practitioners must "chase third parties at appropriate points" and send updates "even when nothing has changed" (ICAEW, Sep 2025 [79]). "Probate cases generate endless back-and-forth emails and phone calls" (Content Snare [129] vendor). Upwork: "Following up with clients for missing documents, signatures, and information"; "Making repeated follow-up calls and sending messages when clients do not respond"; "Following up on existing-client payment plans and past-due balances"; a trust-funding coordinator to "follow up on outstanding items, and keep the process moving" (Upwork [55]; Upwork [61]). UK clients: 84% want same-day responses, 82% weekly updates (Legal Futures, Jan 2025 [26]). "If a client is calling you for a status update, you've already failed" (Finch [260] vendor). Communication and delay are 46% of Ombudsman complaint types.
Their words	"chasing", "being chased and having to chase others", "keep the process moving", "follow up on outstanding items", "progress updates", "status update", "keeping clients and agents updated", "Liaising with clients, estate agents, lenders and solicitors", "ID and source of funds", "payments on account", "regular updates even when nothing has changed", "leads who did not schedule, did not attend their consultation, or have not yet retained the firm". Search phrases: "chasing clients for payment", "how to chase money from clients", "law firm intake automation", "legal virtual assistant philippines", "hire a paralegal virtual assistant".
How they handle it today	Secretaries and paralegals by phone and email; offshore virtual assistants at $5-$25 an hour targeted at the Philippines, Latin America and India; case-management flags (one probate firm emails a bank's bereavement team when a date-of-death balance is overdue); WhatsApp on personal phones with no capture; intake specialists on revenue share (PI).
Vendors already covering it	Clio "Grow AI" that "automatically follows up on outstanding intake items" (announced Oct 2025, no availability or price) vendor; Lawmatics automated follow-up and "File Requests" vendor; Content Snare client questionnaires vendor; Case Status client app, "up to 80% of routine client communication is handled automatically" and "600+ firms" vendor; Smokeball document-request report vendor; EvenUp Communication Agents for record follow-ups (PI) vendor; answering and intake services (Smith.ai named in Lawmatics' integration list). The only user comment found is that Lead Docket's "clients can get past mandatory fields without issue, leaving the firm chasing vital information" user, snippet.
Automatable?	Partly. Reminders, document checklists per stage, "what is still missing" lists, and status updates generated from matter activity are automatable and several vendors claim them. Phoning a local authority, lender or bank, judging a client's excuse, verifying identity in person, and capturing WhatsApp conversations are human or policy problems.
What the reader would need to learn	The stage list for each practice area and what is owed by whom at each stage (Conveyancing Protocol and TA forms, probate third-party timelines, USCIS document lists, trust-funding steps); CMS activity feeds and APIs; SRA client-care rules 8.6 and 8.7 on information clients can understand; email and SMS deliverability and consent; UK GDPR and the SRA's WhatsApp findings.

8 Land Registry requisitions and post-completion checks — UK

Problem signal: medium	**Vendor coverage:** partial	**Automatable:** largely

Problem	Registration applications bounce for "name discrepancies, incomplete identity evidence, poorly scanned or missing documents, missing or incomplete information in forms", each requisition adding two to six weeks of unbilled work on a file the client thinks is finished, while the SDLT return must be filed electronically within 14 days and the mortgage redeemed.
Who has it	UK residential conveyancing firms and CLC-regulated conveyancers of all sizes under 30; paralegals handling "post-completion work including Land Registry submissions" at £25,000-£30,000.
Evidence	Roughly one million requisitions a year; over half of 2022 requisitions avoidable; two weeks' delay in simple cases, up to six in complex (Mortgage Solutions, Jan 2023 [74] snippet). 29% of professional customers cut their avoidable rate in six months; 57% below 5%; some "under 30%"; 4,000+ staff trained by HMLR since 2021 (GOV.UK, Dec 2025 [73]). 32.2% of register updates take over three months (HMLR [72]). SDLT within 14 days, electronic only for agents, "We reject returns that are printed and posted" (GOV.UK [71]). "Land Registry" in 21 of 40 Reed ads; "completion statements" in 7; "SDLT" in 13.
Their words	"requisitions", "avoidable requisitions", "AP1", "post-completion", "Land Registry applications", "Land Registry portal", "SDLT returns", "mortgage redemptions", "completion statements", "name discrepancies", "poorly scanned", "expedite", "Submitting searches and reviewing search results", "Handling post-completion work including Land Registry submissions". Search phrases: "conveyancing assistant job description", "conveyancing assistant remote".
How they handle it today	Paralegals check names and scans by eye; HMLR training and guidance; firms monitor their own requisition rate through HMLR data; case-management forms and precedents; the free expedite service when a client complains.
Vendors already covering it	LEAP "fully automated and integrated legal forms and precedents" vendor; Osprey and Access workflows vendor; HMLR's own academy training (4,000+ staff). No vendor page in the notes claims a pre-submission requisition check across identity evidence, deed and title.
Automatable?	Largely. Cross-checking party names across identity documents, transfer deed, mortgage deed and the title, scan quality and orientation, form completeness, and the 14-day SDLT clock are rule-based checks on documents already in the file. The legal content, the client's signature and HMLR's own queue are not.
What the reader would need to learn	HM Land Registry practice guides on requisitions and the AP1, TR1 and identity forms; SDLT return rules and deadlines; the conveyancing stage data as held in LEAP, Osprey or Proclaim; name-matching and scan-quality checks on PDFs; the Conveyancing Quality Scheme requirements.

9 Criminal defence discovery video review

US (UK unsourced)

Problem signal: medium | **Vendor coverage:** weak | **Automatable:** partly

Problem	Body-worn camera and CCTV discovery runs to many hours per case, defence lawyers believe they must watch all of it, staff must redact for privacy before showing it to clients, and in flat-fee criminal practice none of it is billable.
Who has it	US criminal defence solos and small firms (24/7 phone, free consultation, flat fee); public defenders; UK crime firms (no UK figure in the notes).
Evidence	A chief deputy public defender reviewed 16 hours of body-camera footage in a single case; footage "tripled our workload per case"; "The time expenditure is huge"; Virginia requires one new prosecutor per 75 body cameras; one county budgeted $81,000 for a video prosecutor (WDBJ7, Nov 2019 [135]). "it's malpractice for them to not view every scrap of video" (The Journal [136] snippet). A Richmond defender "had to watch nine of eleven videos" to find the search (Virginia Lawyers Weekly [316] snippet). All figures are 2019-2021 and from public-sector lawyers; no private small-firm or 2025-26 data was found.
Their words	"body camera footage", "discovery", "redact", "protective order", "review the evidence", "examine police reports, body-camera footage, test results, witness statements". Search phrases: none captured.
How they handle it today	The attorney watches at normal speed, "sometimes nights and weekends"; staff redact witness information; discovery arrives on disc, portal or link (format not described on any firm site read).
Vendors already covering it	None in the notes for small defence firms. Parrot (now part of Filevine) does deposition summaries, not evidence video vendor. Coverage is unknown rather than confirmed weak, and should be checked.
Automatable?	Partly. Transcription, speaker and time indexing, keyword search and clip extraction are mechanical. Judging what matters, deciding redactions under a protective order, and the duty to review remain the lawyer's.
What the reader would need to learn	Evidence handling and chain of custody; protective-order and redaction rules; speech-to-text accuracy on poor audio; local, offline storage of evidence; the economics of flat-fee criminal practice.

10 Client-account and trust reconciliation errors and accounting sync

UK and US

Problem signal: strong | **Vendor coverage:** partial | **Automatable:** partly

Problem	Three-way reconciliations (bank, cash book, client ledgers; every five weeks in the UK signed by the COFA, monthly in most US states) fail on aged items carried for months, receipts on the wrong ledger, duplicates, one-sided transfers, debit and residual balances; CMS-to-accounting syncs create duplicate invoices and triple entries; the sole practitioner is often alone with it.
Who has it	Every small firm that holds client money; UK sole practitioners who are their own COFA; UK firms with a single legal cashier; US solos on Clio or PracticePanther with QuickBooks; California firms under CTAPP reporting from 1 January 2026.
Evidence	SRA Accounts Rules 8.2-8.3 and 12.1 (SRA [42]). ILFM's list of common failures and what SRA inspectors check (timeliness, seniority of reviewer, aged items, debit balances, residual balances, whether the COFA is "genuinely engaged") (Legal Futures, May 2026 [108]). "Managing Trust Accounts, Rule 1.15" among the top three violation sources in Virginia (Sands Anderson [116]). Clio users: "over a thousand sync errors, duplicate invoices during migration" user, 15 Aug 2026; "Some trust activity is Sent to QBO as a triple entry" user, 21 Aug 2026; "sink or swim, based on your own level of accounting knowledge" user, 11 Jul 2026 (Trustpilot [240]); trust accounting "does not allow for sub accounts" user, Jul 2022. ILFM: "if a small firm, you might be alone" (ILFM [37]). Legal cashier pay £30,000-£40,000. Autocomplete: "outsource legal cashier", "outsource legal billing".
Their words	"three-way reconciliation", "client to client, matter to matter, client to business (office)" transfers, "residual balances", "aged reconciling items", "debit balances", "unpresented cheques", "COFA", "SRA Accounts Rules", "accountant's report", "IOLTA", "trust account", "trial balance", "QBO sync", "duplicate invoices", "legal cashier", "legal biller".
How they handle it today	In-house or outsourced legal cashiers; LEAP certified bookkeepers (Ascentant, Numero, Legal Financial Controllers); Clio, CosmoLex or LeanLaw with QuickBooks or Xero; spreadsheets; "reconciling to zero and moving on".
Vendors already covering it	CosmoLex (built-in trust accounting) vendor; LeanLaw (contingency disbursement statements) vendor; Clio Accounting and QuickBooks and Xero syncs (users complain); Jayva "client trust accounting consultancy" (US) and legal accounting consultancy (UK) vendor; outsourced cashiers. Coverage is strong on bookkeeping and weak on catching sync and reconciliation anomalies before the COFA signs.
Automatable?	Partly. Detecting duplicates, aged items, debit and residual balances, one-sided transfers and sync mismatches between the CMS and the ledger is rule-based. The reconciliation sign-off, the treatment of residual balances and any transfer decision are the COFA's or lawyer's.
What the reader would need to learn	SRA Accounts Rules 4.3, 8.1-8.3, 12 and 13; US Rule 1.15 variants (Alabama's monthly trial balance and six-year retention, California's CTAPP); three-way reconciliation mechanics; QuickBooks Online and Xero data; CMS billing and trust data models; how a legal cashier's day is structured (CHAPS by deadline, cheque runs, disbursement ledgers).

11 Legal aid billing: CCMS, LAA contingency reconciliation and fee re-coding

UK

Problem signal: strong | **Vendor coverage:** partial | **Automatable:** partly

Problem	Legal aid claims run through LAA systems that reject bills, delay payment and change format; the May 2025 cyber-attack forced months of manual contingency with dummy identifiers that must be reconciled against later payments; fee-scheme changes require billing routines to be rebuilt; all of this on fees frozen since 1996.
Who has it	UK legal aid firms in family, crime, housing and immigration, a shrinking group (civil providers fell from 3,896 in 2011 to 2,101 in 2022; duty solicitors down 25% to October 2024); four of 24 swept high-street sites mention legal aid.
Evidence	Fees unchanged since 1996 and cut 10% in 2011; median family provider at break-even; housing providers losing £33,000 per fee earner (Law Society [86] snippet). CCMS warned in 2015 to make bills "more likely to be rejected" with "significant delays to payment" (Family Law [100]). LAA incident: Crime Apply, CCMS and Civil Apply affected; delegated authority ended 30 Sep 2025; claims without a MAAT number need a file note and dummy MAAT 900900; "Submit a Bulk Claim" live 4 Feb 2026 replacing CWA; email submissions no longer accepted (GOV.UK [98]). Criminal fee scheme from 22 Dec 2025 requires vendors to update billing for "D25 rates" (Access Group [97]). Civil uplift: new minimum £65.35 an hour, "the first since 1996" (MoJ [317]). Recruiter: constraint tightest "particularly for solicitors willing to work in Legal Aid" (BCL Legal [318]).
Their words	"CCMS", "CWA", "Submit a Bulk Claim", "MAAT number", "CRM7", "delegated authority", "representation order", "escape fee", "Legal Help", "Crime Lower", "D25 rates", "legal aid rates", "fixed fees", "Legal Aid Agency", "contracted with the Legal Aid Agency", "Duty Solicitor Scheme", "LAA billing". Search phrases: none captured.
How they handle it today	Cashiers and fee earners re-key claims; Proclaim/Access and LEAP (Legal Aid tagged partners) update billing routines; firms leave the duty scheme; firms exit legal aid altogether.
Vendors already covering it	Access CaseMatters Evo / Proclaim (D25 update, legal-aid billing) vendor; LEAP partners tagged "Legal Aid" vendor directory; the LAA's own portals. Coverage is medium; the problem is niche but acute.
Automatable?	Partly. Claim preparation, validation against scheme rules before submission, and reconciliation of contingency-period claims against later payments are rule-based. Submission formats and LAA decisions are external and change without notice.
What the reader would need to learn	LAA fee schemes (civil and criminal), CCMS and bulk-claim formats, the accounts-rules exemption where all client money is LAA money, and the economics of legal aid firms.

12 Family financial disclosure assembly (Form E and financial affidavits) — UK and US

Problem signal: medium	**Vendor coverage:** partial	**Automatable:** partly

Problem	Financial disclosure is assembled from months of bank statements, pay slips and tax returns, cross-referenced by hand into a court form, converted to the court's format, sworn by the client, then updated two or three times as the case moves, with sanctions for gaps.
Who has it	UK family firms (Form E in financial remedy); US family firms billing hourly (Florida Form 12.902(b), North Carolina's affidavit "required in every case"); paralegals running discovery across dozens of files.
Evidence	"3.5+ hours manually" per affidavit; staff "spend valuable billable time organizing bank statements, calculating monthly expenses" (Casemark [126] vendor). Two years of pay stubs, bank statements and tax returns; gaps "can trigger discovery requests, hearings, or sanctions" (SignNow [319] snippet). NC: "sanctions for violations are now mandatory once violations are proven" (NC Bar CLE [320] snippet). The affidavit "will be updated at other points during the Divorce" (Freed Marcroft [127]). A paralegal posting: discovery "for a minimum of 45 files" and compiling the "production index of documents produced" to determine "the documents that are missing" (BHSG posting [321] snippet). UK: PD27A excludes financial records from bundles unless directed, so triage is required; the GOV.UK Form E page was blocked, so its attachment list is unverified.
Their words	"Form E", "financial affidavit", "financial disclosure", "pay stubs, bank statements, and tax returns", "production index", "documents that are missing", "forensic accountants", "court-acceptable formats", "financial remedy", "FDR". Search phrases: none captured.
How they handle it today	A paralegal keys figures from PDFs into the form and Excel; the client reviews and swears; the exercise repeats at each update.
Vendors already covering it	Casemark (financial affidavit workflow) vendor; general CMS document assembly. No independent review of any such tool was read.
Automatable?	Partly. Extracting transactions, balances and income from statements, building the index of produced versus missing documents, and formatting to the court template are mechanical. The client's sworn accuracy, the lawyer's judgment on disclosure and the court's requirements are not.
What the reader would need to learn	Form E structure and the Family Procedure Rules on disclosure; US state affidavit forms and local rules; bank-statement and pay-slip parsing from PDFs; secure handling of financial data.

Crowded areas that are not gaps

- **Intake call answering and lead follow-up** has the loudest problem signal of all (40% of calls answered, 33% of emails, 48% unreachable) but also the thickest vendor layer: answering services, Supio Intake (24/7 voice intake that scores leads and syncs to the CMS vendor), Eve Intake ('signs the client before the call ends' vendor), Lead Docket, CloudLex's Lexee, EvenUp's carrier-calling agents, Clio's 'after-hours AI phone and email answering' and the chatbot builders on Upwork at $1,200-$4,500 a project; only 7% of firms used a chatbot in 2024, so adoption is low, but the supply is not thin.
- **Medical chronologies and demand letters** are the most heavily funded corner of legal AI (EvenUp '$150M Series E at $2B+', Eve '$103M Series B', Supio, Parrot/MedChron, Wisedocs, DigitalOwl, Finch); user complaints are about quality ('entries from the early 1900s', '72 hrs'), which is a reason to study the space, not to enter it from scratch; the $150 Upwork consultation on 'how a chronology is built and priced' shows newcomers trying exactly that.
- **Dictation and transcription** has a real but small signal (7 of 40 UK ads, 'done in the Microsoft cloud', 'not always 100% accurate') and mature products, though the cloud-processing complaint is itself a small self-hosting signal.

SECTION 10

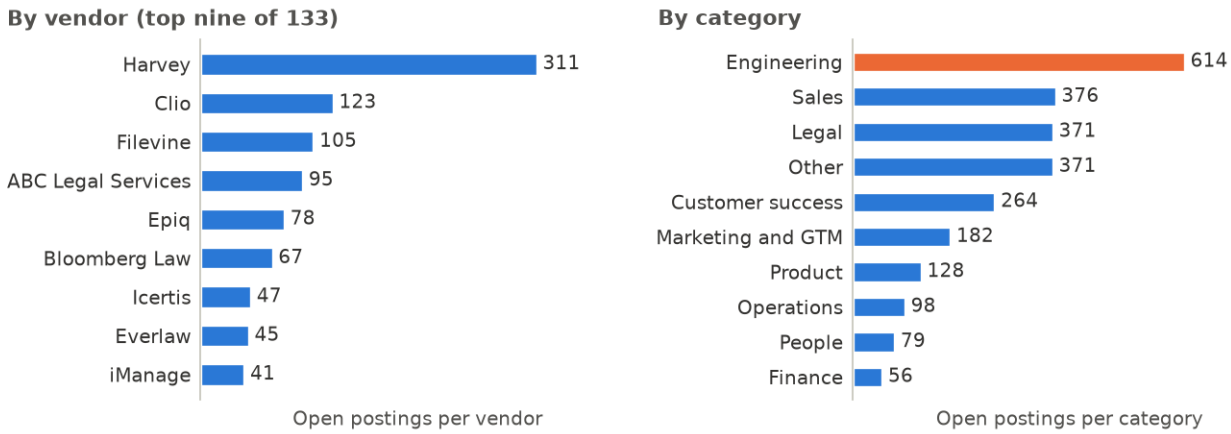
Employed path versus freelance path: the same skills, very different prices

The employed path is small, concentrated and screened hard; the freelance path is open, cheap at the marketplace tier and expensive only inside consultancy and vendor-certification tiers. No source measures time to first revenue or competition directly, so those criteria rest on proxies; the arithmetic comparisons are the researcher's calculations on cited figures.

Employed demand: a dated snapshot

- A legal-tech vendor job aggregator showed **2,539 open postings across 133 vendors on 23 September 2026, of which 614 are engineering**; only 19% of vendors publish pay; Harvey alone 311 postings (12% of the category), Clio 123, Filevine 105 (rlegaltech.com/jobs [322]).
- The general US AI-engineering market had 43,500 postings analysed between January and July 2026; professional services the top hiring sector (28%); 47% of roles at employers with 10,000+ staff (Axial Search [323]).
- Dedicated UK counts for the exact titles are tiny: 4 permanent 'Legal Technology Specialist' vacancies in London in the six months to 10 October 2026 (up from 1) (ITJobsWatch [324]); 18 to 44 'legal engineer' jobs on Glassdoor UK (Glassdoor UK [325] snippet); broad 'legal tech' keyword counts (Reed 4,794; Totaljobs 464; Glassdoor UK 2,009) are inflated by unrelated roles (Reed [326]; Totaljobs [327] snippets). No board gave a count for 'Clio consultant', 'Filevine consultant', 'practice management consultant' or 'legal operations analyst'.

2,539 open legal-tech vendor postings across 133 vendors on 23 Sep 2026: Harvey alone 311, engineering 614



Source: rlegaltech.com/jobs [322], 'Source checked 23 Sept 2026'; only 19% of vendors publish pay. For scale, the general US AI-engineering market had 43,500 postings analysed Jan-Jul 2026 [323].

Table 10.1 Legal-tech vendor postings, 23 Sep 2026

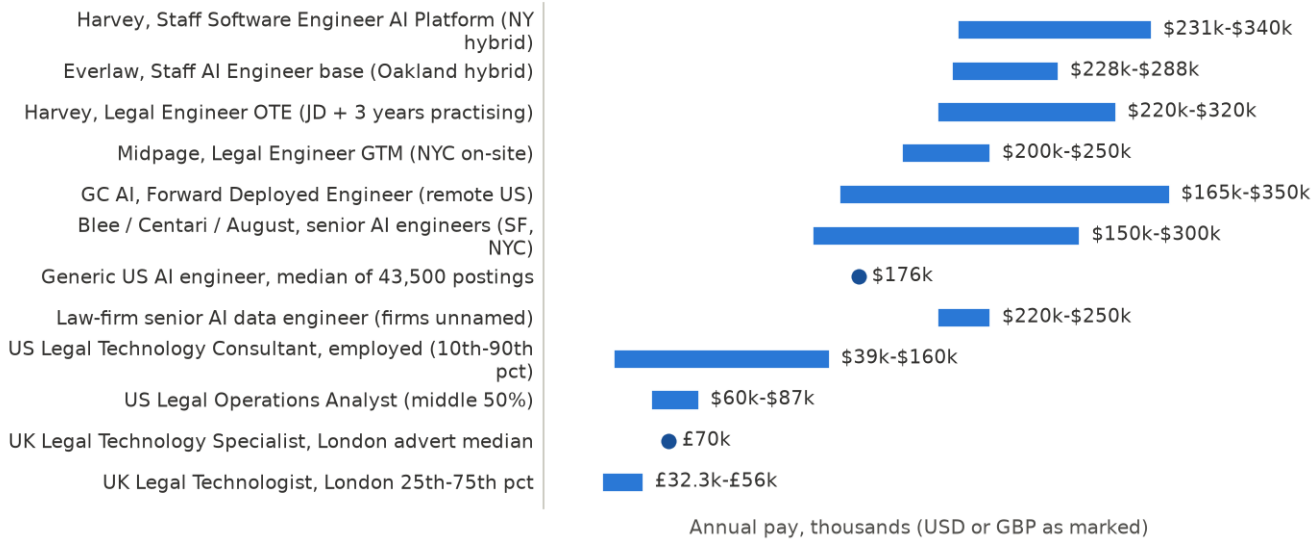
Legal-tech vendor postings, 23 Sep 2026	Count	Category split (same snapshot)	Count
Harvey	311	Engineering	614
Clio	123	Sales	376
Filevine	105	Legal	371
ABC Legal Services	95	Other	371
Epiq	78	Customer success	264
Bloomberg Law	67	Marketing and GTM	182
Icertis	47	Product	128
Everlaw	45	Operations	98
iManage	41	People	79
All vendors tracked	2,539 across 133 vendors	Finance	56

Source: rlegaltech.com/jobs [322], 'Source checked 23 Sept 2026'.

Three title profiles that do not overlap

- The **'legal engineer'** is a lawyer role: Harvey's New York posting requires a 'JD or equivalent legal qualification', 'At least 3 years of experience practicing law at a top-tier law firm (Vault 50 or equivalent) and/or in-house experience', 'Executive engagement skills and presence' and 'Outstanding presentation skills', and lists no technical skills (Legal.io [328]); 'coding is not required' for legal engineers, Luminance fills analyst roles with recent law graduates, some postings say 'qualified lawyers are strongly favoured' (NonBillable, 19 Feb 2026 [329]). Of 46 Am Law 200 lawyers who joined AI companies in the first half of 2026 (Harvey 22, Anthropic 8, OpenAI 5, Legora 5), 15 took 'legal engineer' titles and 40 were associates (Lawfuel, 3 Oct 2026 [330]; the report's author sells talent data to the firms it covers).
- The **'AI engineer'** at the same vendors is a software role with no stated legal-domain requirement: Everlaw's Staff AI Engineer asks for Python, 'applied LLMs in production', NLP, 'at least 6 years' of ML and '8+ years overall' of software engineering, with retrieval-based models and RAG, vector and graph databases, multimodal work and 'agent building incl. tool use and MCP' as pluses (Everlaw careers [331]); across the 43,500 generic US AI postings Python appears in 62%, cloud platforms in 55%, foundation models in 51%, and RAG is 'commonly screened for' (Axial Search [323]).
- The UK law-firm **'legal technology specialist'** is a third thing, a tool-rollout role: the four London adverts all list AI, Generative AI, Harvey AI, HighQ, Legatics, SharePoint and Smartsheet, not an engineering stack (ITJobsWatch [324]). A career-content claim that a JD 'commands a 20-30% premium' over technical-only candidates is not employer data (AI Vortex [332] snippet).

Employed pay: US legal-tech vendors post AI-engineer bases of $150,000 to $340,000; UK legal technologists earn a median of about £42,000



Sources: rlegaltech.com/jobs [322]; Everlaw careers [331]; Legal.io [328]; Axial Search [323] (43,500 postings); Court Cast Sep 2026 [337]; ZipRecruiter [340] [342] (snippets); Glassdoor [343] (snippet, 14 submissions); ITJobsWatch [324] (3 salaries). Remote in these ads means remote within the US or the UK.

Table 10.2 Posted or estimated pay by title

Title	Country	Posted or estimated pay	Basis	Source
Legal Engineer, Harvey (JD + 3 years)	US, NY / SF	$220,000-$320,000 OTE (70/30 or 75/25 split); Product Specialist (In-House) $210,000-$300,000	Posted (Feb 2026, now expired)	Legal.io [328]; Harvey careers [333] snippet
Legal Engineering Manager / Head of AMER Legal Engineering, Harvey	US	$315,000-$385,000 / $400,000-$450,000	Listings dated 1 Oct 2026	Justia Jobs [334] snippet
Legal Engineer, GTM, Midpage	US, NYC on-site	$200,000-$250,000	Posted	rlegaltech.com [322]
Legal Engineer (Asset Management; In-House)	US, NY / SF	$225,000-$325,000	Listing	Built In [335] snippet
Staff Software Engineer, AI Platform, Harvey	US, NY hybrid	$231,000-$340,000	Posted	rlegaltech.com [322]
Staff AI Engineer, Everlaw	US, Oakland hybrid 3 days	$228,000-$288,000 base	Posted	Everlaw [331]
Forward Deployed Engineer, GC AI	US, remote US	$165,000-$350,000	Posted	rlegaltech.com [322]

Title	Country	Posted or estimated pay	Basis	Source
Senior AI Engineer, Blee; Senior SWE AI, Centari; AI Product Engineer, August	US, SF / NYC	$150,000-$275,000; $150,000-$210,000; $175,000-$300,000	Posted	rlegaltech.com [322]
Generic US AI engineer	US	median $176,000 (43,500 postings); Levels.fyi median total comp $156,000 (25th $110,000, 90th $300,000)	Posting analysis; crowd-sourced	Axial Search [323]; Levels.fyi [336] snippet
Law-firm senior AI data engineer; director of applied AI	US	$220,000-$250,000; up to $438,000	Reported, firms unnamed	Court Cast, 26 Sep 2026 [337]
Director of AI Enablement and Legal Engineering, Disney	US, NY	up to $260,000	Reported 28 Sep 2026	Artificial Lawyer [338] snippet
KM and Innovation Manager, Fenwick & West; AmLaw equivalent	US, NY hybrid	est. $126,000-$189,000; $175,000-$190,000	Estimates	The Ladders [339] snippet
Legal Operations Analyst	US	average $75,376 (middle 50% about $60,000-$87,000); SF $99,675; band $65,000-$150,000	Aggregates	ZipRecruiter [340]; HireLegalOps [341] snippets
Legal Technology Consultant (employed title)	US	average $86,450; 10th percentile $39,000, 90th $160,000	Aggregate, Sep 2025	ZipRecruiter [342] snippet
Legal Technologist	UK, London	median about £42,000 (25th-75th £32,264-£55,980; 14 submissions); UK about £43,197 (45 wages)	Crowd-sourced	Glassdoor [343]; Jooble [344] snippets
Legal Technology Specialist	UK, London	advert median £70,000 (3 salaries; +33% year on year)	Advert-based, tiny sample	ITJobsWatch [324]
Legal Engineer, Legora; Harvey UK Product Specialist	UK, London	est. £46,000-£109,000 (median £71,000); associate £36,000-£60,000; Harvey £49,000-£92,000	Glassdoor and model estimates, not posted	Glassdoor Legora listing [345] snippet
Customer Success Manager, Spellbook; Head of Risk and Compliance, Lawhive	UK, remote UK / London	£78,000-£92,000; £90,000-£120,000	Posted	rlegaltech.com [322]

Remote and visa reality

- Of the 43,500 US AI-engineering postings that state a work model, **48% are hybrid, 32% fully remote and 20% on-site** (Axial Search [323]); the sampled legal-tech roles are mostly hybrid or on-site in New York, San Francisco or London, and 'remote' is written as 'Remote (UK)', 'Remote US' or 'Anywhere (USA)' (rlegaltech.com/jobs [322]).
- No legal-engineer or legal-AI-engineer posting with visa-sponsorship language was found; Harvey's posting is silent on work authorisation; many generic AI roles state 'Employment visa sponsorship is unavailable for this position'; one New York forward-deployed engineer role is open to H-1B or TN; one contractor marketplace excludes contractors who need sponsorship (ZipRecruiter [346] snippet).
- The vendors do hire outside the US and UK, but in their own offshore engineering hubs: Filevine ML Ops in Bratislava, Legora legal engineers in Bengaluru and Stockholm, Onit in Pune, DeepJudge in Zurich, Legartis in Berlin and Leipzig (rlegaltech.com/jobs [322]; NonBillable [329]).

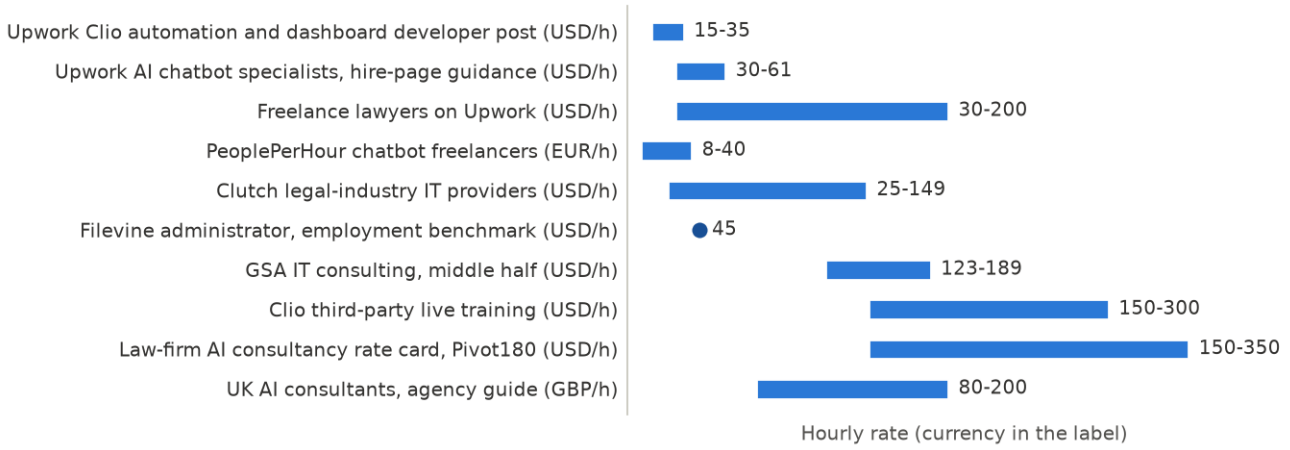
The 2025-26 market moves explain the concentration

- Legal-tech funding hit a record in 2025 (trackers disagree: Crunchbase '$4.08 billion', Legalcomplex '$5.99 billion across 292 companies' snippets); Q1 2026 alone raised **$2.34 billion across 103 deals, with Relativity, Legora and Harvey taking about 63% and a median round of just $1 million** (Artificial Lawyer, 13 Apr 2026 [347]); Harvey reached an **$11 billion valuation** in March 2026 (CNBC [348] snippet); Clio closed a $500 million Series G at $5 billion and the $1 billion vLex acquisition, Filevine raised $400 million, Eve $150 million and Supio $60 million (LawNext, Jan 2026 [349]).
- Large law firms started building in-house units: Cooley AI is recruiting for 14 positions including senior engineering; Covington, Cravath, Latham, Kirkland, McGuireWoods, Mayer Brown and White & Case have advertised AI roles (Court Cast, 26 Sep 2026 [337]).
- Thomson Reuters cut engineering roles in July 2026 ('a small number' per the company; up to 500 worldwide per an anonymous employee) while planning 'more than 250 net-new engineering roles globally over the next two years, the large majority senior and AI-native' (US News / Reuters [350] snippet); Layoffs.fyi counted about 120,000 technology employees laid off across 228 companies in 2026 to that date (The Next Web [351] snippet). The employed path is a bet on a short list of employers that screen on six to eight years of production AI work or on a JD.

The freelance and consulting path has three price tiers

- **Marketplace tier.** Upwork's hire pages price AI chatbot specialists at '$30-$61 per hour', a 'Rule-based FAQ or support bot $300-$1,200/project', a 'Custom LLM or RAG assistant $1,500-$5,000/project', and 'focused Clio-related work' at '$500-$1,500 per project' (Upwork AI chatbot specialists [63]; Upwork Clio freelancers [352] vendor marketing, snippets); Fiverr's '24 Best Legal Automation Services' page shows gigs 'From $30' and legal AI intake and chatbot gigs 'From $20' to 'From $80'; its cost guides put AI expert services at 'approximately $98 for basic consulting to $520 for complex chatbot development' (Fiverr legal automation [353]; Fiverr AI automation cost guide [354] vendor, snippets); PeoplePerHour chatbot freelancers quote roughly €8-€40 an hour with no law-firm automation listings (PeoplePerHour [355] snippet); an agency guide puts UK AI consultants at £80-£200 an hour (Lazige [356] vendor). A guide to RAG jobs on Upwork warns that clients mix 'MVP budget with production expectations' (GigUp [357] snippet).
- **Consultancy tier.** One law-firm AI consultancy's own page lists **$150-$350 an hour, fixed-scope assessments at $1,500-$5,000, implementations at $5,000-$20,000 for a 5-25 attorney firm, and monthly retainers from about $1,500**, and tells buyers to vet consultants on prior law-firm work, confidentiality handling and referral fees (Pivot180 [358] vendor, self-reported); GSA-schedule medians are $151 an hour for IT consulting and $132 for legal and compliance consulting (ConsultingDemand [359] snippet); Clutch's 'Top IT Services Companies for Legal Firms' is dominated by managed-service providers at $25-$149 an hour with one at $200-$300 (Clutch [360] snippet).
- **Vendor-certified tier.** Filevine's contract wording makes partners structurally necessary: 'Filevine will not perform or provide any implementation services and/or data migration services directly ... Such implementation services ... must be performed and provided by a Filevine-certified third-party implementation partner' (Marin County contract [361] snippet), with partner packages at $1,750 to $32,500 (section 6); Clio's LinkedIn page says its ecosystem 'includes partnerships with over 280 app integration partners and 100 Clio Certified Consultants', a consultant being someone 'assessed by Clio as proficient in the use and resale of the Clio application' (Clio LinkedIn [362]; Clio Certified Consultants [363] snippets), a small certified pool against hundreds of thousands of users; no Clio consultant publishes a rate and two consultant sites blocked the fetch. LEAP UK's certified partners include Jayva (since 2014), Thinkwild (since 2015), SPBK and Law Right; Hunnings Consultancy says it has assisted more than 800 of the UK's 2,500-plus LEAP firms (Hunnings [364] self-reported, snippet).

Freelance and consulting rates: $15 to $61 an hour on marketplaces, $150 to $350 an hour at the law-firm consultancy tier



Sources: Upwork hire pages and job post [63] [59] [365] (vendor marketing, snippets); PeoplePerHour [355]; Clutch [360]; Built In [251]; ConsultingDemand [359]; aimadefor [244] (3p); Pivot180 [358] (self-reported); Lazige [356]. Fiverr gigs start at $20-$80 and Clio set-up gigs at $10-$75 (project prices, not shown).

Table 10.3 Price tiers and who sets the price

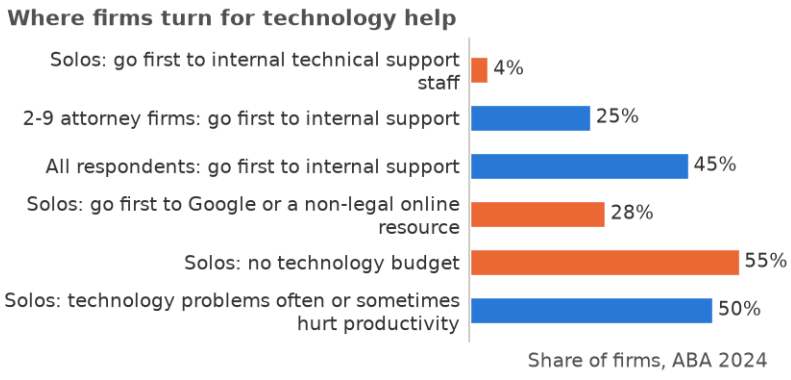
Tier	Price points	Who sets the price	Source
Marketplace, Upwork	$30-$61 an hour; rule-based bot $300-$1,200; custom LLM or RAG assistant $1,500-$5,000; Clio work $500-$1,500 per project; freelance lawyers $30-$200 an hour	Upwork's hire-page guidance	Upwork chatbot [63]; Upwork Clio [352]; Upwork legal [365] vendor, snippets
Marketplace, Fiverr	legal automation gigs from $30; legal AI intake and chatbot gigs from $20-$80; "build ai app for legal" from $80 or $50 an hour; AI consulting $98 to $520; rule-based chatbots $30-$125; mid-range chatbots $200-$400	Sellers and Fiverr cost guides	Fiverr legal automation [353]; Fiverr gig [366]; Fiverr chatbot cost guide [367] vendor, snippets

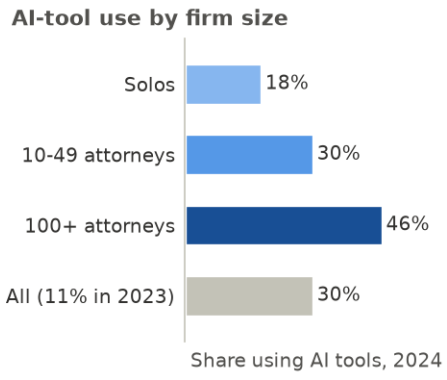
Tier	Price points	Who sets the price	Source
Marketplace, UK and Europe	PeoplePerHour chatbot freelancers about €8-€40 an hour; UK AI consultants £80-£200 an hour (agency guide); global AI freelancers $35-$250 an hour	Platform and agency guides	PeoplePerHour [355]; Lazige [356]; Botpool [368] vendor, snippets
Consultancy, law-firm AI	$150-$350 an hour; assessments $1,500-$5,000; implementations $5,000-$20,000 (5-25 attorneys); retainers from about $1,500 a month; another consultancy "starts at $3,500"	Consultancies' own pages	Pivot180 [358]; ColabContent [369] vendor, self-reported
Consultancy, general benchmarks	IT consulting median $151 an hour (middle half $123-$189); legal and compliance consulting $132 ($96-$178); Clutch AI consulting firms $125-$300; Clutch legal-industry IT providers $25-$300	GSA-derived and directory bands	ConsultingDemand [359]; AY Automate [370]; Clutch [360] snippets
Vendor-certified, Filevine	partner Sprint $1,750-$7,500 (1-20 users, 2 weeks); Launch $12,500-$32,500 (4-6 months); modules $2,500; implementation only through certified partners by contract	Partner rate cards; Filevine contract	Oktopeak [233]; Marin County contract [361] snippet
Vendor-certified, Clio	about 100 Certified Consultants; no published rates; third-party training $150-$300 an hour; Grow set-up $399	Clio directory and third parties	Clio LinkedIn [362] snippet; aimadefor [244] 3p; Costbench [245]
Vendor-certified, LEAP UK and Actionstep	12 LEAP partners; certification "within 2 weeks"; Actionstep tiered certified partners; no published rates	Vendor directories	LEAP directory [247]; Actionstep partners [371]
Employed, for comparison	US legal technology consultant average $86,450 (10th-90th $39,000-$160,000); legal ops analyst about $60,000-$100,000	Salary aggregates	ZipRecruiter [342] snippet

How small firms actually buy technology help

- ABA 2024 Technology and Training TechReport: 45% of all respondents turn first to internal technical support staff, but **only 4% of solos and 25% of 2-9 attorney firms** do, and solos were most likely (**28%**) to turn first to Google or another non-legal online resource (ABA 2024 Technology and Training TechReport [372] snippet; page blocked); **55.4% of solo firms reported no technology budget** (ABA 2024 Budgeting and Planning TechReport [373] snippet).
- Firms learn about AI mainly through CLE seminars and webinars (61% overall, 66% of solos, 68% of 2-9 firms), publications (37%), legal news (34%) and other law firms (32%); it is the 50-99 attorney firms that use 'legal technology consultants, product vendors, and trade shows' as sources (LawNext, 7 Mar 2025 [374]; ABA 2024 AI TechReport [375] snippet). AI-tool use in 2024 was 18% at solos, 30% at 10-49 attorney firms and 46% at 100+; ChatGPT was used or considered by 64% of 2-9 firms and 62% of solos (LawNext [374]).
- Clio's 2025 solo and small-firm report: 'finding time' is the biggest hurdle to adopting new technology for 27% of solos and 33% of small firms (Clio 2025 report [376] snippet; vendor); 55% of small firms have no AI policy (NC Bar, May 2026 [377] snippet). Circulating spend figures ('$3,000-$10,000 per lawyer per year', '$150-230/month in subscriptions for an AI-assisted solo practice') are vendor-cited and cover software, not consulting (tryclean.ai [378]; LawyerAI Directory [379] vendor).
- Put with the Clutch list: small firms' paid technology help is bought as managed IT support and cloud subscriptions, with consultants appearing as a channel mainly at 50-99 lawyer firms. No UK survey on who small firms turn to was found.

Solos go to Google first (28%) and only 4% to internal IT; 55% of solo firms have no technology budget





Sources: ABA 2024 Technology and Training, Budgeting and Planning, and AI TechReports [372] [373] [375] (search snippets; americanbar.org blocked); LawNext 7 Mar 2025 [374] (512 private-practice attorneys).

Table 10.4 ABA 2024 measures by firm size

ABA 2024 measure	Solos	2-9 attorneys	10-49	50-99	100+	All
Turn first to internal technical support staff	4%	25%	not given	not given	more likely with size	45%
Turn first to Google or another non-legal online resource	28% (most likely group)	not given				
Technology problems "often" or "sometimes" hurt productivity	50%	47%	56%	not given	55%	
No technology budget	55.4%	not given				
AI-tool use (2024)	18%	not given	30%	not given	46%	30% (11% in 2023)
CLE seminars and webinars as AI information source	66%	68%				61%
Uses consultants, vendors and trade shows as AI information sources				most likely group		
ChatGPT used or considered	62%	64%				

Sources: ABA 2024 Technology and Training [372], Budgeting and Planning [373] and AI [375] TechReports (all via search snippets; americanbar.org blocked); LawNext, 7 Mar 2025 [374] (512 private-practice attorneys).

Side by side on five criteria

- **Income range.** US vendor AI engineering is posted at $150,000-$340,000 base and legal engineering at $200,000-$325,000 OTE (management to $450,000); US law-firm roles at $126,000-$250,000 (directors to $438,000); US legal-ops and employed-consultant titles about $39,000-$160,000; UK employed roles £42,000-£70,000 (vendor legal engineers estimated at £46,000-£120,000). Freelance marketplace work is priced at $30-$61 an hour or $500-$5,000 a project; consultancy-tier work at $150-$350 an hour, $5,000-$20,000 an implementation and $1,500-plus a month on retainer. The researcher's arithmetic, not a reported figure: a solo consultant billing about $200 an hour for about ten hours a week would gross about $100,000 a year, level with the employed 'legal technology consultant' average and below the US vendor floor; a UK freelancer at £80-£200 an hour would at the same utilisation gross more than the £42,000 UK employed median.
- **Time to first revenue.** No source measures it; proxies: employed postings cycle within months (Harvey's New York legal-engineer post ran from 6 February 2026 to expiry, Danaher's remote role is filled, Husch Blackwell's April 2026 posting was removed); a Filevine partner 'Sprint' is scoped at two weeks and a Clio small-firm set-up at 'about two weeks' (LeanLaw Clio guide [380] snippet); the buyer's own constraints are 'finding time' and no budget line.
- **Competition.** Employed: a few hundred engineering postings sector-wide concentrated in about five vendors, screened on 6-8+ years or a JD, against 43,500 generic AI postings. Freelance: priced down by marketplace sellers at $20-$61 an hour, with the protected niches being Clio's roughly 100 certified consultants, Filevine's handful of certified partners (one claiming '90+ specialists') and LEAP's 12 UK partners.
- **Need for a law background.** A hard requirement only for the 'legal engineer' title (JD plus three years at Harvey; 'qualified lawyers strongly favoured' at Luminance); absent from AI-engineer adverts; absent from freelance buyer-vetting advice, which asks for prior law-firm work and confidentiality handling instead; vendor certification is assessed on product proficiency, not law.
- **Skills in both job ads and buyer posts.** Python, production LLM work, retrieval and RAG, vector databases and agent or tool-use building (required or a plus at Everlaw and in 62%/51% of generic postings; the core of Upwork's 'custom LLM or RAG assistant' category and of the firm-side Upwork post that wanted 'Claude or OpenAI APIs', 'webhook-based automations' and Clio dashboards), and practice-management platform set-up for Clio, Filevine and LEAP (vendor client-success and implementation roles such as LEAP's Client Success Consultant in Bath and London and Filevine's 105 postings on one side; Upwork Clio projects, Filevine partner sprints and LEAP UK partners on the other). One side only: Harvey AI, HighQ, Legatics and SharePoint administration in UK law-firm technologist adverts with no freelance buyer category; intake automation, document automation and legal AI chatbots as Fiverr gig titles with no matching engineering job title.

Table 10.5 Employed path against freelance path on the five criteria

Criterion	Employed path (vendor or law firm)	Freelance and consulting path	Source basis
Income range	US vendor AI engineer $150,000-$340,000 base; legal engineer (JD) $200,000-$325,000 OTE, managers to $450,000; US law firm $126,000-$250,000, directors to $438,000; US legal ops and employed consultant about $39,000-$160,000; UK £42,000-£70,000 posted, vendor estimates £46,000-£120,000	Marketplace $30-$61 an hour, $500-$5,000 a project, gigs from $20; consultancy $150-$350 an hour, $1,500-$5,000 assessments, $5,000-$20,000 implementations, $1,500-plus monthly retainers; Filevine partner packages $1,750-$32,500	Posted ads, aggregates; vendor marketing and consultancy rate cards
Time to first revenue	Not measured; postings cycle within months (Feb 2026 post expired; Apr 2026 post removed; remote role filled)	Not measured; two-week Sprint and "about two weeks" Clio set-up as project proxies; buyers cite "finding time" (27-33%) and no budget (55.4% of solos)	Posting lifetimes; partner scoping; ABA and Clio surveys snippets
Competition	614 engineering postings across 133 vendors, Harvey 311; 46 Big Law lawyers moved to AI companies in H1 2026; screens of 6-8+ years or JD; 32% fully remote and remote means in-country	"24 Best Legal Automation Services" on Fiverr; sellers from €8 an hour on PeoplePerHour; Clutch MSPs from $25 an hour; protected niches: about 100 Clio CCCs, a handful of Filevine partners, 12 LEAP UK partners	Aggregator counts; marketplace pages snippets; vendor directories
Need for a law background	Required for "legal engineer" (JD + 3 years; coding not required); not stated for AI engineer; UK technologist roles are tool rollout	Not required; buyers advised to ask for prior law-firm work and confidentiality handling; certification assessed on product proficiency	Harvey posting; Everlaw posting; Pivot180 vendor; Clio CCC page snippet
Skills in both job ads and buyer posts	Python, production LLMs, RAG, vector databases, agents and tool use; Clio, Filevine, LEAP configuration (client-success and implementation roles)	Same stack in Upwork's RAG-assistant category and the firm-side Clio automation post; Clio, Filevine, LEAP set-up projects and partner sprints	Everlaw; Axial; Upwork hire pages snippets; rlegaltech.com; Upwork job post
Skills on one side only	Harvey AI, HighQ, Legatics, SharePoint, Smartsheet (UK law-firm adverts)	Intake automation, document automation, legal AI chatbots (Fiverr gig titles)	ITJobsWatch; Fiverr snippet

What the notes do not contain

- No interview, podcast or survey of independent legal-tech consultants' income or how they find clients; the only client-acquisition evidence is generic ABA advice about referrals and niche networking (ABA Law Practice Today [381] snippet).
- No seller-to-buyer-post ratios for 'law firm AI', 'Clio' or 'legal RAG' on Upwork or Fiverr; no LinkedIn Services counts; no actual law-firm buyer posts with budgets in this set (the dated ones are in section 2); no posted pay for any Clio, Filevine, LEAP or Actionstep consultant or implementation role; no evidence on whether freelancers outside the US and UK win law-firm work at consultancy-tier rates, since every consultancy rate card found is US-based.

Sources

Every URL cited in the research report, numbered in order of first appearance. Body references [n] point here. Hosts that blocked the researcher are listed in section 11, which follows this appendix; facts from them carry the snippet or secondary tag.

[1]	**Clio benchmarks, 2025** https://clio.com/resources/legal-trends/benchmarks/
[2]	**Legal Futures, 6 Mar 2025** https://www.legalfutures.co.uk/latest-news/client-account-interest-drives-rising-profits-at-sme-law-firms
[3]	**LawNext, 25 Mar 2019** https://www.lawnext.com/2019/03/exclusive-survey-report-small-firms-see-many-challenges-but-do-little-to-address-them.html
[4]	**Clio, Legal Trends for Solo Law Firms, 2023** https://www.clio.com/wp-content/uploads/2022/10/2023-Legal-Trends-for-Solo-Law-Firms.pdf
[5]	**Thomson Reuters press release, Sep 2020** https://www.thomsonreuters.com/en/press-releases/2020/september/small-law-firms-still-struggling-to-manage-administrative-tasks-says-thomson-reuters-survey
[6]	**Legal IT Insider, Nov 2022** https://legaltechnology.com/small-us-law-firms-still-rate-time-spent-on-admin-as-number-one-challenge/
[7]	**LawNext, Nov 2023** https://www.lawnext.com/2023/11/small-law-firms-made-progress-this-year-on-their-biggest-challenge-thomson-reuters-survey-finds.html
[8]	**LexisNexis pressroom, 18 May 2026** https://www.lexisnexis.com/community/pressroom/b/news/posts/small-law-firms-confident-on-client-service-but-held-back-by-operational-drag
[9]	**Legal Futures, 29 Oct 2024** https://www.legalfutures.co.uk/latest-news/conveyancers-spend-nearly-half-their-time-chasing-people
[10]	**LeanLaw** https://www.leanlaw.co/blog/how-many-billable-hours-in-a-year/
[11]	**Law Week Colorado** https://www.lawweekcolorado.com/article/2024-state-of-the-solo-survey-findings/
[12]	**Above the Law, Sep 2026** https://abovethelaw.com/2026/09/lawyer-retention-in-three-words-automate-the-crap/
[13]	**AI Lawyer** https://ailawyer.pro/research/small-firm-legal-operations-2026
[14]	**2Civility** https://www.2civility.org/clio-2024-legal-trends-report-identifies-ai-alternative-billing-structures-and-client-engagement-as-focus-areas-for-todays-lawyers/
[15]	**Armstrong Watson, Feb 2026** https://www.armstrongwatson.co.uk/news/2026/02/law-firm-benchmarking-review-20242025-provides-positive-findings
[16]	**Legal Futures, 21 Jul 2023** https://legalfutures.co.uk/latest-news/pii-premiums-rises-to-be-lower-than-last-year-says-law-society-research
[17]	**Legal Futures, 20 Dec 2023** https://www.legalfutures.co.uk/associate-news/highlights-from-the-2023-legal-trends-report
[18]	**2Civility, 14 Oct 2022** https://www.2civility.org/clio-legal-trends-report-anticipates-stress-in-a-strong-legal-marketplace/
[19]	**Ten Percent Legal, Nov 2025** https://ten-percent.co.uk/?p=41317
[20]	**BLS** https://www.bls.gov/ooh/legal/paralegals-and-legal-assistants.htm
[21]	**Legal Futures, 2 Aug 2023** https://www.legalfutures.co.uk/associate-news/bighands-latest-research-gives-insight-into-just-how-deep-the-staff-attrition-crisis-is-for-law-firms
[22]	**CostBench** https://www.costbench.com/software/legal-practice-management/
[23]	**2Civility, 1 Nov 2024** https://www.2civility.org/2024-clio-legal-trends-report-fixing-the-first-impression-problem-for-law-firms/
[24]	**2Civility, 23 Oct 2019** https://www.2civility.org/clio-legal-trends-report-finds-law-firms-arent-responsive-to-potential-clients/
[25]	**Law Gazette** https://www.lawgazette.co.uk/news/law-firms-are-their-own-competitors/64288.article
[26]	**Legal Futures, 22 Jan 2025** https://www.legalfutures.co.uk/latest-news/more-than-third-of-clients-do-not-instruct-same-firm-for-new-work
[27]	**Answering Legal summary** https://answeringlegal.com/blog/four-takeaways-from-2024-legal-trends-report
[28]	**Property Industry Eye, 29 Mar 2021** https://propertyindustryeye.com/the-factors-that-are-to-blame-for-conveyancing-delays/
[29]	**Deka Chambers, 6 Oct 2023** https://www.dekachambers.com/2023/10/06/court-bundles-if-we-dont-fear-them-we-should/
[30]	**Jonathan Lea Network** https://www.jonathanlea.net/moving-to-consultancy-from-being-a-sole-practitioner/
[31]	**Toya Gavin, May 2018** https://toyagavin.substack.com/p/email
[32]	**A Different Practice, Aug 2025** https://adifferentpractice.substack.com/p/stop-doing-this-manually-5-tasks
[33]	**Reed conveyancing paralegal ads** https://www.reed.co.uk/jobs/conveyancing-paralegal-jobs
[34]	**Reed 57356370** https://www.reed.co.uk/jobs/conveyancing-paralegal/57356370
[35]	**Huggins Lewis Foskett** https://www.hugginslaw.co.uk/site/about/career-opportunities/conveyancing-secretary
[36]	**Mallory Pryce** https://www.mallorypryce.co.uk/jobs/7821165-legal-assistant-private-client
[37]	**ILFM** https://www.ilfm.org.uk/site/blog/ilfm-blog/legal-cashier-job-role-explained
[38]	**Indeed US legal assistant** https://www.indeed.com/hire/job-description/legal-assistant
[39]	**Indeed US paralegal** https://www.indeed.com/hire/job-description/paralegal
[40]	**Craigslist Los Angeles legal** https://www.craigslist.org/search/area/losangeles?cat=lgl
[41]	**Penningtons Manches Cooper** https://www.penningtonslaw.com/insights/transatlantic-litigation-disclosure-discovery-and-the-difference/
[42]	**SRA Accounts Rules** https://www.sra.org.uk/solicitors/standards-regulations/accounts-rules/
[43]	**Wikipedia: IOLTA** https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Interest_on_Lawyers%27_Trust_Accounts

[44]	**Reed 57348435** https://www.reed.co.uk/jobs/conveyancing-paralegal/57348435
[45]	**Craigslist Dweck Law posting** https://www.craigslist.org/view/d/new-york-legal-secretary-and-biller/uE4UxdG4uWgNsND4YvCyYS
[46]	**Reed legal secretary** https://www.reed.co.uk/jobs/legal-secretary-jobs
[47]	**Senior Legal Assistant, PI** https://www.craigslist.org/view/d/new-york-senior-legal-assistant/8oj9kyzSZDqrtqdSWQm4jt
[48]	**Court Calendar Clerk** https://www.craigslist.org/view/d/new-york-court-calendar-clerk-landlord/n3xEo2Auk7SstQSJ4Vfk9H
[49]	**Google suggest, "is chatgpt confidential"** https://suggestqueries.google.com/complete/search?client=firefox&gl=gb&q=is+chatgpt+confidential
[50]	**ai for solicitors** https://suggestqueries.google.com/complete/search?client=firefox&gl=gb&q=ai+for+solicitors
[51]	**court bundle** https://suggestqueries.google.com/complete/search?client=firefox&gl=gb&q=court+bundle
[52]	**law firm automation** https://suggestqueries.google.com/complete/search?client=firefox&gl=us&q=law+firm+automation
[53]	**outsource legal** https://suggestqueries.google.com/complete/search?client=firefox&gl=gb&q=outsource+legal
[54]	**Upwork legal-assistance jobs** https://www.upwork.com/freelance-jobs/legal-assistance/
[55]	**Upwork immigration-law jobs** https://www.upwork.com/freelance-jobs/apply/Intake-Specialist-for-Immigration-Law-Firm_~021907571624068917640/
[56]	**PeoplePerHour legal services** https://www.peopleperhour.com/freelance-jobs/business/legal-services
[57]	**Fiverr Clio automation** https://www.fiverr.com/gigs/clio-automation
[58]	**Fiverr paralegal** https://www.fiverr.com/gigs/paralegal
[59]	**Upwork** https://www.upwork.com/freelance-jobs/apply/Automation-Developer-Legal-Operations-Ongoing-Engagement_~022052780018516086731/
[60]	**Freelancer** https://www.freelancer.com/jobs/legal/
[61]	**Upwork** https://www.upwork.com/freelance-jobs/apply/Intake-Specialist-for-Family-Law-and-Immigration-Firm_~021914565614360494905/
[62]	**Upwork** https://www.upwork.com/hire/legal-virtual-assistants/
[63]	**Upwork** https://www.upwork.com/hire/ai-chatbot-specialists/
[64]	**Fiverr gig** https://www.fiverr.com/noahakanni/do-clio-automation-clio-matter-client-portal-clio-manage-desk-clio-client-crm
[65]	**Fiverr gig** https://www.fiverr.com/joell_k/set-up-clio-automate-your-legal-workflows-and-train-your-team-clio-grow
[66]	**Fiverr gig** https://www.fiverr.com/yassinerabaoui/program-a-gpt4-based-ai-legal-assistance-tool
[67]	**Fiverr chatbots** https://www.fiverr.com/categories/programming-tech/chatbots
[68]	**PPH** https://www.peopleperhour.com/freelance-jobs/business/legal-services/solicitor-for-selling-flat-4375687
[69]	**Legal Futures, 3 Feb 2026** https://www.legalfutures.co.uk/associate-news/property-transactions-spike-at-123-days-driving-industry-to-seek-greater-certainty/print/
[70]	**Carbon Law Partners** https://carbonlawpartners.com/2025/09/11/wondering-how-long-uk-property-conveyancing-takes-in-2025-we-break-it-all-down/
[71]	**GOV.UK SDLT** https://www.gov.uk/guidance/stamp-duty-land-tax-online-and-paper-returns
[72]	**HMLR processing times** https://www.gov.uk/guidance/hm-land-registry-processing-times
[73]	**HMLR requisitions, Dec 2025** https://www.gov.uk/government/news/hm-land-registry-gives-more-information-to-help-cut-delays-and-costs
[74]	**Mortgage Solutions, Jan 2023** https://www.mortgagesolutions.co.uk/news/2023/01/10/one-in-five-transactions-held-up-by-basic-conveyancing-errors-land-registry/
[75]	**findajob.dwp.gov.uk** https://findajob.dwp.gov.uk/details/17951411
[76]	**Legal Futures, 7 Jan 2026** https://www.legalfutures.co.uk/blog/the-sras-2025-aml-report-what-law-firms-need-to-know
[77]	**Today's Conveyancer, 11 May 2026** https://todaysconveyancer.co.uk/sra-tightens-grip-aml-enforcement-intensifies-2026/
[78]	**ICAEW, Jun 2025** https://www.icaew.com/regulation/regulatory-news/regulatory-news-2025-06/hmcts-updates-for-probate-practitioners-june-2025
[79]	**ICAEW, Sep 2025** https://www.icaew.com/regulation/regulatory-news/regulatory-news-2025-09/third-party-delays-in-probate-what-you-need-to-know
[80]	**Burton & Co probate pricing** https://www.burtonlaw.co.uk/probate-pricing/
[81]	**Myerson** https://myerson.co.uk/news-insights-and-events/changes-probate-application-process
[82]	**Legal Ombudsman 2025/26** https://www.legalombudsman.org.uk/information-centre/data-centre/complaints-data/legal-ombudsman-202526-annual-complaints-data-and-insight/
[83]	**Resolution guidance note** https://resolution.org.uk/guidance-note-court-bundles/
[84]	**Financial Remedies Journal** https://financialremediesjournal.com/bundle-of-joy-new-practice-direction-on-bundles-position-statements-etc-effective-2-march-2026/
[85]	**MoJ Family Court Statistics Oct-Dec 2025** https://www.gov.uk/government/statistics/family-court-statistics-quarterly-october-to-december-2025/family-court-statistics-quarterly-october-to-december-2025
[86]	**Law Society sustainability research** https://lawsociety.org.uk/topics/research/civil-legal-aid-sustainability
[87]	**Free Movement, 19 Feb 2025** https://freemovement.org.uk/the-home-office-is-creating-unnecessary-additional-work-and-delays-in-change-of-conditions-applications/
[88]	**EIN, UT IAC e-bundles** https://www.ein.org.uk/news/updated-upper-tribunal-immigration-and-asylum-chamber-guidance-electronic-bundles-and-use-ce
[89]	**Law Society** https://lawsociety.org.uk/topics/immigration/youre-under-pressure-to-stop-clients-being-tortured-or-killed-anonymous-immigration-solicitor-speaks
[90]	**Legal Ombudsman horizon scan, Oct 2023** https://www.legalombudsman.org.uk/media/ne1jmwfa/129-11-23-horizon-scan.pdf
[91]	**askMID** https://www.askmid.com/

[92]	**OIC start a claim** https://www.officialinjuryclaim.org.uk/help-hub/start-a-new-claim/
[93]	**Legal Futures, 14 Aug 2026** https://www.legalfutures.co.uk/associate-news/practice-area-growth-for-small-law-firms-in-the-uk
[94]	**Higgs LLP** https://www.higgsllp.co.uk/articles/employment-tribunal-backlog-continues-to-increase
[95]	**ACAS statistics** https://www.acas.org.uk/about-us/service-statistics/early-conciliation/early-conciliation-and-employment-tribunal-cases-data-2025-to-2026/july-september-2025
[96]	**BCLP, Mar 2026** https://www.bclplaw.com/en-US/events-insights-news/record-backlog-at-the-employment-tribunal-in-england-and-wales.html
[97]	**Access Group, D25 rates** https://help-proclaim.theaccessgroup.com/en/articles/12982547-criminal-legal-aid-fee-scheme-reform-december-2025
[98]	**GOV.UK LAA incident** https://www.gov.uk/guidance/legal-aid-agency-cyber-security-incident
[99]	**MoJ criminal consultation** https://www.gov.uk/government/consultations/criminal-legal-aid-proposals-for-solicitor-fee-scheme-reform/criminal-legal-aid-proposals-for-solicitor-fee-scheme-reform
[100]	**Family Law on CCMS, 2015** https://familylaw.co.uk/news_and_comment/acl-issues-stark-warning-over-legal-aid-billing-system
[101]	**GOV.UK possession** https://www.gov.uk/evicting-tenants/standard-possession-orders
[102]	**OTS Solicitors** https://www.otssolicitors.co.uk/news/landlord-possession-court-delays-2026/
[103]	**NRLA** https://www.nrla.org.uk/news/courts-unprepared-for-renters-rights-bill-as-possession-delays-worsen-news
[104]	**Pre-Action Protocol for Debt Claims** https://www.justice.gov.uk/courts/procedure-rules/civil/pdf/protocols/pre-action-protocol-for-debt-claims.pdf
[105]	**GOV.UK court fees** https://www.gov.uk/make-court-claim-for-money/court-fees
[106]	**SRA Transparency Rules** https://www.sra.org.uk/solicitors/standards-regulations/transparency-rules/
[107]	**SRA Code of Conduct** https://www.sra.org.uk/solicitors/standards-regulations/code-conduct-solicitors/
[108]	**Legal Futures on ILFM, May 2026** https://www.legalfutures.co.uk/blog/the-hidden-risks-in-client-account-reconciliations
[109]	**Legal Futures, 2011** https://www.legalfutures.co.uk/latest-news/cost-of-sra-compliance-forcing-small-firms-to-close-says-law-society-survey/print/
[110]	**Judiciary.uk minutes, 10 Feb 2025** https://www.judiciary.uk/wp-content/uploads/2025/04/ACO-CUG-Meeting-10.02.2025-Minutes.pdf
[111]	**Legal Futures, 8 Apr 2026** https://www.legalfutures.co.uk/latest-news/solicitor-develops-free-software-to-organise-court-bundles
[112]	**Boys & Maughan** https://www.boysandmaughan.co.uk/site/library/legalnews/waiting_time_for_grants_of_probate_remains_steady.html
[113]	**The Gazette** https://thegazette.co.uk/all-notices/content/103873
[114]	**Farrer & Co** https://www.farrer.co.uk/news-and-insights/acas-early-conciliation-time-limits-extended-to-12-weeks--what-you-need-to-know/
[115]	**MoJ** https://www.gov.uk/government/statistics/civil-justice-statistics-quarterly-april-to-june-2026/civil-justice-statistics-quarterly-april-to-june-2026
[116]	**Sands Anderson** https://www.sandsanderson.com/insights/thought/statistics-on-virginias-discipline-of-lawyers-fiscal-years-2020-2022
[117]	**Maryland AGC** https://mdcourts.gov/sites/default/files/import/attygrievance/docs/annualreport.pdf
[118]	**Legal Ombudsman 2024/25** https://www.legalombudsman.org.uk/information-centre/data-centre/complaints-data/legal-ombudsman-202425-annual-complaints-data-and-insight/
[119]	**Lawyers Mutual NC, Sep 2024** https://lawyersmutualnc.com/blog/oops-i-did-it-again-missed-deadlines-continue-to-plague-plaintiffs-attorneys
[120]	**ALPS, Jul 2026** https://www.alpsinsurance.com/blog/safeguarding-your-practice-what-current-malpractice-trends-are-telling-us-about-managing-risk
[121]	**CASEpeer checklist, Sep 2026** https://www.casepeer.com/blog/personal-injury-case-management-guide-and-checklist/
[122]	**CloudLex** https://www.cloudlex.com/law-firm-management/essentials-of-medical-record-retrieval/
[123]	**Tavrn** https://tavrn.ai/blog/medical-record-retrieval-turnaround-time
[124]	**LegalFunding.com, Jul 2025** https://www.legalfunding.com/news/navigating-the-medical-lien-obstacle
[125]	**YoCierge on Supio** https://www.supio.com/blog/how-flat-fee-record-retrieval-saves-firms-money-and-improves-predictability
[126]	**Casemark** https://www.casemark.com/workflows/financial-affidavit-and-disclosure
[127]	**Freed Marcroft** https://freedmarcroft.com/?p=2427
[128]	**Hodgson Law Office** https://hodgsonlawoffices.com/family-law/child-custody
[129]	**Content Snare** https://contentsnare.com/form-templates/probate-questionnaire/
[130]	**Douglass & Runger** https://www.douglassrunger.com/probate-law/what-is-an-inventory-and-when-do-i-have-to-file-one
[131]	**Atticus TN form** https://forms.weareatticus.com/tennessee/probate/estate-inventory-5857
[132]	**Toorey** https://toorey.com/blogs/rfe-response-management-how-immigration-firms-handle-requests-for-evidence-without-losing-time/
[133]	**Messersmith Law** https://messersmithlaw.com/?p=4133
[134]	**USCIS online filing** https://www.uscis.gov/file-online/forms-available-to-file-online
[135]	**WDBJ7, Nov 2019** https://www.wdbj7.com/content/news/WDBJ7-In-Depth-Body-cameras-create-additional-workload-cost-for-localities-565234062.html
[136]	**The Journal** https://www.the-journal.com/?p=147917
[137]	**US Courts, Ch 7** http://www.uscourts.gov/court-programs/bankruptcy/bankruptcy-basics/chapter-7-bankruptcy-basics
[138]	**US Courts, Ch 13** http://www.uscourts.gov/court-programs/bankruptcy/bankruptcy-basics/chapter-13-bankruptcy-basics
[139]	**Greenway Law Group** https://www.greenwaybankruptcy.com/

[140] **Charles E. Boyk** https://www.charlesboyk-law.com/toledo-workers-compensation-lawyer/

[141] **Greeman Toomey** https://www.greemantoomey.com/?p=827

[142] **Midwest Disability** https://www.midwestdisability.com/blog/2023/10/how-long-does-social-security-have-to-issue-a-decision/

[143] **Cogdill Law Firm** https://cogdilllawfirm.com

[144] **Sallé Law** https://www.sallelaw.com/

[145] **Lawyers Mutual NC, Dec 2022** https://www.lawyersmutualnc.com/blog/missed-deadlines-are-top-cause-of-legal-malpractice

[146] **Ezel Alabama trust template** https://ezel.ai/templates/trust-account-reconciliation/al

[147] **MinuteDock summary of Clio 2024** https://minutedock.com/academy/flat-fee-vs-hourly-billing-guide-for-law-practices

[148] **Allington Hughes** https://www.allingtonhughes.co.uk/

[149] **Taylor Bracewell** https://www.taylorbracewell.co.uk/

[150] **McKenzie Bell** https://mckenzie-bell.co.uk/

[151] **Kenneth Jones redirect** https://www.kennethjones.co.uk/

[152] **Hartley Law Office listing** https://lawyers.uslegal.com/attorney/hartley-law-office-llc-77313550/

[153] **Legal Futures, 24 Feb 2026**
https://www.legalfutures.co.uk/latest-news/solicitor-faces-probe-after-putting-client-documents-into-chatgpt

[154] **Legal Futures, 9 Oct 2026**
https://www.legalfutures.co.uk/latest-news/ai-poses-existential-threat-to-immigration-cases-tribunal-warns

[155] **Slaughter and May Lens, 8 Jun 2026** https://thelens.slaughterandmay.com/post/102n1a1/privilege-and-ai-hallucinations

[156] **Legal Cheek, 18 Aug 2026** https://www.legalcheek.com/2026/08/sra-warns-over-ai-misuse-following-rise-in-blunders/

[157] **Lets Data Science** https://letsdatascience.com/news/sra-warns-solicitors-over-ai-hallucinations-and-client-confi-2f083fd3

[158] **Bar Council PDF** https://www.barcouncilethics.co.uk/wp-content/uploads/2024/01/Considerations-when-using-ChatGPT-and-generative-artificial-intelligence-Nov-2025.pdf

[159] **Legal Cheek, May 2026**
https://www.legalcheek.com/2026/05/hands-off-chatgpt-bsb-puts-barristers-on-notice-over-free-ai-tools/amp/

[160] **LawCareers.Net, Michelmores**
https://www.lawcareers.net/Explore/CommercialQuestion/Michelmores-LLP-Generative-AI-use-and-client-confidentiality

[161] **Judgment, National Archives** https://caselaw.nationalarchives.gov.uk/ewhc/admin/2025/1383

[162] **Zuva summary** https://zuva.ai/blog/aba-formal-opinion-512/

[163] **KBA E-457** https://kybar.org/Portals/0/Admin/Ethics%20Opinions/KBA%20E-457.pdf

[164] **Epiq** https://www.epiqglobal.com/en-US/Resource-Center/Articles/State-Bars-are-Issuing-Generative-AI-Guidance

[165] **Washington Legal Foundation**
https://www.wlf.org/2026/04/27/publishing/united-states-v-heppner-use-of-generative-ai-can-waive-privileges/

[166] **ACEDS** https://aceds.org/do-you-waive-privilege-by-using-ai-two-federal-courts-say-it-depends-aceds-blog/

[167] **MSBA, 27 Jul 2026** https://www.msba.org/site/content/News-and-Publications/News/General-News/Confronting_the_Hard%20Numbers_Behind_Lawyers_AI_and_Phantom_Precedents.aspx

[168] **Cronkite News, 28 Oct 2025** https://cronkitenews.azpbs.org/2025/10/28/lawyers-ai-hallucinations-chatgpt/

[169] **LawNext, Apr 2025**
https://www.lawnext.com/2025/04/an-ai-assisted-look-at-four-new-surveys-on-ai-adoption-in-law-how-do-they-compare-differ.html

[170] **SRA research findings** https://publications.sra.org.uk/sole-practitioners-and-small-firms-use-of-technology/research-findings

[171] **SRA, Nov 2023** https://www.sra.org.uk/sra/research-publications/artificial-intelligence-legal-market/

[172] **Legal Futures blog, Access Legal** https://www.legalfutures.co.uk/blog/containing-the-spread-of-unapproved-ai

[173] **Solicitors Journal, 16 May 2022**
https://www.solicitorsjournal.com/sjarticle/bellwether-report-2022-revenue-is-up-but-recruitment-and-retention-remains-a-challenge

[174] **Bloomberg Law** https://news.bloomberglaw.com/business-and-practice/sure-youve-got-an-ai-policy-but-is-everyone-following-it

[175] **Intapp case study** https://www.intapp.com/case-study/nelson-mullins-copilot-ai-permissions/

[176] **ABA Law Technology Today, 2026** https://www.americanbar.org/groups/law_practice/resources/law-technology-today/2026/what-should-law-firms-do-before-deploying-copilot/

[177] **Legal Futures** https://www.legalfutures.co.uk/latest-news/small-law-firms-embracing-ai-as-they-move-away-from-hourly-billing

[178] **LawNext, Mar 2025** https://www.lawnext.com/2025/03/ai-adoption-nearly-doubles-among-small-law-firms-according-to-smokeballs-2025-state-of-law-report.html

[179] **NCSC, Jun 2023** https://www.ncsc.gov.uk/files/Cyber-Threat-Report_UK-Legal-Sector.pdf

[180] **Legal Futures, 31 Oct 2019** https://www.legalfutures.co.uk/latest-news/review-spells-out-toll-of-cyber-crime-on-law-firms/print/

[181] **ICO, Levales** https://ico.org.uk/action-weve-taken/enforcement/2024/10/levales-solicitors-llp/

[182] **teiss, 22 Apr 2025** https://www.teiss.co.uk/privacy/ico-fines-law-firm-dpp-60000-over-a-major-client-data-breach-15669

[183] **Mortgage Solutions, 5 Dec 2023** https://www.mortgagesolutions.co.uk/news/2023/12/05/thousands-of-sales-in-limbo-after-conveyancing-cyberattack-%e2%80%92-reports/

[184] **Insurance Business / QBE, Jun 2026**
https://www.insurancebusinessmag.com/au/news/cyber/ransomware-groups-are-coming-for-law-firms-580610.aspx

[185] **ABA 2023 Cybersecurity TechReport**
https://www.americanbar.org/groups/law_practice/resources/tech-report/2023/2023-cybersecurity-techreport/

[186] **Law Society** https://www.lawsociety.org.uk/topics/regulation/solicitor-fined-for-failing-to-spot-friday-afternoon-cyber-fraud

[187] **Legal Futures, 31 Jul 2024**
https://www.legalfutures.co.uk/latest-news/law-firms-need-whatsapp-policies-when-advising-asylum-clients

[188] **Legal Futures on MacInnes v DWF** https://www.legalfutures.co.uk/latest-news/whatsapp-messages-form-part-of-firms-file-if-they-charge-for-them

[189] **Conventus Law** https://conventuslaw.com/report/how-to-write-outside-counsel-guidelines-that-govern-ai-assisted-work/

[190] **Bloomberg Law** https://news.bloomberglaw.com/esg/ai-standing-orders-proliferate-as-federal-courts-forge-own-paths

[191] **ABA 2022** https://www.americanbar.org/groups/law_practice/resources/tech-report/2022/cybersecurity/

[192] **Sikich** https://www.sikich.com/insight/the-lawyers-guide-to-cybersecurity-in-2026/

[193] **Law Society Communities** https://communities.lawsociety.org.uk/december-2019/the-friday-blues/6000595.article

[194] **Forensic Control** https://forensiccontrol.com/sectors/law-firms/

[195] **Finch** https://www.finchlegal.com/

[196] **Morgan & Morgan, Mar 2025** https://www.forthepeople.com/blog/how-get-copy-police-report/

[197] **Injury Claim Coach** https://www.injuryclaimcoach.com/police-report.html

[198] **Tex. Transp. Code 550.065** https://texas.public.law/statutes/tex._transp._code_section_550.065

[199] **Fla. Stat. 316.066** https://florida.public.law/statutes/fla._stat._316.066

[200] **Cal. Veh. Code 20012** https://california.public.law/codes/ca_veh_code_section_20012

[201] **Ohio Crash Retrieval** https://ohtrafficdata.dps.ohio.gov/CrashRetrieval

[202] **ISP Crash Reports** https://isp.illinois.gov/CrashReports

[203] **Fla. Stat. 627.4137** https://florida.public.law/statutes/fla._stat._627.4137

[204] **CMS BCRC** https://www.cms.gov/medicare/coordination-benefits-recovery/beneficiary-services

[205] **Garretson Resolution Group** https://web.garretsongroup.com/claimant-education-posts/claimant-education/long-normally-take-resolve-medicare-lien-individual-case

[206] **OSB PLF PI checklist** https://assets.osbplf.org/forms/practice_forms/issues-for-consideration-in-commencing-and-settling-a-personal-injury-case.docx

[207] **EvenUp Intake** https://www.evenuplaw.com/intake

[208] **EvenUp, 3 Jun 2026** https://www.evenuplaw.com/blog/lerner-rowe-faster-cases-efficiency-settlements/

[209] **Supio, 16 Mar 2026** https://www.supio.com/blog/march-2026-release

[210] **Zapier Clio** https://zapier.com/apps/clio/integrations

[211] **Zapier Filevine** https://zapier.com/apps/filevine/integrations

[212] **CloudLex** https://www.cloudlex.com/

[213] **MIB** https://www.mib.org.uk/

[214] **GOV.UK STATS19** https://www.gov.uk/guidance/road-accident-and-safety-statistics-guidance

[215] **Lawyerist Clio review** https://lawyerist.com/reviews/law-practice-management-software/clio/

[216] **Clio help 35132279298843** https://help.clio.com/hc/articles/35132279298843

[217] **Clio Automated Workflows guide, May 2025** https://www.clio.com/wp-content/uploads/2025/05/Automated-Workflows-Best-Practice-Guide.pdf

[218] **TrustRadius Clio** https://web-v2.prod.trustradius.com/products/clio/reviews/all

[219] **PR Newswire, 16 Oct 2025** https://www.prnewswire.com/news-releases/clio-introduces-the-legal-industrys-first-intelligent-legal-work-platform-302586236.html

[220] **PR Newswire, 9 Mar 2026** https://www.prnewswire.com/news-releases/clio-introduces-clio-operate-to-the-north-american-legal-market-302707832.html

[221] **Clio help 16186400854171** https://help.clio.com/hc/en-us/articles/16186400854171

[222] **Zapier community** https://community.zapier.com/troubleshooting-99/zap-isn-t-updating-custom-field-for-all-matters-in-clio-28292

[223] **Clio developer docs** https://docs.developers.clio.com/api-docs/clio-manage/rate-limits/

[224] **Clio developer docs** https://docs.developers.clio.com/api-docs/clio-manage/applications/

[225] **PricingSaaS** https://pricingsaas.com/companies/clio

[226] **MyCase** https://www.mycase.com/features/workflow-automation/

[227] **Lawyerist MyCase** https://lawyerist.com/reviews/law-practice-management-software/mycase/

[228] **PracticePanther** https://www.practicepanther.com/case-management/workflows/

[229] **Lawyerist PP** https://lawyerist.com/reviews/law-practice-management-software/practicepanther/

[230] **CASEpeer pricing** https://www.casepeer.com/pricing/

[231] **Lawyerist Smokeball** https://lawyerist.com/reviews/law-practice-management-software/smokeball/

[232] **Filevine support** https://support.filevine.com/hc/en-us/articles/360004140772

[233] **Oktopeak** https://oktopeak.com/blog/filevine-pricing-real-cost-tco/

[234] **LEAP UK features** https://www.leaplegalsoftware.com/uk/features/

[235] **Osprey** https://ospreyapproach.com/

[236] **Access Legal** https://www.theaccessgroup.com/en-gb/legal/case-management/

[237] **PR Newswire, 16 Oct 2025** https://www.prnewswire.com/news-releases/the-science-behind-smarter-law-clios-2025-legal-trends-report-reveals-how-technology-is-rewiring-the-way-lawyers-work-302585725.html

[238] **OSB PLF tickler systems** https://assets.osbplf.org/forms/practice_forms/reminder-and-tickler-systems.pdf

[239] **OSB PLF docketing checklist** https://assets.osbplf.org/forms/practice_forms/docketing-and-calendaring-checklist.pdf

[240] **Trustpilot** https://www.trustpilot.com/review/clio.com

[241] **Clio Grow conversion help** https://help.clio.com/hc/articles/9286116462747

[242] **Big Mode** https://www.clio.com/partnerships/certified-consultants/find-a-ccc/big-mode-consulting/

[243] **Apply Compliance Today** https://www.clio.com/partnerships/certified-consultants/find-a-ccc/apply-compliance-today/

[244] **aimadefor, Jul 2026** https://www.aimadefor.com/blog/clio-pricing-2026/

[245] **Costbench** https://www.costbench.com/software/legal-practice-management/clio-grow/hidden-costs/

[246] **Jayva** https://www.jayvaglobal.com/news/are-you-wasting-your-software-investment

[247] **LEAP partner directory** https://www.leaplegalsoftware.com/uk/certified-partner-directory/

[248] **LEAP Partner Network** https://www.leaplegalsoftware.com/uk/partner-network/

[249] **Vineskills** https://www.vineskills.com/pricing

[250] **Upwork Filevine developer job** https://www.upwork.com/freelance-jobs/apply/Filevine-Developer-Workflow-Optimization-Dashboard-Development_~022064174955884814478

[251] **Built In** https://builtin.com/job/filevine-administrator/7571212

[252] **ZipRecruiter** https://www.ziprecruiter.com/Jobs/Filevine

[253] **SoftwareFinder** https://softwarefinder.com/legal/filevine-software/reviews

[254] **Actionstep pricing** https://www.actionstep.com/pricing/

[255] **Baskerville Drummond** https://baskervilledrummond.com/

[256] **3Kites** https://www.3kites.com/

[257] **Lawyers Mutual NC, 29 Sep 2026** https://lawyersmutualnc.com/article/dont-leave-client-intake-to-chance/

[258] **CASEpeer medical records, Sep 2026** https://www.casepeer.com/blog/medical-records-management/

[259] **ChartRequest** https://www.chartrequest.com/articles/medical-record-retrieval-delays-personal-injury

[260] **Finch guides** https://www.finchlegal.com/guides

[261] **Smokeball, Jan 2023** https://www.smokeball.com/blog/document-request-reporting

[262] **EvenUp** https://www.evenuplaw.com/

[263] **EvenUp Medical Management** https://www.evenuplaw.com/products/medical-management

[264] **Supio chronologies** https://www.supio.com/medical-chronologies

[265] **Eve Legal** https://www.eve.legal/

[266] **Wisedocs** https://www.wisedocs.ai/

[267] **DigitalOwl** https://www.digitalowl.com/

[268] **Supio** https://www.supio.com/

[269] **Filevine** https://www.filevine.com/

[270] **TrustRadius Filevine** https://web-v2.prod.trustradius.com/products/filevine/reviews/all

[271] **Case Status** https://www.casestatus.com/

[272] **Sacra, May 2026** https://sacra.com/c/filevine

[273] **Lawyerist Filevine** https://lawyerist.com/reviews/law-practice-management-software/filevine/

[274] **Dupple, May 2026** https://dupple.com/reviews/filevine

[275] **LawNext, 9 Oct 2023** https://www.lawnext.com/2023/10/clio-goes-all-out-with-major-product-announcements-including-a-personal-injury-add-on-e-filing-and-of-course-generative-ai.html

[276] **Filevine case study** https://filevine.com/customers/case-studies/connecticut-trial-firm/

[277] **Capterra Filevine p2** https://capterra.com/p/140815/Filevine/reviews/?page=2

[278] **Lawyerist Clio Grow** https://lawyerist.com/reviews/intake-crm/clio-grow/

[279] **Layer3Labs, 22 Sep 2026** https://www.layer3labs.io/comparisons/lawmatics-vs-clio-grow

[280] **Costbench Clio** https://costbench.com/software/ai-legal-tools/clio/

[281] **Clio app directory, Falkon** https://clio.com/app-directory/falkon-sms

[282] **Text Request** https://www.clio.com/app-directory/text-request/

[283] **Clio UK vs LEAP** https://www.clio.com/uk/compare/clio-vs-leap/

[284] **CivicIQ** https://civiciq.com/public-contract/cbcdbbcd-a682-4543-8213-34422ff206e5

[285] **Software Advice Lead Docket** https://www.softwareadvice.com/crm/leaddocket-profile

[286] **Lead Docket support** https://support.leaddocket.com/hc/en-us/articles/360045303012-Adding-a-Phone-Number

[287] **Vinesign** https://vinesign.com/

[288] **rfp.wiki Clio** https://www.rfp.wiki/legal-compliance/legal-practice-management/clio

[289] **Capterra Clio** https://www.capterra.com/p/105428/Clio/reviews/%3Fpage%3D13

[290] **Capterra Filevine** https://capterra.com/p/140815/Filevine/reviews/

[291] **TrustRadius p2** https://web-v2.prod.trustradius.com/products/filevine/reviews/all?page=2

[292] **rfp.wiki Filevine** https://www.rfp.wiki/legal-compliance/filevine

[293] **Filevine partners** https://filevine.com/partners/directory

[294] **Filevine news** https://www.filevine.com/news/filevine-releases-payment-processing-to-deliver-end-to-end-timekeeping-billing-and-payments-platform

[295] **Clio help 18350703919899** https://help.clio.com/hc/articles/18350703919899

[296] **Clio online intake forms** https://www.clio.com/features/online-intake-forms/

[297] **Clio help 14164457325595** https://help.clio.com/hc/articles/14164457325595

[298] **Layer3Labs intake roundup, Jul 2026** https://www.layer3labs.io/comparisons/best-legal-client-intake-software

[299] **Clio Cloud Conference 2022 PDF** https://cliocloudconference.com/wp-content/uploads/2022/10/Clio-Cloud-Conference-2022-How-to-Set-Up-Dynamic-Information-and-Document-Automation.pdf

[300] **G2 Clio Grow** https://g2.com/products/clio-grow/reviews

[301] **Clio Grow data import** https://help.clio.com/hc/en-us/articles/18952761837979

[302] **Lead Docket features** https://www.leaddocket.com/features/

[303] **Phase Mapping** https://support.leaddocket.com/hc/en-us/articles/360048471211-Phase-Mapping

[304] **Vinesign article** https://support.leaddocket.com/hc/en-us/articles/4410421026331

[305] **Software Advice AU** https://www.softwareadvice.com.au/software/266483/leaddocket

[306] **Capterra CA compare** https://www.capterra.ca/compare/105428/176004/clio/vs/leaddocket

[307] **TrustRadius Lead Docket** https://web-v2.prod.trustradius.com/products/lead-docket/reviews/all

[308] **Law Society LEAP offer** https://www.lawsociety.org.uk/membership/offers/leap-legal-software

[309] **Capterra UK compare** https://www.capterra.co.uk/compare/105428/147413/clio/vs/leap

[310] **Trustpilot LEAP UK** https://uk.trustpilot.com/review/leap.co.uk

[311] **Software Advice FR LEAP** https://softwareadvice.fr/software/20175/leap?page=2

[312] **Filevine support, phases** https://support.filevine.com/hc/en-us/articles/360004186471

[313] **Zapier community** https://community.zapier.com/how-do-i-3/avoid-creating-duplicate-contacts-in-clio-manage-13442

[314] **Carly blog** https://www.usecarly.com/blog/filevine-api/

[315] **LexisNexis** https://www.lexisnexis.com/en-gb/legal/guidance/preparing-electronic-pdf-bundles

[316] **Virginia Lawyers Weekly** https://valawyersweekly.com/?p=131341

[317] **MoJ** https://www.gov.uk/government/consultations/civil-legal-aid-towards-a-sustainable-future

[318] **BCL Legal** https://www.bcllegal.com/the-brief/insights/lexisnexis-bellwether-report-2026

[319] **SignNow** https://www.signnow.com/template/florida-family-law-rules-of-procedure-form-12900a-

[320] **NC Bar CLE** https://cle.ncbar.org/courses/87757

[321] **BHSG posting** https://bhsg.com/jobs/job/bm-btb_1773939696-family-law-paralegal-chicago-illinois

[322] **rlegaltech.com/jobs** https://www.rlegaltech.com/jobs/

[323] **Axial Search** https://axialsearch.com/insights/ai-engineering-jobs

[324] **ITJobsWatch** https://www.itjobswatch.co.uk/jobs/london/legal%20technology%20specialist.do

[325] **Glassdoor UK** https://www.glassdoor.co.uk/Job/legal-engineer-jobs-SRCH_KO0,14.htm

[326] **Reed** https://www.reed.co.uk/jobs/legal-tech-jobs

[327] **Totaljobs** https://www.totaljobs.com/jobs/legal-tech

[328] **Legal.io** https://www.legal.io/jobs/5787729/Full-time/Legal-Engineer/Remote

[329] **NonBillable, 19 Feb 2026** https://www.nonbillable.co.uk/posts/legal-careers-big-law-ai-working-at-harvey-legora-luminance

[330] **Lawfuel, 3 Oct 2026** https://www.lawfuel.com/ai-companies-poach-biglaw-talent-h1-2026-lateral-report/

[331] **Everlaw careers** https://www.everlaw.com/careers/4648836006/

[332] **AI Vortex** https://www.aivortex.io/legal/guides/ai-legal-career-paths-2026/

[333] **Harvey careers** https://www.harvey.ai/company/careers/3fc0953f-8a03-46f4-8f4b-d12cf95f2800

[334] **Justia Jobs** https://www.justia.jobs/employer/harvey-6039

[335] **Built In** https://builtin.com/jobs/legal/artificial-intelligence

[336] **Levels.fyi** https://www.levels.fyi/t/software-engineer/title/ai-engineer

[337] **Court Cast, 26 Sep 2026** https://courtscast.com/law-firms-step-up-tech-hiring-as-ai-race-moves-deeper-into-legal-work/

[338] **Artificial Lawyer** https://www.artificiallawyer.com/2026/09/28/disney-seeks-legal-ai-chief-amid-inhouse-shakeup/

[339] **The Ladders**
https://www.theladders.com/job/knowledge-management-innovation-manager-fenwickandwest-new-york-ny_88790892

[340] **ZipRecruiter** https://www.ziprecruiter.com/Salaries/Legal-Operations-Analyst-Salary

[341] **HireLegalOps** https://hirelegalops.com/resources/legal-ops-analyst-salary-2026

[342] **ZipRecruiter** https://www.ziprecruiter.com/Salaries/Legal-Technology-Consultant-Salary

[343] **Glassdoor** https://www.glassdoor.com/Salaries/london-legal-technologist-salary-SRCH_IL.0,6_IC2671300_KO7,25.htm

[344] **Jooble** https://uk.jooble.org/salary/legal-technologist/United-Kingdom

[345] **Glassdoor Legora listing**
https://www.glassdoor.co.uk/job-listing/legal-engineer-legora-JV_IC2671300_KO0,14_KE15,21.htm?jl=1009784012126

[346] **ZipRecruiter** https://www.ziprecruiter.com/Jobs/Artificial-Intelligence-Engineer-Visa-Sponsorship

[347] **Artificial Lawyer, 13 Apr 2026**
https://www.artificiallawyer.com/2026/04/13/legal-tech-raised-2-3b-in-q1-26-but-3-companies-dominate/

[348] **CNBC** https://www.cnbc.com/2026/03/25/legal-ai-startup-harvey-raises-200-million-at-11-billion-valuation.html

[349] **LawNext, Jan 2026** https://www.lawnext.com/2026/01/the-10-legal-tech-trends-that-defined-2025.html

[350] **US News / Reuters**
https://money.usnews.com/investing/news/articles/2026-07-13/thomson-reuters-to-cut-small-number-of-engineering-jobs

[351] **The Next Web** https://thenextweb.com/news/thomson-reuters-engineering-layoffs-ai

[352] **Upwork Clio freelancers** https://www.upwork.com/hire/themis-solutions-clio-freelancers/

[353] **Fiverr legal automation** https://www.fiverr.com/gigs/legal-automation

[354] **Fiverr AI automation cost guide** https://www.fiverr.com/resources/guides/costs/ai-automation-experts

[355] **PeoplePerHour** https://www.peopleperhour.com/freelance-jobs/artificial-intelligence/artificial-intelligence-chatbot-development

[356] **Lazige** https://lazige.agency/guides/ai-consultant-pricing-guide-uk

[357]	**GigUp** https://giguphq.com/blog/rag-chatbot-development-jobs-on-upwork-how-to-find-better-ai-projects-faster
[358]	**Pivot180** https://pivot180.ai/resources/ai-consultant-for-law-firms-cost-process-how-to-choose-2026
[359]	**ConsultingDemand** https://consultingdemand.com/blog/consultant-hourly-rates/
[360]	**Clutch** https://clutch.co/it-services/legal-industry
[361]	**Marin County contract** https://marin.granicus.com/MetaViewer.php?view_id=&clip_id=13163&meta_id=1442479
[362]	**Clio LinkedIn** https://ca.linkedin.com/company/clio---cloud-based-legal-technology
[363]	**Clio Certified Consultants** https://www.clio.com/partnerships/certified-consultants/
[364]	**Hunnings** https://hunningsconsultancy.co.uk/leap-assistance/
[365]	**Upwork legal** https://www.upwork.com/hire/legal-focus-freelancers/
[366]	**Fiverr gig** https://www.fiverr.com/trustedit/build-ai-app-for-legal-compliance-and-law-firms
[367]	**Fiverr chatbot cost guide** https://www.fiverr.com/resources/guides/costs/chatbot-developer
[368]	**Botpool** https://www.botpool.ai/blogs/how-much-does-it-cost-to-hire-an-ai-freelancer
[369]	**ColabContent** https://colabcontent.com/best/ai-consultants-law-firms/
[370]	**AY Automate** https://www.ayautomate.com/blog/ai-consultant-hourly-rate-guide-2026
[371]	**Actionstep partners** https://www.actionstep.com/partners/
[372]	**ABA 2024 Technology and Training TechReport** https://www.americanbar.org/groups/law_practice/resources/tech-report/2024/2024-technology-and-training/
[373]	**ABA 2024 Budgeting and Planning TechReport** https://www.americanbar.org/groups/law_practice/resources/tech-report/2024/2024-budgeting-and-planning-techreport/
[374]	**LawNext, 7 Mar 2025** https://www.lawnext.com/2025/03/aba-tech-survey-finds-growing-adoption-of-ai-in-legal-practice-with-efficiency-gains-as-primary-driver.html
[375]	**ABA 2024 AI TechReport** https://www.americanbar.org/groups/law_practice/resources/tech-report/2024/2024-artificial-intelligence-techreport/
[376]	**Clio 2025 report** https://www.clio.com/resources/legal-trends/2025-solo-small-firm-report/
[377]	**NC Bar, May 2026** https://www.ncbar.org/nc-lawyer/2026-05/by-the-numbers-what-surveys-show-about-law-firm-ai-adoption/
[378]	**tryclean.ai** https://www.tryclean.ai/solutions/legal/law-firm-technology
[379]	**LawyerAI Directory** https://www.lawyerai.directory/blog/legal-ai-budget-allocation-2026
[380]	**LeanLaw Clio guide** https://www.leanlaw.co/blog/the-complete-guide-to-clio-100-essential-questions-answered-for-mid-sized-law-firms-2025/
[381]	**ABA Law Practice Today** https://www.americanbar.org/groups/law_practice/resources/law-technology-today/2025/how-to-get-clients-as-a-lawyer-11-steps-to-success/

SECTION 11

What could not be verified

The researchers were blocked by many primary hosts (clio.com and its help centre; americanbar.org; lawsociety.org.uk; lawgazette.co.uk; sra.org.uk notice pages; G2, Capterra and (for some products) TrustRadius; Upwork and Fiverr gig pages; Reddit on every mirror; most US state crash-report portals and every UK police-force collision-report page). The items below rest on search snippets, secondary reports or vendor claims, or were not found at all, and should be checked before being repeated to a client.

Table 11.1 Items that rest on snippets, secondary reports or vendor claims

Item	Status
Clio 2024 and 2025 utilisation, realisation, collection and lock-up figures	Search summaries and secondary sites only; clio.com returned 403; no 2024-25 lock-up figure found anywhere
SRA warning notice text (Aug 2026), Law Society "Generative AI: the essentials", ABA Formal Opinion 512 PDF, SRA Risk Outlook on AI	All quoted second-hand (Legal Cheek, Michelmores, Zuva, LeanLaw); primary pages blocked
The "Munir" Upper Tribunal decision said to hold that open-tool use is "an automatic breach of legal professional privilege"	Cited only in vendor and consultancy commentary; no citation, date or primary text located; UK v SSHD [2026] UKUT 81 (IAC) is cited by Slaughter and May as the companion authority but was not read directly
42 SRA reports of AI misuse (Jul 2025-Jul 2026)	Attributed to Legal IT Insider via two secondary sites; not seen in the notice itself
Access Legal shadow-AI survey (59% / 68%) and "4.16 hours a week"	Vendor-run, self-reported, 200 respondents
Clio UK "96% have adopted AI", AI Lawyer "89.3% lose 5+ hours", Smokeball 53%, Clio "74% of tasks automatable"	Vendor surveys, some self-selected
Microsoft Copilot 30-day prompt retention	An older Substack post; current Microsoft terms not verified
Crash-report fees, waiting times and party rules for every state except Texas, Florida, California and Ohio; BuyCrash, CrashDocs and ReportBeam fees and account terms; "$10" Florida and Kentucky recollections	Not sourced; treat as unconfirmed
UK police collision-report fee (the "£100-£200" figure), who may request, turnaround; "SCRIM" as a collision-record system	Not found; SCRIM appears in no fetched source (the police statistical return is STATS19); MIB professional pages and MIAFTR access unsourced
Clio help-centre specifics: whether a custom field can be marked required, whether task-template assignees can be set by role, the full native "When" trigger list, whether webhooks exist	Help centre blocked; API reference too large to fetch; no webhooks page found but not proven absent
Clio Certified Consultant count, UK list and any Clio-published consultant rates; Clio Manage AI, PI add-on and top-tier prices after the Aug 2026 rename	Blocked; third-party price trackers and blogs only
Upwork budgets and Fiverr prices and review counts for Clio and Filevine set-up gigs; the "most-reviewed gig" question	Not readable (403); only titles and starting prices from snippets
Independent reviews of EvenUp, Supio, Eve, Finch, Wisedocs, DigitalOwl, CASEpeer, Lead Docket	G2, Capterra and TrustRadius blocked or empty; all performance figures are vendor-authored or vendor-selected testimonials
Filevine seat price, Lead Docket standalone terms, whether a Zapier Filevine app exists (Dupple says no, Fiverr sellers say yes), Marin County seat count	Conflicting or unreadable sources
The 10-15 day medical-records turnaround ("2024 U.S. Legal Support survey"), "3.5+ hours per affidavit", RFE "6 to 10 hours"	Vendor figures, no independent survey found
Thomson Reuters State of US Small Law Firms 2024 or 2025 edition; ABA Profile firm-size percentages for 2024-25; ABA 2024-25 breach rates by firm size	Not found or blocked; 2023 TR edition is the latest with figures
Bellwether 2023-2025 headline figures (hours, admin time, cash-flow worry)	Only titles listed by LexisNexis; 2025 partial via Legal Futures
Law Society Annual Statistics 2023-25 (firms by partner count); UK figure for hours per week on compliance after 2011	Not retrievable

Item	Status
Conveyancer "72% under severe pressure" (Conveyancing Foundation 2023)	Search summary only; not on the page fetched
Hunter Recruiting's "turnover nearly 30% higher" at firms under 50 attorneys and "$30,000 to $50,000" paralegal replacement	Recruiter blog, no source given
Reddit-native phrasing (r/Lawyertalk, r/LawFirm, r/paralegal, r/uklaw), including the August 2026 r/paralegal thread on missing providers	Reddit unreachable on every host; only one thread paraphrased by Rev
Page counts per matter for bundles, disclosure, medical records or probate files	No UK or US source found; only a 2015 North Carolina court-file study (71.6 pages per civil superior file) snippet
Commercial court-bundling products and their reviews	Not in the notes; only the free tool and LexisNexis guidance
Idaho mandatory malpractice insurance claim; Beancount's claim that twelve state bars shortened trust-reconciliation deadlines from 1 July 2026	Conflicting or unverified
Upwork and Fiverr freelance rates for legal AI and Clio work ($30-$61 an hour, $500-$5,000 a project, gigs "from $20-$80")	Upwork's and Fiverr's own "hire" and cost-guide marketing pages, seen in snippets; no buyer posts with budgets and no seller-to-post ratios could be read
Clio "100 Clio Certified Consultants" and "280 app integration partners"	Clio's LinkedIn page via snippet, about seven months old when indexed; the consultant directory itself was blocked
ABA 2024 TechReport figures on where solos turn for help (4% internal IT, 28% Google first, 55.4% no technology budget)	Search snippets only; americanbar.org returned 403
Thomson Reuters engineering cuts "up to 500"	Anonymous employee figure reported by Reuters; the company said "a small number"
UK vendor "legal engineer" pay (£46,000-£120,000)	Glassdoor and model estimates, not employer-posted salaries; no UK employer-posted legal-engineer salary found
Pivot180 consultancy rate card ($150-$350 an hour, $5,000-$20,000 implementations, $1,500 a month retainers)	A consultancy's own page; no independent survey of legal-tech consultants' income or client sources exists in the notes
LinkedIn Jobs counts for legal engineer, legal technologist, Clio consultant or legal operations analyst	Not retrievable; no third party publishes dated counts

Conclusion

What the research changes

The problem a small firm will pay to remove is not drafting law. It is the loop of chasing, waiting and checking that sits around every matter, and that loop is now policed from outside: by regulators (SRA AML inspections, the Legal Ombudsman's 36% conveyancing share), by courts (bundle rejections, CE-File fee rejections, hallucination sanctions) and by insurers (administrative errors at a quarter of claims). The strongest language is therefore risk language, not productivity language, and the strongest evidence is a regulator's own finding about the firm's own practice area.

The 2025-26 rulings and notices drew a hard line between 'open' and 'closed' tools, and the firms most likely to cross it are the smallest and least supported. The market reaction so far is either a ban that staff ignore or a vendor AI add-on that users describe as forced on them and wrong in its details. The space between those two, where confidential files are processed inside the firm's control with a human check built into the step, is where every top-ranked gap sits: closed-tool document work, provider reconciliation on medical records, exception reports pulled from the firm's own Clio data, bundles built from the firm's own documents, AML reasoning written from the firm's own evidence.

Where not to go, and what the law reserves to a person

Intake answering, chronologies and demand letters are where the venture money and the vendor claims are concentrated, and their users' complaints are about quality, support and price rather than absence.

Anything the law reserves to a person is not a gap to automate but a boundary to design around: a sworn statement for a Florida crash report, an attorney's declaration in California, the COFA's signature on a reconciliation, the qualified lawyer's check of every citation.

Two vocabularies, two markets for the same skills

The vocabulary split is not cosmetic: a UK buyer searches 'court bundle software', 'ai policy for solicitors' and hires a 'fee earner' support role around 'completion' and 'Land Registry'; a US buyer searches 'law firm intake automation', 'is chatgpt confidential' and hires a 'case manager' around 'calendaring' and 'e-filing'. The same service will need two sets of words, and the notes give them verbatim.

The job-market notes add a last contrast: the employed path pays most where a law degree or six to eight years of production AI work is the screen and where 'remote' stops at the national border, while the freelance path is priced down to $20 an hour by marketplace sellers and protected only inside vendor certification programmes, which is where the small firm's actual buying habit (no internal IT, no technology budget, Google first) meets a consultant at all.

This document reports problems, workflows, numbers, vocabulary and gaps only. It contains no solutions and no recommendations. The Sources appendix lists every URL the research cited; section 11 lists what could not be verified.